

Antmicro

Pipeline Manager

2026-10-23

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CHAPTER

ONE

INTRODUCTION

Pipeline Manager is a data-based web application for creating, visualizing and managing pipelines for various applications.

This documentation contains the following chapters:

- *Pipeline Manager* - a quickstart guide for the project
- *Specification format* - description of the node specification format
- *Dataflow format* - graph description format overview
- *Front-end features* - description of front-end features and front end testing
- *Communication with an external application* - external application integration overview
- *Sample third-party server* - describes how to configure server for testing frontend features
- *Specification Builder* - describes the Python's `SpecificationBuilder` module for constructing the specification.
- *Graph Builder* - describes the Python's `GraphBuilder` class for constructing and manipulating the dataflow graph.
- *Dataflow and specification format changelog* - lists changes and versions in the format of dataflow and specification files
- *Front end demo* - Pipeline Manager's front end demonstration.

CHAPTER

TWO

PIPELINE MANAGER

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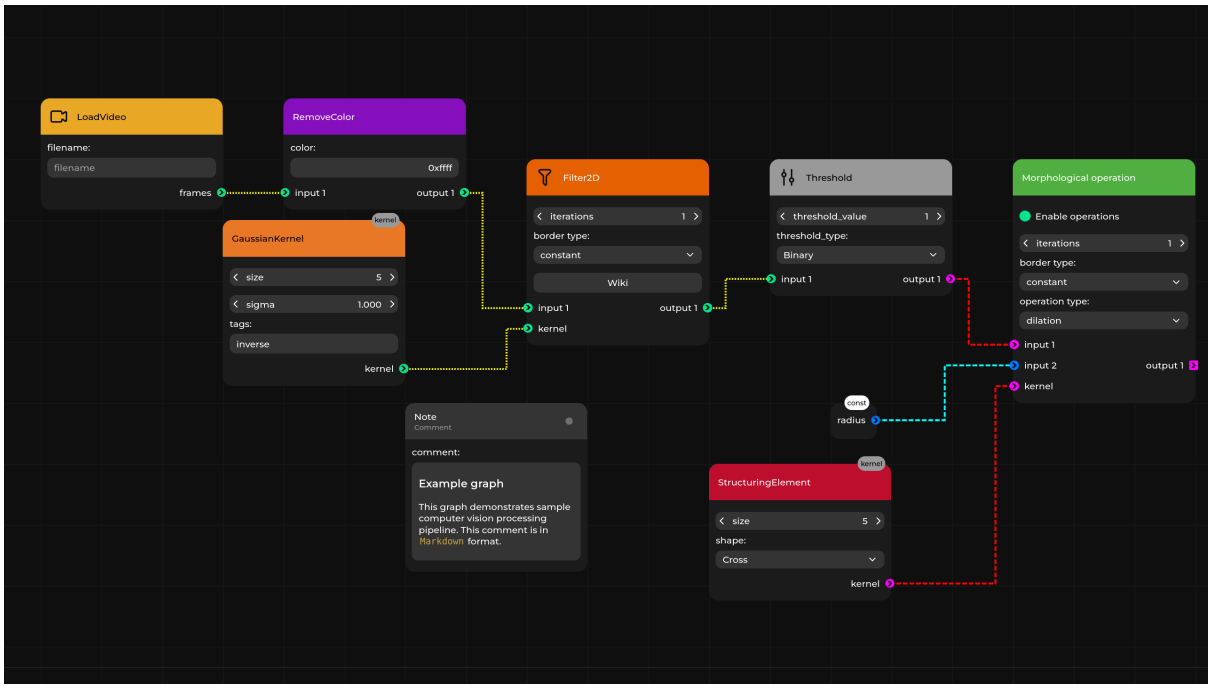
Pipeline Manager is a data-based, application-agnostic web application for creating, visualizing and managing dataflows in various applications. It does not assume any properties of the application it is working with, thanks to which fast integration with various formats is possible.

Pipeline Manager documentation | Demo application

Pipeline Manager provides functionality for:

- visualizing and editing dataflows
- saving and loading dataflows
- communicating with an external application to delegate advanced validation, execution of the defined graph and conversions to and from native graph formats

Pipeline Manager simplifies the process of developing graph-based graphical interfaces for applications that are modular and have a graph-like nature.



2.1 Prerequisites

Pipeline Manager requires `npm` (at least 10.8.2 version is recommended, along with Node.js starting from 20.10.0), `python` and `pip` for installing dependencies, building and (optionally) running - use package manager to install those packages.

The backend of the application has a list of requirements in the `pyproject.toml` file. They can be installed using `pip`:

```
pip install .
```

All `npm` modules necessary for the front end of the application are installed automatically during build. You can find them in the `./pipeline_manager/frontend/node_modules` directory after the application is built.

2.2 Building and running

Pipeline Manager can be built in two different ways, as:

- a static HTML application running in a browser without any additional back end server
- a regular web application designed to communicate and cooperate with an external application (like Kenning)

2.2.1 Static HTML application

To build Pipeline Manager as a static HTML application, run the following in the root directory:

```
./build static-html
```

To list available flags, run:

```
./build static-html -h
```

To run the built application, open `./pipeline_manager/frontend/dist/index.html` in a preferred browser. For example, if the browser of your choice is `firefox` you should run:

```
firefox ./pipeline_manager/frontend/dist/index.html
```

With Pipeline Manager running, you can use a sample specification you can find in the `./examples/sample_specification.json` directory to explore visualization and pipeline editing capabilities. Additionally, you can use `./examples/sample_dataflow.json` see how dataflows are stored.

You can load the specification on the webpage using the `Load specification` option in the main menu. You can then load the dataflow on the webpage using the `Load graph file` option in the main menu.

What is more, you can provide the specification and the dataflow as URL arguments:

- `spec` - should contain URL to the specification file
- `graph` - should contain URL to the dataflow file
- `preview` - if `true`, the graph is displayed in preview mode (read only, no HUD)

- `include` - to alter the specification from within the URL, you can provide an URL to additional includes with this field

URL example:

```
firefox "https://antmicro.github.io/kenning-pipeline-manager/_static/pipeline-
↪manager.html?spec=https%3A%2F%2Fraw.githubusercontent.com%2Fantmicro%2Fkenning-
↪pipeline-manager%2Frefs%2Fheads%2Fmain%2Fexamples%2Fsample-specification.json&
↪graph=https%3A%2F%2Fraw.githubusercontent.com%2Fantmicro%2Fkenning-pipeline-
↪manager%2Frefs%2Fheads%2Fmain%2Fexamples%2Fsample-dataflow.json"
```

The URL above will fetch and use specification and dataflow from the GitHub repository for this project. The URLs need to be encoded.

You can add a JSON with a default specification to the generated HTML by providing the path to your file as the second argument for the `./build` script:

```
./build static-html <path-to-specification-json>
```

You can also add a default dataflow that will be loaded when the application starts, for example:

```
./build static-html <path-to-specification> <path-to-dataflow>
```

To be able to use some additional assets, like icons for nodes, run:

```
./build --assets-directory <path-to-assets-dir> static-html <path-to-
↪specification> <path-to-dataflow>
```

To change the title of the editor and page, use the `--editor-title` flag, for example:

```
./build --editor-title 'Graph editor' static-html <path-to-specification> <path-
↪to-dataflow>
```

For details on how to write specifications, see:

- Pipeline Manager documentation
- Specification format
- Dataflow format
- Examples in `examples/` directory - in the directory you can find sample specification files (with `-specification.json` suffix), usually paired with supported dataflow files (with `-dataflow.json` suffix)

For example, you can run:

```
./build static-html ./examples/sample-specification.json ./examples/sample-
↪dataflow.json --output-directory ./pipeline-manager-demo
```

Upon a successful build, run:

```
firefox ./pipeline-manager-demo/index.html
```

You should get a graph view similar to the one in the documentation's demo.

2.2.2 Web application

To build Pipeline Manager to work with an external application (like Kenning), run the following in the root directory:

```
./build server-app
```

For available flags, check:

```
./build server-app -h
```

In this scenario, the back-end server is expected to serve the content for Pipeline Manager. To do that, run the following in the root directory:

```
./run
```

By default, the back-end server runs on `http://127.0.0.1:5000`. In addition to using the sample specification, you can also connect a third-party application (e.g. Kenning), edit its pipeline, validate it and run it.

2.2.3 Miscellaneous

Development

To run a development server which automatically recompiles a project after detecting any changes, in `./pipeline_manager/frontend` directory, for static mode, run:

```
npm run serve-static
```

For web application mode, run:

```
npm run serve
```

Validation

Pipeline Manager includes a validation tool you can use during specification and dataflow development.

To validate an existing specification, run the following in the root directory:

```
./validate <specification-path>
```

To validate an existing specification and one or more dataflows, run the following in the root directory:

```
./validate <specification-path> <dataflow-path> <dataflow-path> ...
```

Replace both `specification-path` and `dataflow-path` with the actual paths to the JSON configuration file you want to validate. When running the validation tool for the first time, make sure to include the `--instal-dependencies` flag.

Cleanup

To remove the installed `npm` dependencies and the built application, run the following in the root directory:

```
./cleanup
```

2.2.4 Using Pipeline Manager as a Python module

To install Pipeline Manager with `pip`, run:

```
pip install -U git+https://github.com/antmicro/kenning-pipeline-manager.git
```

To work directly with the repository, install the module with:

```
pip install -e .
```

All Pipeline Manager scripts can then be used from the command-line interface:

```
pipeline_manager
usage: pipeline_manager {build,run,validate,cleanup}
```

CHAPTER

THREE

SPECIFICATION FORMAT

Pipeline Manager requires a JSON specification that defines the working environment. It specifies all nodes, properties, available connections, and metadata for the editor. It can be either provided from a file or fetched from an *external application*.

Such a specification defining the nodes needs to be loaded through the front end in order for you to be able to load any dataflow.

3.1 Format description

The specification needs to be provided in a JSON file. The specification consists of:

- `metadata` - object of type *Metadata* that specifies editor styling and metadata
- `nodes` - array that specifies valid nodes, where every element is of type *Node*.
- `graphs` - array of dataflow-like objects defining graph nodes, of type *Graph*.
- `include` - array of string objects pointing to a remote url to the specifications to include.
- `includeGraphs` - array of objects of type *Included Graph*, that specifies graph instances to be included in the specification from a remote url.
- `entryGraph` - ID of the graph that should be loaded with the specification. A graph can be chosen from `include` or `includeGraphs`.
- `version` - string determining version of the specification. Should be set to the newest version described in *Changelogs*. Pipeline Manager uses that value to check the compatibility of the specification with the current implementation, giving warnings about inconsistency in versions.
- `urloverrides` - override metadata URLs in provided specification. Lets the user change the locations of icons and other items stored in the *metadata*.

Note

Graph node named `New Graph Node` is available by default after loading a specification. It can be used to create new, custom graphs. That is why using this name for a graph will result in an error.

3.1.1 Metadata

This object specifies additional editor options and contains the following optional properties:

- `interfaces` - a dictionary which defines interface and connection styling for particular interface types. The key in the dictionary is the name of the interface type, and the value is of type *Interface style*.
- `allowLoopbacks` - boolean value that determines whether connections with endpoints at the same node are allowed. Default value is `false`.
- `readonly` - boolean value determining whether the editor is in read-only mode. In read-only mode, the user cannot create or remove nodes and connections. Modification of any properties is also disabled. The user is only allowed to load existing dataflows. Default value is `false`.
- `twoColumn` - boolean value determining the layout of the nodes. If set to `true`, then input and output sockets are both rendered in the top part of the node and properties are displayed below. Default value is `false`.
- `connectionStyle` - string value that determines the connection style. Can choose one out of the two options: `curved` or `orthogonal`. Default value is `curved`
- `hideHud` - boolean value determining whether UI elements should be hidden. Components affected by this flag are: popup notifications, navigation bar and terminal window. Default value is `false`
- `layers` - layers specifying groups of interfaces and nodes that can be hidden in the viewer from settings level. The entries are of type *Layer*. By default there are no layers.
- `urls` - list of URL classes present in the specification and flow. It is a dictionary, where key is the name of the URL class, and value is of type *URL class specification*. The given URL classes can be referred to later in *Nodes* with proper link suffix.
- `collapseSidebar` - boolean value determining whether nodes sidebar should be collapsed by default. Default value is `true`
- `movementStep` - Defines offset to which nodes snap in the grid. Default value is `1`.
- `backgroundSize` - Defines size of the background grid. Default value is `100`.
- `layout` - String specifying the name of autolayout algorithm used in placing nodes from dataflow Default value is `NoLayout`
- `icons` - contains definition of icon classes. Icon classes are key-value pairs, where key is the name of the icon class, and value is the URL prefix that is used to compute the actual path.
- `nodeLists` - definitions of jq queries used to filter nodes. Key in the dict represents name of a node list, and the value is a string representing jq query executed on `nodes`. Example:

```
nodeLists: {
  "All nodes": ".",
  "Custom nodes": "[.[] | select(.tag? == \"custom\")]"
}
```

- `styles` - a dictionary that defines node styles. The key in the dictionary is the name of the style, and the value is of type *Node style*.

- `welcome` - boolean value determining whether a welcome text should appear on empty editor. This feature is enabled by default.
- `navbarItems` - list of buttons that are displayed in the navbar in `server-app` mode, that allow for calling custom procedures. The entries are of type *Navbar item*.
- `contextMenuActions` - list of actions that are displayed in the context menu of every node, that allow for calling custom procedure. The entries are of type *Context menu item*.
- `subgraphContextMenuActions` - list of actions that are displayed in the context menu of subgraph nodes, that allow for calling custom procedure. The entries are of type *Context menu item*.
- `logLevel` - string specifying minimum level of verbosity notification has to have to be displayed. It can be one of `INFO`, `WARNING`, `ERROR`.
- `tag` - String value assigned to each node type defined in the current specification (not in included subspecifications)
- `editableTypes` - Boolean specifying whether nodes can be edited. It may be changed later in the UI (given that `toggleableEditableTypes` is enabled in the specification). The default value is `false`.
- `toggleableEditableTypes` - Boolean value determining whether node editibility can be toggled from the frontend. The default value is `true`.
- `newGraphNode` - Boolean value telling whether anonymous graphs should be available for the given specification or not.
- `newNodeType` - Boolean value that controls whether the button for creation of new node types should be displayed or not. The default value is `true`.
- `notifyWhenChanged` - Boolean value specifying whether the frontend should send requests with information about changed values. This option is only effective when Pipeline Manager is run in server-app mode. Notifications include events from the *list of available events* ending with `_on_change`.
- `hideAnchors` - Boolean value determining whether anchors in all connections should be hidden and only visible on hover. The default value is `false`.
- `showIds` - Boolean value determining whether node IDs and graph IDs should be visible in the editor. The default value is `false`.
- `showHiddenProperties` - Boolean value determining whether properties marked with `hideOnDefault` should be visible regardless of their value. The default value is `false`.
- `disableInterfaceExpose` - Boolean value which blocks option to expose node's interfaces. The default value is `false`.

An example:

```
"metadata": {
    "interfaces": {
        "Dataset": {
            "interfaceColor": "#FF00FF",
            "interfaceConnectionPattern": "dashed",
            "interfaceConnectionColor": "#FF0000"
        }
```

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```
    },
    "allowLoopbacks": false,
    "readonly": true,
    "connectionStyle": "orthogonal",
    "hideHud": false,
    "layers": [
        {
            "name": "Example Layer",
            "nodeLayers": ["processing"],
            "nodeInterfaces": ["BinaryImage"]
        }
    ],
    "layout": "NoLayout"
}
```

Layer

Layer is used to describe a set of types of nodes and interfaces. Layers can be used to hide nodes of given types. They can be also used to hide interfaces with given types.

The layers can be enabled or disabled in editor settings. Their state can be specified for each graph individually.

Every layer has three properties (at least `name` and one of `nodeLayers` or `nodeInterfaces` need to be defined):

- `name` - name of the layer displayed in the editor,
- `nodeLayers` (optional) - array of names of node types that belong to the layer,
- `nodeInterfaces` (optional) - array of names of interface types that belong to the layer.

URL class

URL class provides links with additional information for a given node. They are represented in nodes as icons leading to a URL with additional information on nodes.

The name of the URL class is specified as key in `urls` entry in metadata.

The URL class parameters are following:

- `name` - name of the URL class, appears as hint on hover over the icon,
- `icon` - path to the icon representing the URL class,
- `url` - base URL for URL class. The suffixes for URLs are present in *Node* parameters.

Interface style

Interface style describes how interfaces of a given type should look like, as well as its input or output connections. It consists of the following properties:

- `interfaceColor` - describes the color of the interface, should be a hexadecimal number representing RGB values. An interface of several types takes the style of the first of them that has one.

- `interfaceConnectionPattern` - describes how the connection line should look like. The possible variants are `solid`, `dashed` and `dotted`.
- `interfaceConnectionColor` - describes the color of connection lines, should be a hexadecimal number representing RGB values. A connection takes the style of the first type of its source that both its ends have and that has a style.
- `x` - relative x position to node width, in percentages used with `shape` node style attribute.
- `y` - relative y position to node width, in percentages used with `shape` node style attribute.

Node style

Node style defines how nodes of a given style should look like. Currently, the following elements are supported:

- `color` - color of the node unless a node sets its own `color`,
- `icon` - secondary icon of the node, which is displayed separately from *Node* `icon`,
- `pill` - pill of the node unless a node sets its own `pill`.
- `minimal` - flag informing whether to use special minimized style for the node. Note that icon and title card won't be visible when this is enabled.
- `shape` - a link or path to SVG file, allowing to define custom shape for node.
- `clean` - flag informing whether to use special clean style for the node. Only title and port endpoints will be visible in this style. Interface names and properties will be hidden.
- `title` - a section that allows for settings node title behaviour.
  - `fit` - a node width depends on title length
  - `hideSubTitle` - when set, sub title remains hidden
  - `position` - allows to set arbitrary position of title relative to node top-left corner, defined by `x` and `y` attributes with percentage values related to node's size.
  - `offset` - allows to set a offset position of title relative to node top-left corner, defined by `x` and `y` attributes in pixels.
  - `padding` - allows to set shape size offset, defined by `x` and `y` attributes in pixels.

There are also entries that allow for further customization of specific node elements:

- `nodes` - specifies custom CSS attributes for node as a whole. Top-most key value must be one of:
  - `title` - object with CSS attributes for title of node only.
  - `content` - object with CSS attributes for content of a node.
  - `body` - object with CSS attributes for the whole node.
- `interfaces` - is a dictionary of objects. Each key signals type of interface (within a node that has this specific style) and the value is a dictionary of CSS properties for this specific interface.
- `properties` - is a dictionary of objects. Each key represents type of property (see *Property*) and the value is a dictionary of CSS attributes for the specified property within a node of that style.

Note that when specifying `interface` or `property` type above a star `*` may be used to match all other (non specified) types.

Example of a valid style using CSS attribute setting:

```
"experimental": {
    "interfaces": {
        "*": {
            "--baklava-control-color-foreground": "transparent"
        }
    },
    "properties": {
        "text": {
            "--baklava-control-color-hover": "olive",
            "--baklava-control-color-background": "green",
            "--baklava-control-color-foreground": "lime"
        }
    },
    "nodes": {
        "title": {
            "justify-content": "center"
        },
        "body": {
            "min-width": "0px",
            "width": "auto"
        }
    }
}
```

Field values are defined the same way as in *Node* specification, however, `icon` can obtain *Navbar item* `iconName` values as well.

There exist special styles:

- `__new` - managed automatically and does not persist specification saves and loads,
- `__edited` - added to the node type which was modified.

Specificity

Node type can define multiple styles and styling of type-specific elements (e.g. `icon`). Moreover, *an instance* can do this as well, although it is currently limited to the `color` option.

The following order of specificity is used when evaluating the actual style of a given element (the first - the most important):

1. Node instance styling
2. Node type styling
3. Styles defined by the node type

Cascading

Appearance of a given element is determined by the the most specific rule that defines the element.

> **Note**
>
> Value `null` is a regular style value (i.e. undergoes the same merging procedure). It discards any lower-precedence styling of an element.

Example

For example, given:

- styles:

```
{
    "style1": {
        "options": {
            "color": "#0000FF",,
            "icon": "Cogwheel",
            "pill": {
                "text": "options"
            }
        },
        "miscellaneous": {
            "color": null,
            "pill": {
                "text": "misc"
            }
        }
        "constant": {
            "minimal": true,
            "pill": {
                "text": "const"
            }
        }
    }
}
```

- a node type:

```
{
    "name": "Node",
    "style": ["options", "miscellaneous"],
    "pill": null
}
```

- a node instance:

```
{
    "id": "401aff7b-fbb7-44cb-8f77-c78c80deefff",
    "position": {
        "x": 0,
        "y": 0
    },
    "width": 300,
    "twoColumn": false,
    "interfaces": [],
    "properties": [],
    "enabledInterfaceGroups": [],
    "name": "Node",
    "instanceName": "Node",
    "color": "#000000"
},
```

would resolve in the following way:

Element	Style `options`	Style `miscellaneous`	Node type	Node instance	Resolved value
`color`	`##0000FF`	`null`	`undefined`	`#000000`	`#000000`
`icon`	`Cogwheel`	`undefined`	`undefined`	–	`Cogwheel`
`pill`	`{"text": "options"}`	`{"text": "misc"}`	`null`	–	`null`

Navbar item

Describes a list of custom buttons displayed in the navbar. Every element consists of the following properties:

- `name` - displayed as a tooltip to the user when the button is hovered. Names have to be unique.
- `stopName` - name displayed in the tooltip when the corresponding procedure is running and is stoppable. If not specified simply 'Stop' is added as a prefix to the name.
- `iconName` - name of the icon that is used. It can be either a file in the assets directory, or an icon described in `/pipeline-manager/pipeline_manager/frontend/src/icons/index.ts`.
- `procedureName` - name of the procedure (either a built-in *API procedure* or a *custom procedure*) to be called. It is assumed that the procedure accepts a does not need any arguments, or takes one argument which is the currently displayed dataflow (similarly to [dataflow_run(#external-dataflow-run)]).
- `allowToRunInParallelWith` - a list of procedure names that can be started in parallel to the currently running job.

Example of a button that is used to run the current graph using a dedicated procedure `dataflow_run` looks as follows:

```
{
    "name": "Run",
```

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```
    "stopName": "Stop",
    "iconName": "Run",
    "procedureName": "dataflow_run",
    "allowToRunInParallelWith": [
        "dataflow_validate",
        "custom_lint_files"
    ]
}
```

This will create a button called Run, with the `Run` icon (available built-in icon), which upon clicking will run `dataflow_run` method. During execution of the `dataflow_run` method, we can run in parallel `dataflow_validate` and `custom_lint_files` procedures.

Note

By default, only single action can be called from NavBar at a time.

Warning

`allowToRunInParallelWith` is a one-way relation. This means that if we have two actions that can be started when the other one is running, then `allowToRunInParallelWith` needs to be defined in both actions.

Context menu item

Describes a list of custom actions available for nodes in the custom menu (depending on where the item is specified either all nodes, only subgraph nodes or only nodes of given type). Every element consists of the following properties:

- `name` - displayed as a tooltip to the user when the node is clicked. Names have to be unique,
- `iconName` - name of the icon that is used. It can be either a file in the assets directory, or an icon described in `/pipeline-manager/pipeline_manager/frontend/src/icons/index.ts`.
- `procedureName` - name of the *custom procedure* to be called. It is assumed that the procedure takes one argument, which is the id of the clicked node. The response is validated against *dataflow_export* if `procedureName` starts with `custom_download` or *dataflow_run* otherwise
- `requiredResponse` - whether the response from the external application should be awaited when running the procedure

An example of an action that is used to run a dedicated `custom_show_info` procedure looks as follows:

```
{
    "name": "Show Info",
    "iconName": "Magnifier",
    "procedureName": "custom_show_info",
```

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```
    "requireResponse": true
}
```

This will create a button called Show Info, with the `Magnifier` icon (available built-in icon), which upon clicking will run `custom_show_info` method and pass the id of the clicked node to it.

3.1.2 Node

This object specifies a single node.

- `name` - name displayed in the editor.
- `layer` - layer type used for styling and toggling the node visibility in the editor.
- `category` - context menu category displayed in the editor.
- `icon` - name of an SVG icon that is going to be displayed next to the name of the node. The value of `icon` can be:
  - `string` containing the path to the icon relative to the `assets` directory, e.g. `filter.svg` for `pipeline_manager/frontend/dist/assets/filter.svg`
  - `string` containing the URL to the remote image file
  - `{"key": "value"}` pair, where `key` is the name of the icon class created in `icons`, in *Metadata*, and `value` is a suffix of the URL.

> **Note**
>
> The `assets` directory can be created and filled manually or added by `build` script with `--assets-directory <path-to-directory-with-icons>`, e.g.:
>
> ```
> ./build --assets-directory examples/sample-assets static-html static-html␣
> ↪examples/sample-specification.json
> ```

- `style` - node style name described in `styles` in *Metadata*. The value of `style` can be:
  - `string` - single style,
  - `array` - multiple styles, each subsequent style overrides the previous one.
- `interfaces` - array representing inputs, outputs and bidirectional ports for nodes. The entries are of type *Interface*.
- `properties` - array with elements of type *Property*,
- `interfaceGroups` - array with elements of type *Interface Groups*,
- `defaultInterfaceGroups` - array of objects that specifies which interface groups are enabled by default. Every object should contain a `name` and `direction` of an *Interface Groups*.
- `urls` - a dictionary of *URL class* and URL suffixes pairs. The key should be a URL class key from `urls` in `metadata`. The value of the entry is appended to the URL base from the URL class.

- `abstract` - boolean determining whether the node type is abstract or not. Abstract node types are used only for inheritance purposes, they do not appear in the final list of available nodes. They only have one mandatory field - `name`. The rest of the fields can be provided to introduce some common properties of classes inheriting from it.
- `contextMenuActions` - list of actions that are displayed in the context menu of every node of this type, that allow for calling custom procedures. The entries are of type *Context menu item*.
- `additionalData` - can be any JSON-like object (array, dictionary, number, string, ...), it is only used for storing some additional, node-specific data, such as comments etc.
- `description` - description of the node in markdown format that is displayed in a sidebar node.
- `isCategory` - determines whether the node is both a category and a node. If set to true, then the `name` of the node is inferred from the last text segment in the `category` parameter. If any node has a node category in its `category` path then it has to extend from the nearest ancestor category node. Additionally, if a node extends from a category node, then it has to be in its subtree.
- `color` - a hexadecimal color that will be used as the node background in the editor. If not provided, the default Kenning Pipeline Manager color scheme will be used.
- `tag` - Tag assigned to a node type during specification resolving. Used to filter node types with queries defined in `nodeLists` object defined in *Metadata*.
- `width` - a default width, in pixels, of a node in the editor.
- `twoColumn` - boolean value. If set to `true`, the interfaces on opposite sides will be arranged parallel to each other. Otherwise, each interface will be positioned on a separate line.
- `pill` - a dictionary that defines an additional node tag displayed in the top right corner of the node. It has the following entries:
  - `text` - content of the pill,
  - `color` (optional) - background color. The default color is white.
- `height` - a default height, in pixels, of a node in the editor. Most relevant with *Custom shape nodes*.

Some or all of the properties above (except for `name`) can be derived from existing node types using the `extends` list - check *Node type inheritance*.

Here is an example of a node:

```
{
    "name": "Filter2D",
    "layer": "filters",
    "category": "Filters",
    "icon": "filter.svg",
    "description": "Node that applies a *2D* filter.",
    "properties": [
        {
            "name": "iterations",
            "type": "integer",
            "default": 1
```

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```
        },
        {
            "name": "border type",
            "type": "select",
            "values": ["constant", "replicate", "wrap", "reflect"],
            "default": "constant"
        }
    ],
    "interfaces": [
        {
            "name": "image",
            "type": "Image",
            "direction": "input"
        },
        {
            "name": "kernel",
            "type": "Image",
            "direction": "input"
        },
        {
            "name": "output",
            "type": "Image",
            "direction": "output"
        }
    ],
    "color": "#4e096f"
}
```

Interface

An object that specifies a single input, output or inout interface of node. Every interface object has following properties:

- `name` - name of the input displayed in the editor
- `type` - type of the input used for styling and validation purposes. Can be either a list of strings or a single string. If two interfaces have at least one matching type, they can be connected. The first type in the list is a "base" type - it is used to color the interface based on *Interface style*. If only one type between two interfaces is matching, the connection style matches the one defined for this particular type. Otherwise, if multiple types are matching, a white solid line for connection is rendered.
- `direction` (optional) - type of the interface in terms of direction, it can be:
  - `input` - interface accepts input data,
  - `output` - interface returns output data.
  - `inout` - interface can both produce outputs and receive inputs.

  The default value is `inout`.
- `maxConnectionsCount` (optional) - specifies the maximum allowed number of connections for a given port. Value less than 0 means no limit for connections for a given interface.

Value equal to 0 means default behavior - one allowed connection to inputs, many allowed connections from outputs. The default value is 0.

- `side` (optional) - specifies the side on which the interface is rendered. Value can be either `left` or `right`. Interfaces with `direction` set to `input` or `inout` are by default rendered on the left side of the node. Interfaces with `direction` set to `output` are by default rendered on the right side of the node.
- `dynamic` (optional) - determines whether the interface should be dynamic, which means that the number of interfaces created of this definition can be changed in the editor. For each dynamic interface definition, a new property is added to the node that allows the user to change the number of interfaces. The name of the property is determined by the `name` and `direction` of the dynamic interface. The format is `{name} {direction}`. The property also has the optional attribute `dynamicCounter` set to `true`. The name of the dynamic interfaces is `{name}[{i}]`, where `i` is the index of the interface. `dynamic` property can be either `true`, then the maximum number of interfaces is not limited, or an array in a form of `[min, max]` that specifies the range of interfaces. All created interfaces share the same `maxConnectionCount` and `type` values.
- `array` (optional) - special keyword to easily define a range of interfaces. Value has to be a list with two integer values that specify the range of interfaces. For example, for an `example` interface with `array: [0, 2]` two interfaces called `example[0]` and `example[1]` are created.
- `sidePosition` (optional) - specifies the row on which the interface is rendered. Values for interfaces of the same `side` value have to be unique. If the value is not provided then rows are automatically provided by iterating from the first upper row. This value does not work for `array` keyword, as it produces more than one interface.
- `externalName` (optional) - used for graph nodes only, to expose an interface of a node within the graph. It specifies the name of the interface of the graph. Both the interface of the graph node and the interface of the node within the graph must have the same `id` and `direction` fields. Note that values of `externalName` of the graph node have to be unique.
- `bus` (optional) - interfaces can be changed to represent a bus:
  - `bus.type` - sets the interface to behave like a bus. Can be either set to `"oneSided"` or `"twoSided"` resulting in bigger or smaller variation of the bus.
  - `bus.size` - sets the size of the bus in pixels.

> **Note**
>
> Only interfaces of the same `type` can be connected together.

Property

An object that specifies a single property. Every project object has three required base properties:

- `name` - name of the property.
- `type` - type of the property.
- `default` - specifies a default selected value Its type depends on the `type` chosen.
- `hidden` - determines whether the property should be rendered in the node. This can be *overridden* by the node instance.

There are 13 possible values for the `type` property.

- `text` - property is a string. A text field is displayed to the user.
- `multiline` - property is a multi-line string. It allows to format the text in Markdown format.
- `constant` - property is a string. A non-modifiable text field is displayed to the user.
- `number` - property is a float. A number field is displayed to the user.
- `integer` - property is an int. A number field that only accepts integers is displayed to the user.
- `select` - property is a string with a defined range. It requires a `values` property.
- `bool` - property is a bool. A bool representing boolean value
- `slider` - property is a float with a specified range. It requires `min` and `max` properties.
- `list` - property is a list of arguments of the same type, which can be specified using `dtype`.
- `hex` - property is a string representing base-16 number which has to match the following regex: `/0x[a-fA-F0-9]`.
- `button-url` - property is a button which opens a new tab with a given URL.
- `button-api` - property is a button which triggers `button_click` *External App API* request, providing property `id` and `value`.
- `button-graph` - property is a button which opens a subgraph with a given URL.

Additional properties:

- `min` - specifies the left end of a range or minimal value of the base-16 number.
- `max` - specifies the right end of a range or maximal value of the base-16 number.
- `values` - specifies a range of possible values for `select`.
- `dtype` - specifies data type of elements in a `list`. Supported values are `string`, `number`, `integer`, `boolean`.
- `description` - description of the property. In some cases, it can be displayed to the user.
- `group` - object of type *Group*.
- `override` - boolean value determining whether the property should be overridden.
- `readonly` - boolean value determining whether the property should be read-only.
- `hideOnDefault` - boolean value determining whether the property should be kept hidden if it has default or no value assigned.

Group

Array with elements of type *Property*. It defines properties that are toggled by the property. `group` can only be used with property of type `bool`.

Example group of properties:

```
{
    "name": "Group", "type": "bool", "default": true, "group": [
        {"name": "prop-a", "type": "integer", "default": 1},
        {"name": "prop-b", "type": "text", "default": ""}
    ]
}
```

Node type inheritance

It is possible to inherit:

- `layer`
- `category`
- `icon`
- `interfaces`
- `properties`
- `urls`

From existing node types using the `extends` parameter. The parameter accepts a list of node types. The node type is computed by iteratively updating node type definition structures, going through all node types in the `extends` list (in the specified order), and then applying parameters from the current node type.

Below is a sample specification with used inheritance mechanism:

```
{
    "nodes": [
        {
            "name": "Type A",
            "layer": "class",
            "category": "Classes",
            "properties": [
                {"name": "prop-a", "type": "text", "default": ""}
            ],
            "interfaces": [
                {"name": "output-a", "type": "Interface", "direction": "output"}
            ]
        },
        {
            "name": "Type B",
            "extends": ["Type A"],
            "properties": [
                {"name": "prop-b", "type": "text", "default": ""}
            ],
            "interfaces": [
                {"name": "output-b", "type": "Interface", "direction": "output"}
            ]
        },
        {
```

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```
            "name": "Type C",
            "layer": "class",
            "category": "Classes",
            "properties": [
                {"name": "prop-c", "type": "text", "default": ""}
            ],
            "interfaces": [
                {"name": "input-c", "type": "Interface", "direction": "input"}
            ]
        },
        {
            "name": "Type D",
            "extends": ["Type B", "Type C"],
            "properties": [
                {"name": "prop-d", "type": "text", "default": ""}
            ],
            "interfaces": [
                {"name": "inout-d", "type": "Interface", "direction": "inout"}
            ]
        }
    ]
}
```

> **Warning**
>
> Node types can not be repeated (explicitly in list or implicitly through inheritance) in the `extends` list.

Moreover, it is possible to override inherited properties and interfaces. This mechanism requires using the same name and `"override"` attribute set to `true`. Only attributes used in the child node are overridden, others are inherited without change. For instance:

```
        {
            "name": "Type D",
            "extends": ["Type B", "Type C"],
            "properties": [
                {"name": "prop-a", "type": "number", "default": 1.4, "override":␣
↪true},
                {"name": "prop-c", "type": "integer", "default": 5, "override":␣
↪true},
                {"name": "prop-d", "type": "text", "default": ""}
            ],
            "interfaces": [
                {"name": "inout-d", "type": "Interface", "direction": "inout"},
                {"name": "output-a", "type": "Interface", "direction": "inout",
↪"override": true}
            ]
        }
```

3.1.3 Interface Groups

Object similar to a single interface but reserves a range of interfaces. `name`, `type`, `direction`, `maxConnectionsCount` and `side` are the same as in a regular *Interface*. The only difference is that a range of interfaces has to be defined which describes constraints of an interface. For example two interface groups can be defined that consist of common interfaces and thus cannot coexist.

```
"interfaceGroups": [
  {
    "name": "1",
    "type": "test",
    "direction": "input",
    "interfaces": [
      {"name": "1[1]", "direction": "output"},
      {"name": "1", "array": [3, 15], "direction": "output"},
      {"name": "1", "array": [35, 48], "direction": "output"}
    ]
  }
]
```

The interface group called `1` consists of three ranges of interfaces: `1[1]`, interfaces `1[3]`, `1[4]`, `...`, `1[14]` and `1[35]`, `1[36]`, `...`, `1[47]`.

3.1.4 Included Graphs

Object that specifies a graph instance to be included in the specification. The included graphs are available in the node palette and can be used in the editor.

> **Note**
>
> Included graphs cannot consist of more than one graph.

Included graphs can be specified using the `includeGraphs` keyword.

They have the following properties:

- `name` - name of the included graph, if not passed, the name of the graph is inferred from the graph.
- `category` - category in which the included graph is placed in the node palette, uses `/` as a delimiter. By default, the category is set to `default`.
- `url` - URL, where the graph file is located. The file has to be in a valid *dataflow* format.

Graphs included in the node palette can also be described directly in the specification.

To do that, use the `graphs` keyword and describe the graph using the *dataflow* format.

Keep in mind that the node used to represent the graph has to be declared in the specification as well.

The node needs to have `subgraphId` that matched the `id` of the graph.

It is possible to attach one graph to multiple nodes.

```
{
    "name": "Test subgraph node #2",
    "category": "Second Category",
    "color": "#6f091a",
    "subgraphId": "129c6246-d874-48cd-a33c-2927961d42e8"
},
{
    "name": "Test subgraph node #3",
    "category": "Second Category",
    "color": "#4e096f",
    "subgraphId": "129c6246-d874-48cd-a33c-2927961d42e8"
}
```

3.2 Example

Below, you can see a sample specification containing a hypothetical definition of nodes for image processing purposes:

```
{
    "nodes": [
        {
            "name": "LoadVideo",
            "layer": "filesystem",
            "category": "Filesystem",
            "properties": [
                {"name": "filename", "type": "text", "default": ""}
            ],
            "interfaces": [{"name": "frames", "type": "Image", "direction":
↪"output"}]
        },
        {
            "name": "SaveVideo",
            "layer": "filesystem",
            "category": "Filesystem",
            "properties": [
                {"name": "filename", "type": "text", "default": ""}
            ],
            "interfaces": [
                {"name": "color", "type": "Image", "direction": "input"},
                {"name": "binary", "type": "BinaryImage", "direction": "input"}
            ]
        },
        {
            "name": "GaussianKernel",
            "layer": "kernel",
            "category": "Generators",
            "properties": [
                {"name": "size", "type": "integer", "default": 5},
                {"name": "sigma", "type": "number", "default": 1.0}
```

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```
            ],
            "interfaces": [{"name": "kernel", "type": "Image", "direction":
↪"output"}]
        },
        {
            "name": "StructuringElement",
            "layer": "kernel",
            "category": "Generators",
            "properties": [
                {"name": "size", "type": "integer", "default": 5},
                {
                    "name": "shape",
                    "type": "select",
                    "values": ["Rectangle", "Cross", "Ellipse"],
                    "default": "Cross"
                }
            ],
            "interfaces": [{"name": "kernel", "type": "BinaryImage", "direction":
↪"output"}]
        },
        {
            "name": "Filter2D",
            "layer": "processing",
            "category": "Processing",
            "properties": [
                {"name": "iterations", "type": "integer", "default": 1},
                {
                    "name": "border type",
                    "type": "select",
                    "values": ["constant", "replicate", "wrap", "reflect"],
                    "default": "constant"
                }
            ],
            "interfaces": [
                {"name": "image", "type": "Image", "direction": "input"},
                {"name": "kernel", "type": "Image", "direction": "input"},
                {"name": "output", "type": "Image", "direction": "output"}
            ]
        },
        {
            "name": "Threshold",
            "layer": "processing",
            "category": "Processing",
            "properties": [
                {"name": "threshold_value", "type": "integer", "default": 1},
                {
                    "name": "threshold_type",
                    "type": "select",
                    "values": ["Binary", "Truncate", "Otsu"],
```

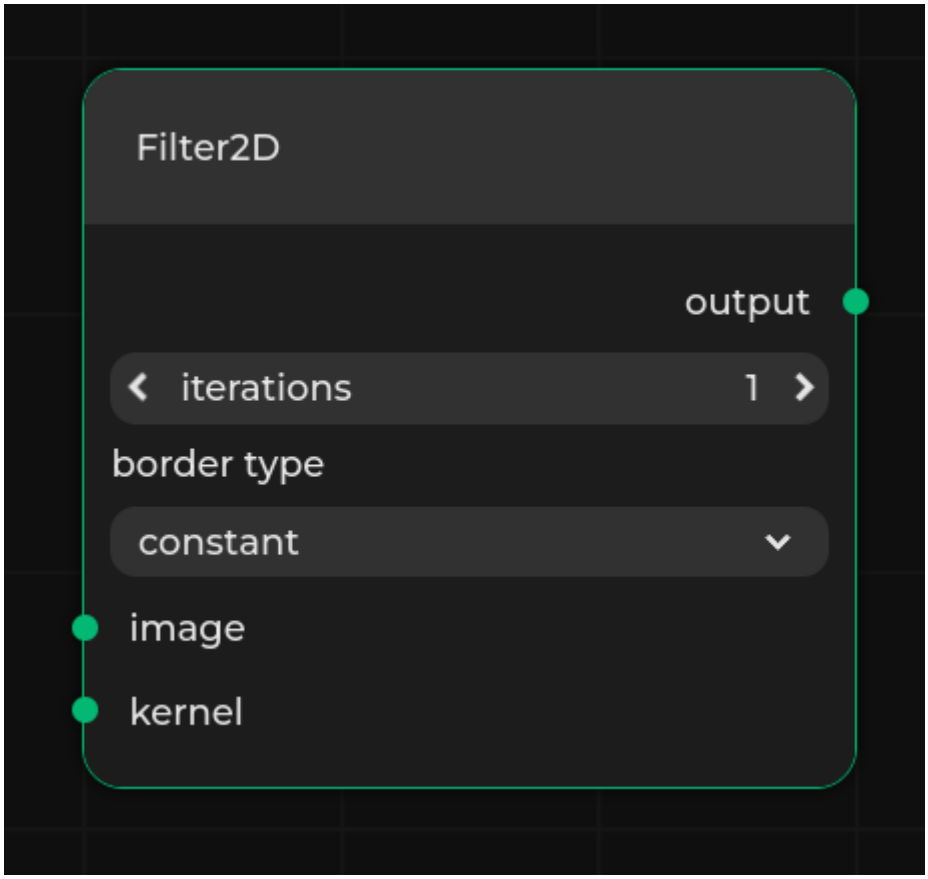
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```
                    "default": "constant"
                }
            ],
            "interfaces": [
                {"name": "image", "type": "Image", "direction": "input"},
                {"name": "output", "type": "BinaryImage", "direction": "output"}
            ]
        },
        {
            "name": "Morphological operation",
            "layer": "processing",
            "category": "Processing",
            "properties": [
                {
                    "name": "Enable operations", "type": "bool", "default": true,
↪"group": [
                        {"name": "iterations", "type": "integer", "default": 1},
                        {
                            "name": "border type",
                            "type": "select",
                            "values": ["constant", "replicate", "wrap", "reflect
↪"],
                            "default": "constant"
                        },
                        {
                            "name": "operation type",
                            "type": "select",
                            "values": ["dilation", "erosion", "closing", "opening
↪"],
                            "default": "dilation"
                        }
                    ]
                }
            ],
            "interfaces": [
                {"name": "image", "type": "BinaryImage", "direction": "input"},
                {"name": "kernel", "type": "BinaryImage", "direction": "input"},
                {"name": "output", "type": "BinaryImage", "direction": "output"}
            ]
        }
    ],
    "metadata": {
        "interfaces": {
            "Image": "#00FF00",
            "BinaryImage": "#FF0000"
        }
    },
    "version": "20230830.10"
}
```

Thanks to the flexibility of the specification format, you can use any combination of properties and interfaces to create a custom node. It is also readable and divided into distinct parts, so you can implement a process of automated specification generation into an external application. See the *External App Communication* section to find out more.

A sample node created from the specification above:



CHAPTER

FOUR

DATAFLOW FORMAT

A rendered graph with all its nodes, their properties, values, and connections is called a dataflow. Its state can be serialized and saved as a JSON file.

4.1 Format description

The root of the dataflow format consists of four main attributes.

- `metadata` - structure of type *Metadata*. It is used to override metadata settings from the *Specification format*. In general, values from dataflow's `metadata` override settings from specification. For simple types, such as strings or integers, values are changed. For arrays and dictionaries, the values are updated (values of existing keys are replaced with new ones, and the new values in arrays are appended to the existing entries).
- `entryGraph` - string that specifies the ID of the graph from `graphs` list that should be rendered when the dataflow is loaded. If not specified, the first graph in the list is rendered.
- `graphs` - array of objects of type *Graph* that describe available graphs in the dataflow. Each graph is a separate entity that can be rendered in the editor. If `entryGraph` is not specified, the first graph in the list is rendered when the dataflow is loaded.
- `version` - string that identifies the version of the specification and dataflow. It is used to check compatibility between provided dataflow and the current version of the implementation.

4.1.1 Graph

Graphs are a way to encapsulate a part of the dataflow into a separate entity. They can be used to simplify the dataflow structure, group nodes, or create reusable components. On the frontend level, graphs are rendered as distinct nodes, which can be interacted with in the same way as standard nodes, but can be entered and expanded to show the content of the subgraph. On top of that, interfaces of such graph nodes may be exposed and accessed outside the graph, allowing to create more complex, multi-layer graph structures.

Each graph can be described with the following properties:

- `id` - unique value that identifies the graph.
- `name` - human-readable name of the graph.
- `additionalData` - any JSON-like data that provides additional information regarding the graph.
- `nodes` - array that specifies all nodes in the dataflow. Every element is of type *Node*.

- `connections` - array that specifies all connections in the dataflow. Every element is of type *Connection*.
- `groups` - object of type *Group* that allows for a visual separation of a selected set of nodes.
- `panning` - object of type *Panning* that defines the position of the top-left corner in the rendered editor.
- `scaling` - floating-point number that defines the zoom level in the editor.
- `disabledLayers` - array of strings containing names of layers disabled by default for a particular graph.

Node

An object that describes a single node in the editor. Each node has:

- `name` - node name, as defined in the specification.
- `id` - unique value assigned to the node.
- `instanceName` - optional field defining a node's title rendered to the user. If set, `instancename (name)` will be displayed, otherwise, just the `name` will be rendered.
- `properties` - list describing the node's parameterized values. Every element is of type *Property*.
- `interfaces` - list describing the node's interfaces. Every element is of type *Interface*.
- `width` - the node's width in the editor.
- `twoColumn` - boolean value. If set to `true`, the interfaces on opposite sides will be arranged parallel to each other. Otherwise, each interface will be positioned on a separate line. This overrides the value set in the specification. If not provided, the value set in the specification will be used instead.
- `subgraph` - optional field defining the `id` of the subgraph that this node represents. It refers to one of the *Graphs* entries from `graphs` with a matching `id`.
- `enabledInterfaceGroups` - optional array describing enabled interface groups. Every element is of type *Enabled Interface Groups*.
- `color` - optional field defining a hexadecimal color that will be used as the node background in the editor. This overrides the node color set in the specification. If not provided, the color set in the specification will be used instead.
- `views` - optional field that can define alternative ways to display the node. Each element has to have assigned:
  - `name` - name of the alternative view
  - `position` - position of the node in alternative view
  - `style` - style of the node in alternative view

Property

Each property is described by an object with three attributes:

- `id` - unique value assigned to the property,
- `name` - name of the property,

- `value` - actual value of the property,
- `hidden` - determines whether the property should be rendered in the node. This overrides a similar directive from *specification* The default value is `false`.

Additionally, these optional attributes may be used to control specific types of properties:

- `externalName` - name of the property displayed in the editor. Used only for properties exposed from nested graphs.
- `dynamicCounter` - boolean value indicating that the property controls dynamic interfaces. If set to true, the property can be used to increase or decrease the number of dynamic interfaces with the same name.

Two node properties: `example_text` of value `example_value` and `example_number` of value `123` would be defined as such:

```
[
    {
        "id": 1,
        "name": "example_text",
        "value": "example_value"
    },
    {
        "id": 2,
        "name": "example_number",
        "value": 123
    }
]
```

Interface

Each input, output, and inout is described by an object with at least three attributes:

- `id` - unique value assigned to the interface. It is used to describe connections in the dataflow.
- `name` - name of the interface
- `direction` - value determining the type of the interface. Can be either `input`, `output`, or `inout`.

Additionally, these optional attributes may be used:

- `side` - tells on which side of the node the interface should be placed.
- `sidePosition` - specifies a row on which the interface is rendered. Values for interfaces of the same `side` value have to be unique.
- `externalName` - name of the interface displayed in the editor. For every interface in each node, it is possible to make it a graph interface. A graph interface has its own unique external name, which is visible when the graph is nested within another graph. It is used to create multi-layer graphs, with subgraphs that can be connected to others nodes/graphs. Both the interface of the graph node and the interface of the node within the graph have the same `id` and `direction` fields. Note that values of `externalName` within the graph have to be unique.

- `bus` - holds information about the bus-specific data used for the interface. Note that for the interface to be treated as a bus it needs to have `bus.type` set in it's *specification*. In dataflow you can define:
  - `bus.size` - size of the bus in pixels.
  - `bus.stubs` - holds any connection endpoints that will be used for any connections. Each stub MUST have a connection assigned otherwise it will be treated as an error. Each stub has:
    * `id` - id of the stub used to identify it when creating connections just like a normal interface
    * `offset` - position of the stub within the parent bus
    * `side` - (optional) used when parent bus is two-sided.

Example of graph interfaces:

```
{
    "graphs": [
        {
            "id": "9c4d5349-9d3b-401f-86bb-021b7b3e5b81",
            "nodes": [
                {
                    "id": "0bfba841-a1e8-429c-aa8a-d98338339960",
                    "position": {
                        "x": 0,
                        "y": 0
                    },
                    "width": 200,
                    "twoColumn": false,
                    "interfaces": [
                        {
                            "name": "Exposed Name",
                            "id": "29cd9a27-2b49-4ae7-a164-a574c07fc684",
                            "direction": "input",
                            "side": "left",
                            "sidePosition": 0
                        }
                    ],
                    "subgraph": "569edd54-0f42-4c24-a809-1509febbe23a",
                    "name": "Test subgraph node #1"
                }
            ],
            "connections": []
        },
        {
            "id": "569edd54-0f42-4c24-a809-1509febbe23a",
            "nodes": [
                {
                    "id": "56910b7a-9fe9-4db1-9d19-71037711d718",
                    "position": {
                        "x": 871,
```

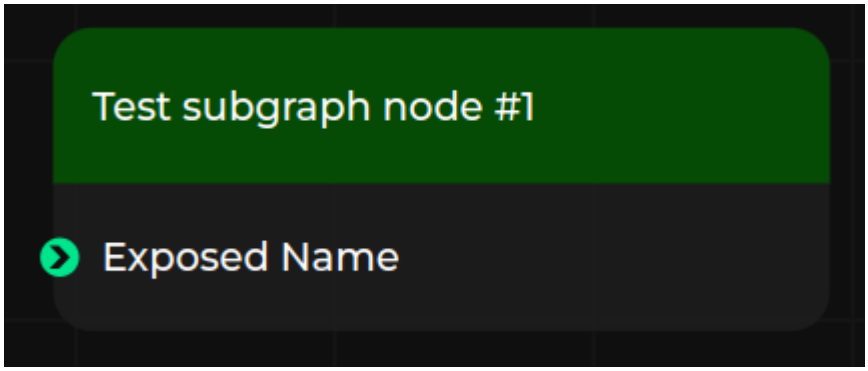
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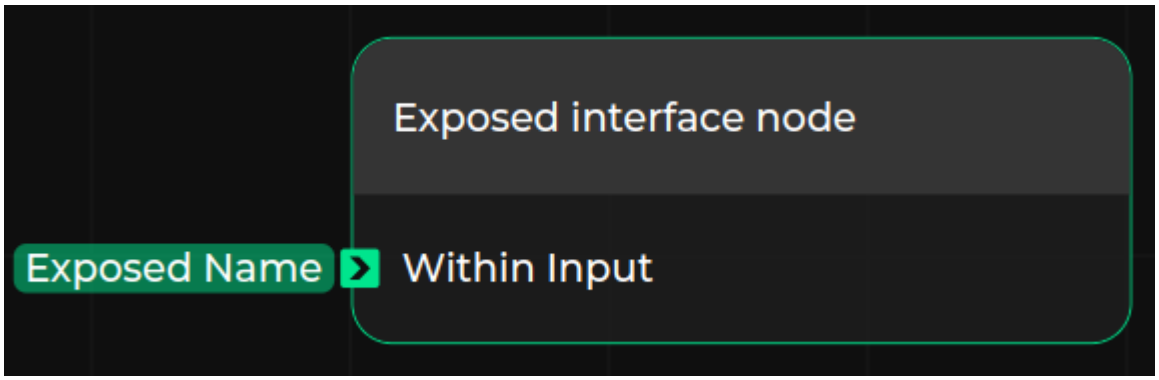

```
                        "y": 316
                    },
                    "width": 200,
                    "twoColumn": false,
                    "interfaces": [
                        {
                            "name": "Within Input",
                            "externalName": "Exposed Name",
                            "id": "29cd9a27-2b49-4ae7-a164-a574c07fc684",
                            "direction": "input",
                            "side": "left",
                            "sidePosition": 0
                        }
                    ],
                    "name": "Exposed interface node"
                }
            ],
            "connections": []
        }
    ],
    "entryGraph": "9c4d5349-9d3b-401f-86bb-021b7b3e5b81",
    "version": "20250623.14"
}
```


The example consists of two graphs. The first graph of id `9c4d5349-9d3b-401f-86bb-021b7b3e5b81` consists of a single graph node with an interface of id `29cd9a27-2b49-4ae7-a164-a574c07fc684`. The node represents a graph of id `569edd54-0f42-4c24-a809-1509febbe23a`, which is a graph with a single node with an interface of id `29cd9a27-2b49-4ae7-a164-a574c07fc684`. The interface of the graph node is exposed as `Exposed name` thanks to which it can be accessed from the outside of the graph. Because the interface is exposed, both of those interfaces have to have the same `id` and `direction` value.

Graph node:



Node within graph:



Connection

Object that describes a singular connection. It has three attributes:

- `id` - unique value assigned to the connection
- `from` - the connection's output interface id
- `to` - the connection's input interface id.
- `anchors` - optional list of *Anchor* objects.

Anchor

This object describes a single anchor that is used to render connections divided into subparts. Every part of the connection is rendered between two adjacent anchors. Two attributes are used:

- `x` - x coordinate of the anchor
- `y` - y coordinate of the anchor.

Group

This object describes a visual-only grouping of an arbitrary set of nodes in the same graph. It should be used for improving readability of the graph, where using a `subgraph` would not reduce complexity. It has two attributes:

- `color` - field defining a hexadecimal color that will be used as the collection background in the editor.
- `name` - name of the grouping that will be displayed above it.

Panning

This object describes the position of the top-left corner of the rendered editor in the browser. Defines the camera position in the editor space. Two attributes are used:

- `x` - x coordinate of the corner
- `y` - y coordinate of the corner.

Enabled Interface Groups

Each enabled interface group is described by the following properties:

- `name` - name of the interface group
- `direction` - value determining the type of the interfaces. Can be either `input`, `output` or `inout`.

> **Warning**
>
> Make sure that enabled interface groups use disjoint interfaces.

4.2 Example dataflow

The example dataflow for a specification defined in *Specification format* is defined as below:

```
{
    "graphs": [
        {
            "id": "2035108300",
            "nodes": [
                {
                    "name": "Filter2D",
                    "id": "node_168064109167511",
                    "position": {
                        "x": 544,
                        "y": 77
                    },
                    "width": 200,
                    "twoColumn": false,
                    "interfaces": [
                        {
                            "name": "image",
                            "id": "ni_168064109167612",
                            "direction": "input"
                        },
                        {
                            "name": "kernel",
                            "id": "ni_168064109167613",
                            "direction": "input"
                        },
                        {
                            "name": "output",
                            "id": "ni_168064109167714",
                            "direction": "output"
                        }
                    ],
                    "properties": [
                        {
                            "name": "iterations",
```

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```
                    "id": "8434027854",
                    "value": 1
                },
                {
                    "name": "border type",
                    "id": "7165552813",
                    "value": "constant"
                }
            ],
            "instanceName": "Filter"
        },
        {
            "name": "LoadVideo",
            "id": "node_168064220761015",
            "position": {
                "x": -60,
                "y": -36
            },
            "width": 200,
            "twoColumn": false,
            "interfaces": [
                {
                    "name": "frames",
                    "id": "ni_168064220761016",
                    "direction": "output"
                }
            ],
            "properties": [
                {
                    "name": "filename",
                    "id": "8887517324",
                    "value": "input.mp4"
                }
            ]
        },
        {
            "name": "GaussianKernel",
            "id": "node_168064222522321",
            "position": {
                "x": -65,
                "y": 295
            },
            "width": 200,
            "twoColumn": false,
            "interfaces": [
                {
                    "name": "kernel",
                    "id": "ni_168064222522422",
                    "direction": "output"
```

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```
                    }
                ],
                "properties": [
                    {
                        "name": "size",
                        "id": "1247863780",
                        "value": 5
                    },
                    {
                        "name": "sigma",
                        "id": "0187870808",
                        "value": 1
                    }
                ]
            },
            {
                "name": "Threshold",
                "id": "node_168064225320530",
                "position": {
                    "x": 999,
                    "y": 100
                },
                "width": 200,
                "twoColumn": false,
                "interfaces": [
                    {
                        "name": "image",
                        "id": "ni_168064225320531",
                        "direction": "input"
                    },
                    {
                        "name": "output",
                        "id": "ni_168064225320532",
                        "direction": "output"
                    }
                ],
                "properties": [
                    {
                        "name": "threshold_value",
                        "id": "8770324282",
                        "value": 1
                    },
                    {
                        "name": "threshold_type",
                        "id": "8305532648",
                        "value": "Otsu"
                    }
                ]
            },
```


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```
            {
                "name": "StructuringElement",
                "id": "node_168064227787336",
                "position": {
                    "x": 1010,
                    "y": 409
                },
                "width": 200,
                "twoColumn": false,
                "interfaces": [
                    {
                        "name": "kernel",
                        "id": "ni_168064227787437",
                        "direction": "output"
                    }
                ],
                "properties": [
                    {
                        "name": "size",
                        "id": "1587558664",
                        "value": 5
                    },
                    {
                        "name": "shape",
                        "id": "1375086555",
                        "value": "Cross"
                    }
                ]
            },
            {
                "name": "Morphological operation",
                "id": "node_168064228786538",
                "position": {
                    "x": 1422,
                    "y": 54
                },
                "width": 200,
                "twoColumn": false,
                "interfaces": [
                    {
                        "name": "image",
                        "id": "ni_168064228786539",
                        "direction": "input"
                    },
                    {
                        "name": "kernel",
                        "id": "ni_168064228786540",
                        "direction": "input"
                    },
```


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```
                    {
                        "name": "output",
                        "id": "ni_168064228786641",
                        "direction": "output"
                    }
                ],
                "properties": [
                    {
                        "name": "iterations",
                        "id": "0605526715",
                        "value": 1
                    },
                    {
                        "name": "border type",
                        "id": "2810748353",
                        "value": "constant"
                    },
                    {
                        "name": "operation type",
                        "id": "8413506138",
                        "value": "dilation"
                    }
                ]
            },
            {
                "name": "SaveVideo",
                "id": "node_168064231007448",
                "position": {
                    "x": 1773,
                    "y": 76
                },
                "width": 200,
                "twoColumn": false,
                "interfaces": [
                    {
                        "name": "color",
                        "id": "ni_168064231007449",
                        "direction": "input"
                    },
                    {
                        "name": "binary",
                        "id": "ni_168064231007450",
                        "direction": "input"
                    }
                ],
                "properties": [
                    {
                        "name": "filename",
                        "id": "3087244218",
```


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```
                        "value": "output.mp4"
                    }
                ]
            }
        ],
        "connections": [
            {
                "id": "168064222082820",
                "from": "ni_168064220761016",
                "to": "ni_168064109167612"
            },
            {
                "id": "168064222926625",
                "from": "ni_168064222522422",
                "to": "ni_168064109167613"
            },
            {
                "id": "168064225938335",
                "from": "ni_168064109167714",
                "to": "ni_168064225320531"
            },
            {
                "id": "168064230015344",
                "from": "ni_168064225320532",
                "to": "ni_168064228786539"
            },
            {
                "id": "168064230253147",
                "from": "ni_168064227787437",
                "to": "ni_168064228786540"
            },
            {
                "id": "168064231874053",
                "from": "ni_168064228786641",
                "to": "ni_168064231007450"
            }
        ]
        "panning": {
            "x": 0,
            "y": 0
        },
        "scaling": 1
    },
]
}
```

The highlighted bits of code represent all code fragments relevant to the `Filter2D` node. In the `nodes` list, there is a full specification of the state of the `Filter2D` node:

- Its unique `id`

- Its `name`
- Its parameters (stored in `parameters`), e.g. `border_type` equal to `constant`
- Its interfaces, with unique `id` representing each input and output
- Rendering data, such as `position` or `width`.

Later, in `connections`, you can see triples representing to which interfaces the interfaces of `Filter2D` are connected.

CHAPTER

FIVE

LAYOUTS

In Pipeline Manager it is possible to export active graph layout, without overhead in form of node definitions and metadata. It stores basic information about nodes position, style and underlying interfaces states.

5.1 Format description

The layout is stored in JSON file, which consists of entries like:

```
"<node-id>": {
        "position": {
            "x": 100,
            "y": -100
        },
        "style": "basic",
        "interfaces": {
            "<interface-name>": {
                "side": "right",
                "sidePosition": 0
            }
        }
    },
```

- `node-id` - id of node to which layout's data will be applied to id, it is in `UUIDv4` format
- `position` - it defines position of the node in the graph, defined in 2D `x` and `y` coordinates
- `style` - it is a name of the style that will be applied to a node. Multiple styles can be provided using array. More about node's *styles*
- `interfaces` - it is an entry defining states for node's interfaces
  - `interface-name` - a name of the interface that state will be applied to
  - `side` - a side of the interface
  - `sidePosition` - a position of the interface

5.2 Layout saving and loading

It is possible to save and load the layout of graph. After graph is selected in editor you can use `Save layout` or `Save layout as file as...` to save current graph to file, then you can load it using `Load layout` option in editor menu.

5.3 Layout and views

Layouts are compatible with views and it is possible to save and load layout into selected view. All it is necessary is just to select desired view in settings and then use `Save layout` and `Load layout` options.

5.4 Example layout

Part of the layout exported from `sample-specification` and `sample-dataflow` example.


```
{
    "f50b4f2a-a2e2-4409-a5c9-891a8de44a5b": {
        "position": {
            "x": 100,
            "y": -100
        },
        "interfaces": {
            "frames": {
                "side": "right",
                "sidePosition": 0
            }
        }
    },
    "3f16d8b0-8bf4-411c-9b61-286fde9035be": {
        "position": {
            "x": 100,
            "y": 200
        },
        "interfaces": {
            "kernel": {
                "side": "right",
                "sidePosition": 0
            }
        }
    },
    "75800d41-a534-4dae-9133-2fabb0c98e31": {
        "position": {
            "x": 600,
            "y": 0
        },
        "interfaces": {
            "kernel": {
                "side": "left",
                "sidePosition": 1
```


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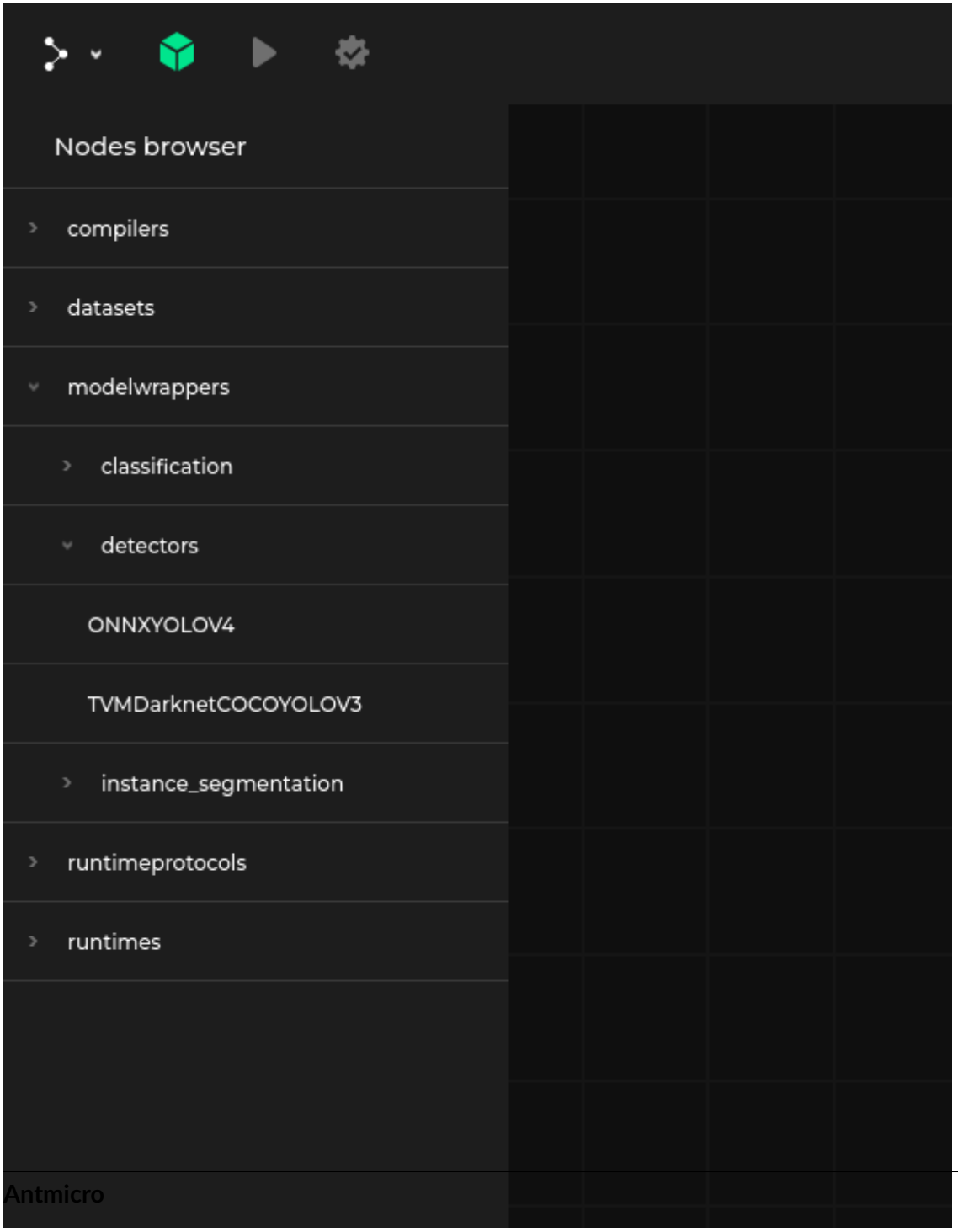
```
            },
            "input 1": {
                "side": "left",
                "sidePosition": 0
            },
            "output 1": {
                "side": "right",
                "sidePosition": 0
            }
        }
    }
}
```

CHAPTER

SIX

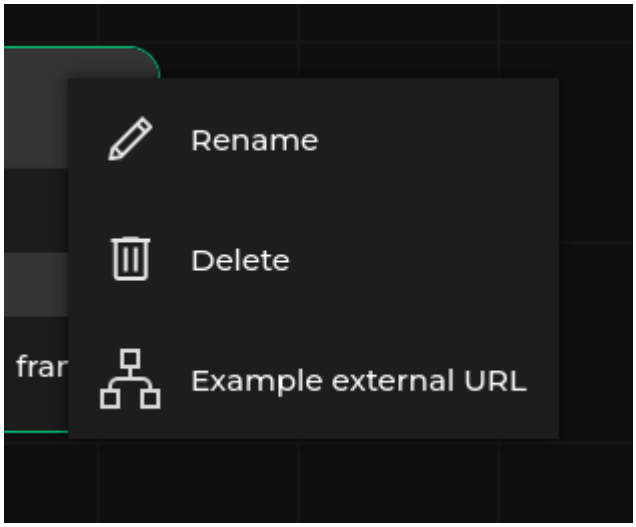
FRONT-END FEATURES

6.1 Graph manipulation



On the left side there is a node palette (which can be turned off or on using the green icon in the upper left corner). To add a new node to the graph, click the node in the palette and drag it to the editor. You can also select existing nodes and copy and paste them using `ctrl-c` and `ctrl-v` keyboard shortcuts.

After loading a specification, the palette will contain all the nodes defined in it and will be divided into hierarchical categories. Additionally, a graph node named `New Graph Node` is always available under a `Graphs` category and can be used to design custom graphs.



In the upper right corner of each node there is a context menu toggle. It contains the following options:

- `Rename` - Changes instanceName of the node. More details regarding node naming can be found in the *'instanceName' field of dataflow format*
- `Delete` - Deletes the node from the dataflow. Another way of deleting nodes is to select and press the `Delete` key.
- Additional, user defined URLs. More details in the *URL specification*

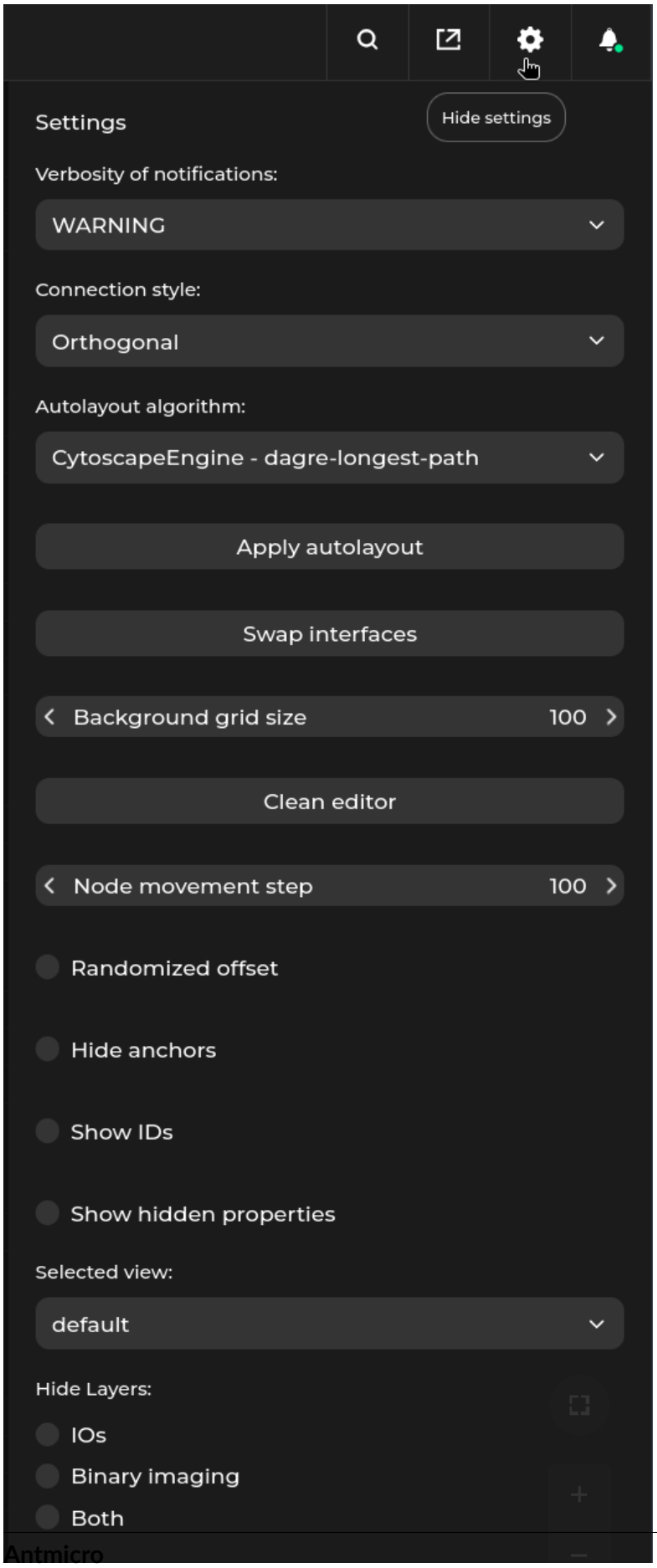
Scroll lets you to zoom in and out. Left-clicking and dragging the editor background allows you to move around the editor area.

Left-clicking on a node allows you to select and drag the node within the editor area. Pressing the `ctrl` key while moving a node allows you to align the node with another one along some axis.

To create a connection, left-click a node's connector and connect it to a connector (of a matching type, see *Specification format*) on another node. Double left-click on an existing connection removes it.

Clicking on a connection while pressing the `ctrl` key creates an anchor, which breaks up the connection into two parts, allowing to manually configure the layout. Right-clicking on an anchor removes it. Note that anchors can only be created when `Connection style` is set to `orthogonal` and the editor is not in read-only mode.

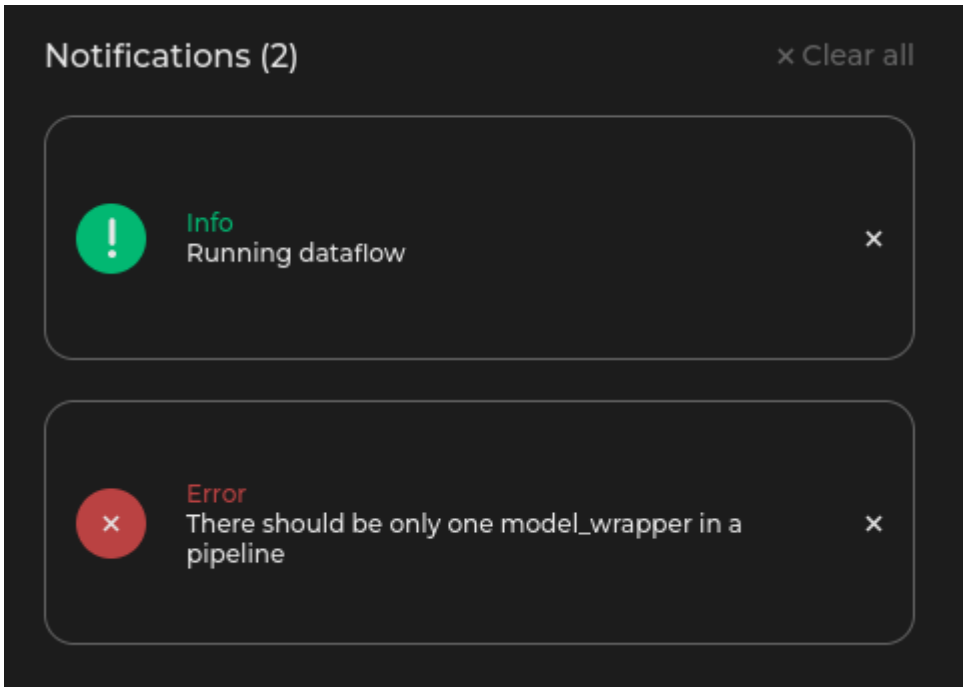
6.2 Settings


Settings
Hide settings
Verbosity of notifications:
WARNING
Connection style:
Orthogonal
Autolayout algorithm:
CytoscapeEngine - dagre-longest-path
Apply autolayout
Swap interfaces
Background grid size
100
Clean editor
Node movement step
100
Randomized offset
Hide anchors
Show IDs
Show hidden properties
Selected view:
default
Hide Layers:
IOs
Binary imaging
Both

On the upper right corner of Pipeline Manager window there is a gear icon toggling settings tab. In the tab the following options can be found:

- `Connection style` - Switch the style of the connection between `orthogonal` and `curved`
- `AutoLayout algorithm` - Choose the algorithm for automatic node placement. Autolayout algorithm is triggered in the following situations:
  - When loading the dataflow autolayout is used to place nodes without the `position` parameter set. Dataflow load can be triggered either via external application or choosing the `Load graph file` option. In this case autolayout is applied to both the main graph and the nodes in the subgraphs.
  - By pressing the `Apply autolayout` button in the settings tab. In this case autolayout is applied to the entire graph.
- `Background grid size` - Sets the size of single grid cell visible in the background
- `Node movement step` - Sets the minimum step size which can be taken along each axis when moving node.
- `Center` - Pressing this buttons moves the viewport to the center of graph and sets the zoom level so that whole dataflow is visible
- `Selected view` - If the graph representation has at least one alternative *view*, it can be selected here.
- `Hide layers` - *Metadata* allows to specify layers for a certain set of interface types and connections. Toggling this checkbox allows to hide connections belonging to said layer
- `Modify node types` - Toggling this checkbox allows editing existing nodes and adding new node types to the specification
- `Hide anchors` - Hides anchors in all connections. The anchors are still visible (and can be edited) when hovering over the connection

6.3 Notifications

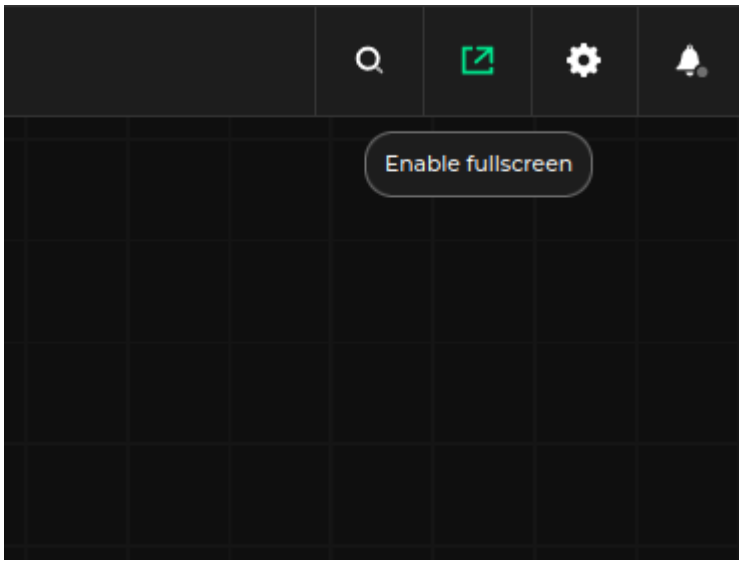


Pipeline Manager provides notifications describing errors occurring in:

- The front end, such as invalid input specification, or invalid dataflow
- The back end (see *Communication with an external application*)

During pipeline development or execution, notifications can display various messages to the user.

6.4 Full screen

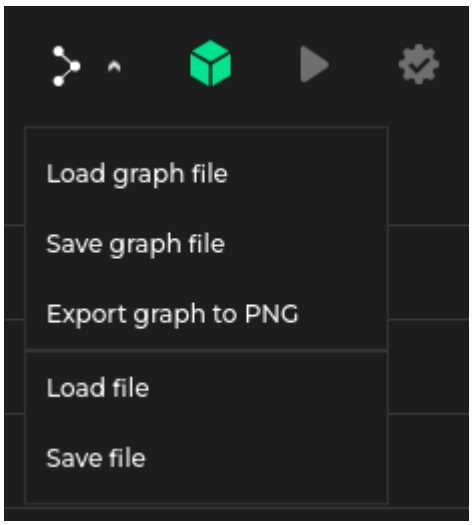


Near the settings tab, there is a full screen icon. Clicking it will expand the Pipeline Manager window to full screen. Note that this feature may be disabled during embedding Pipeline Manager in an external application, make sure to allow full screen mode.

For example, in the case of embedding Pipeline Manager in an iframe, the `allow="fullscreen"` attribute must be set:

```
<iframe src="https://url" allow="fullscreen">
  <p>Your browser does not support iframes.</p>
</iframe>
```

6.5 Editor menu



Depending the application's mode (`static-html` or `server-app`), the following options will be available in the Pipeline Manager menu:

- `Load specification` - lets the user load a specification file describing the nodes that can appear in the graph (see *Specification format*)

> **Note**
>
> It appears only in the `static-html` build mode, where a specification is not delivered by a third-party app.

- `Load graph file` - lets the user load a graph specification in Pipeline Manager's internal format (see *Dataflow specification*).
- `Save graph file` - Saves the graph currently stored in the editor into JSON using Pipeline Manager's internal format.
- `Export graph to PNG` - Saves the graph currently stored in the editor as PNG image
- `Load file` - lets the user load a file describing a graph in the native format supported by the third-party application using Pipeline Manager for visualization.

> **Note**
>
> It appears only in the `server-app` build mode, since the third-party app performs conversion from its native format to the *Dataflow format*

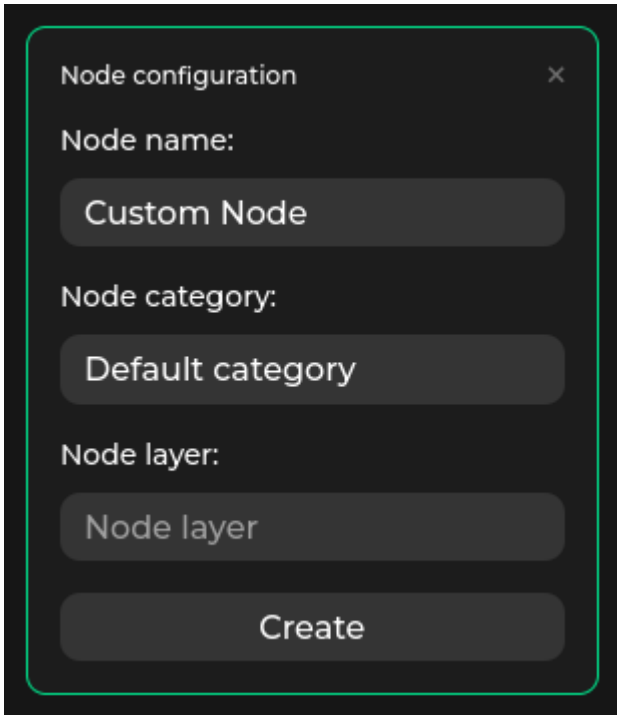
- `Save file` - saves the current graph in a native format supported by the third-party application using Pipeline Manager for visualization.

> **Note**
>
> It appears only in the `server-app` build mode, since the third-party app performs conversion from the *Dataflow format* received from the editor to its native format.

6.6 Creating new node types

After toggling the `Modify nodes types` checkbox in settings, the special `New Node Type` becomes available in the node palette.

Drag and drop it to the editor to display the `Node configuration menu`.



After the node is created, it will be added to the editor and available in the node palette.

The node type can be configured further from the editor, e.g. by adding properties and interfaces.

6.7 Working with the server

When Pipeline Manager works in the `server-app` mode, it is connected to an external application, making it possible to manipulate or execute a graph as well as save and load files in the application's native format.



Status of the connection is displayed in the upper right corner of the editor. The color of the icon indicates the status of the connection with the server:

- `Red` - No connection with the server.
- `Green` - Connection with the server is established.

External application may deliver additional features by providing additional buttons in the editor menu. More details can be found in the *Specification format* section.

6.8 URL parameters for the frontend

The frontend of Pipeline Manager provides a set of URL parameters that can be used to change the specification, graph or default behavior of the application. Those arguments need to be encoded - we need to escape all URL-specific characters. This can be achieved either with `urllib.parse.urlencode` in Python:

```
import urllib.parse

urllib.parse.urlencode({
    "spec": "https://github.com/antmicro/kenning-pipeline-manager/blob/main/
↪examples/sample-specification.json",
    "graph": "https://github.com/antmicro/kenning-pipeline-manager/blob/main/
↪examples/sample-dataflow.json"
})

# RESULT: 'spec=https%3A%2F%2Fgithub.com%2Fantmicro%2Fkenning-pipeline-manager
↪%2Fblob%2Fmain%2Fexamples%2Fsample-specification.json&graph=https%3A%2F
↪%2Fgithub.com%2Fantmicro%2Fkenning-pipeline-manager%2Fblob%2Fmain%2Fexamples
↪%2Fsample-dataflow.json'
```

or with `encodeURIComponent` in Javascript:

```
encodeURIComponent("https://github.com/antmicro/kenning-pipeline-manager/blob/
↪main/examples/sample-specification.json")

// RESULT: 'https%3A%2F%2Fgithub.com%2Fantmicro%2Fkenning-pipeline-manager%2Fblob
↪%2Fmain%2Fexamples%2Fsample-specification.json'
```

Available parameters are as follows:

- `spec` - URL to the specification, by default it can be a HTTP/HTTPS URL,
- `graph` - URL to the graph, by default it can be a HTTP/HTTPS URL,
- `preview` - starts Pipeline Manager in read only mode, without HUD,
- `include` - allows to provide includes for the specification,
- `backend` - connects Pipeline Manager to the specified backend regardless of the application mode.
- `center_at_top` - determines whether to center the editor at the topmost node after loading.

When it comes to `spec` and `graph`, by default we can use following URI schemes:

- `http://`, `https://`
- `relative://` - picks a path relative to the Pipeline Manager URL
- `data:application`, or `data:application;base64`, - JSON embedded as Data URL

To add more URI schemes, we need to define `VUE_APP_JSON_URL_SUBSTITUTES` variable holding a dictionary mapping scheme name to appropriate template/prefix.

The JSON for URL substitutes can look as follows:

```
{
    "examples": "https://github.com/antmicro/kenning-pipeline-manager/examples/{}"
}
```

And be later be referred to as `examples://sample-specification.json` in URL.

Note

The URI schemes can be passed to `pipeline_manager build` via `--json_url_specification` argument.

6.9 External frontend

These features are available for websites that embed Pipeline Manager using `iframe`. POST requests are used as a communication channel.

The usage example can be found in pipeline_manager/frontend_tester/tester_api/index.html (see README for build instructions). You can check a deployed instance in Frontend-to-Frontend demo.

6.9.1 Making API requests

There is a possibility to call Pipeline Manager *API* from the frontend level.

```
let iframe;

window.addEventListener('load', () => {
    iframe = document.getElementById(pipelineManagerIframe);
});

window.addEventListener('message', (event) => {
    // handling responses from Pipeline Manager
    const response = JSON.stringify(event.data, null, 4);
    console.log(response);
});

// sending specification_change request to Pipeline Manager's iframe
iframe.contentWindow.postMessage({ method: 'specification_change', params: {␣
↪specification } });
```

This piece of code opens Pipeline Manager in an iframe and provides it with a JSON object containing the request body corresponding to a `specification_change` *frontend endpoint*. Note that

this method also supports *backend endpoints* and *external app endpoints* if external application is attached to Pipeline Manager.

Check *External Frontend Communication* for more details.

6.9.2 Serving External Application

A wrapping website may implement *External Application*, e.g.:

```
let iframe;

window.addEventListener('load', () => {
    iframe = document.getElementById(pipelineManagerIframe);
    iframe = iframe.contentWindow.postMessage({ method: 'register_external_
↪frontend' });
});

window.addEventListener('message', (event) => {
    const { data } = event;
    if (data.method !== undefined) {
        const result = handleExternalAppRequest(data);
        iframe.contentWindow.postMessage({ id: data.id, result });
    } else {
        handleResponse(data);
    }
});
```

Here, the code registers the website as an external application, and then sets up the listener for processing corresponding requests and responses.

Check *External Frontend Application* for more details.

6.10 Testing the front-end features

The best way to test the front-end features is to use the `pipeline_manager.frontend_tester.tester_client`, *Third-party server example*.

CHAPTER

SEVEN

COMMUNICATION WITH AN EXTERNAL APPLICATION

The communication with an external application is based on JSON-RPC messages.

Pipeline Manager supports two ways of defining external application:

- *External Backend Application*
- *External Frontend Application*

7.1 Communication protocol

The application layer protocol specifies two blocks:

- `size` - four first bytes form an unsigned integer and tell the size of the content of the message in bytes.
- `content` - the rest of the message holding additional data in JSON-RPC format described in *API Specification*.

The `size` and `content` are stored in big-endian.

7.1.1 External Backend Application

This is a core concept of `server-app` Pipeline Manager mode.

Pipeline Manager implements a TCP server that is listening on a specified port and waiting for the client to connect. Pipeline Manager frontend sends JSON-RPC requests to this server through SocketIO, which redirects messages to connected client for specific actions described in this chapter. External application can also request actions from Pipeline Manager in similar manner.

Frontend / Backend / External application

By default, Pipeline Manager will wait for an external application to connect and then request the specification. If the connection is established successfully, Pipeline Manager frontend will check if external application is still connected every 0.5 second. Apart from that, both Pipeline Manager frontend and external application can send requests which pass through Pipeline Manager backend.

```
sequenceDiagram
    Note over Frontend,Backend: Pipeline Manager (SocketIO)
    Note over External App: Pipeline Manager Backend Communication
    Frontend-> > Backend: status_get
    Backend-> > Frontend: status
    Frontend-> > +Backend: external_app_connect
    Note over Backend,External App: BSD socket
    External App-> > Backend: connect_socket
    Backend-> > -Frontend: MessageType.OK
    Frontend-> > +Backend: specification_get
    Backend-> > External App: specification_get
    External App-> > Backend: specification
    Backend-> > -Frontend: MessageType.OK + specification
    loop Every 0.5s
        Frontend-> > Backend: status_get
        Backend-> > Frontend: status
    end
    par External App API
        Frontend-> > +Backend: request
        Backend-> > +External App: redirected request
        External App-> > -Backend: response
        Backend-> > -Frontend: redirected response
    and Frontend API
        External App-> > +Backend: request
        Backend-> > +Frontend: redirected request
        Frontend-> > -Backend: response
        Backend-> > -External App: redirected response
    end
```

As Pipeline Manager part of communication is done with SocketIO, it is based on events, which are precisely defined for both sides and can trigger different actions.

Frontend listens to:

- **api** – received messages are JSON-RPC requests, they are validated with *specification*, executed and generated responds are resend,
- **api-response** – received messages are JSON-RPC responses, they are also validated and returned as result of previous request.

Backend implements the following events:

- **backend-api** – receives all JSON-RPC requests, runs methods and responds,
- **external-api** – redirects messages to external application through BSD socket.

On the other hand, communication between backend and external application is done through BSD socket. To manage this, both sides run socket listener as separate coroutine task, which waits for messages and responds or redirects them.

External Frontend / Pipeline Manager

If the Pipeline Manager is wrapped with another frontend (see *Frontend Features* for details), the communication can be established with POST requests.

```
sequenceDiagram
    Note over External Frontend,Frontend: postMessage
    par Frontend API
        External Frontend-> > Frontend: request
        Frontend-> > External Frontend: response
    and Backend/External API
        External Frontend-> > +Frontend: request
        Note over Frontend,Backend & External App: Pipeline Manager (SocketIO)
        Frontend-> > +Backend & External App: redirected request
        Backend & External App-> > -Frontend: response
        Frontend-> > -External Frontend: redirected response
    end
```

Request structure

Following communication structure diagram below, we have:

- blue lines describing *Backend API* request from frontend,
- red lines describing *External App API* request from frontend,
- purple lines describing *Frontend API* request from external application.

```
C4Deployment
    Deployment_Node(cf, "External Frontend", "") {
        Container(external-post-message, "postMessage")
    }
    Deployment_Node(pm, "Pipeline Manager", "") {
        Deployment_Node(front, "Frontend", "") {
            Container(front-post-message, "postMessage")
            Deployment_Node(socketio, "SocketIO", "") {
                Container(front-socket, "SocketIO")
                Deployment_Node(front-event, "Events", "") {
                    Container(front-api, "api")
                    Container(front-response-api, "api-response")
                }
            }
        }
        Deployment_Node(back, "Backend", "") {
            Deployment_Node(flask, "Python-SocketIO events", "") {
                Container(flask-backend-api, "backend-api")
                Container(flask-external-api, "external-api")
            }
            Deployment_Node(flask-task, "Coroutine task", "") {
                Container(back-socket, "BSD socket listener")
            }
        }
    }
    Deployment_Node(pmbc, "Pipeline Manager Backend Communication", "") {
        Deployment_Node(pmbc-socket, "Socket", "") {
            Container(pmbc-socket, "BSD socket")
            Deployment_Node(pmbc-task, "Coroutine task", "") {
                Container(pmbc-listener, "BSD socket listener")
            }
        }
    }
    %% frontend to frontend
    BiRel(external-post-message, front-post-message, "JSON-RPC requests and␣
frontend responses")
    Rel(front-post-message, front-socket, "Redirected requests")
    Rel(front-response-api, external-post-message, "Redirected responses")
    UpdateRelStyle(external-post-message, front-post-message, $offsetX="-55",␣
$offsetY="-30")
    UpdateRelStyle(front-post-message, front-socket, front-post-message,␣
$offsetX="-55", $offsetY="-30")
    %% frontend to backend request
    Rel(front-socket, flask-backend-api, "JSON-RPC request")
    Rel(flask-backend-api, front-response-api, "JSON-RPC response")
    UpdateRelStyle(front-socket, flask-backend-api,␣
$lineColor="var(--md-code-hl-keyword-color)",␣
$textColor="var(--md-code-hl-keyword-color)", $offsetY="-15")
    UpdateRelStyle(flask-backend-api, front-response-api,␣
$lineColor="var(--md-code-hl-keyword-color)",␣
```

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```
$textColor="var(--md-code-hl-keyword-color)", $offsetX="-50", $offsetY="55")
    %% frontend to external app request
    Rel(front-socket, flask-external-api, "JSON-RPC request")
    Rel(flask-external-api, pmbc-listener, "Redirected requests and responses")
    Rel(pmbc-listener, back-socket, "JSON-RPC response")
    Rel(back-socket, front-response-api, "Redirected response")
    UpdateRelStyle(front-socket, flask-external-api,␣
$lineColor="var(--md-code-hl-number-color)",␣
$textColor="var(--md-code-hl-number-color)")
    UpdateRelStyle(flask-external-api, pmbc-listener,␣
$lineColor="var(--md-code-hl-name-color)",␣
$textColor="var(--md-code-hl-name-color)", $offsetX="-10", $offsetY="-10")
    UpdateRelStyle(pmbc-listener, back-socket,␣
$lineColor="var(--md-code-hl-number-color)",␣
$textColor="var(--md-code-hl-number-color)", $offsetX="25", $offsetY="-25")
    UpdateRelStyle(back-socket, front-response-api,␣
$lineColor="var(--md-code-hl-number-color)",␣
$textColor="var(--md-code-hl-number-color)", $offsetX="-10", $offsetY="20")
    %% external app to frontend request
    Rel(pmbc-socket, back-socket, "JSON-RPC request")
    Rel(back-socket, front-api, "Redirected request")
    Rel(front-api, flask-external-api, "JSON-RPC response")
    Rel(pmbc-listener, pmbc-socket, "Received response")
    UpdateRelStyle(pmbc-socket, back-socket,␣
$textColor="var(--md-code-hl-function-color)",␣
$lineColor="var(--md-code-hl-function-color)", $offsetX="-10", $offsetY="15")
    UpdateRelStyle(back-socket, front-api,␣
$textColor="var(--md-code-hl-function-color)",␣
$lineColor="var(--md-code-hl-function-color)", $offsetX="45")
    UpdateRelStyle(front-api, flask-external-api,␣
$textColor="var(--md-code-hl-function-color)",␣
$lineColor="var(--md-code-hl-function-color)", $offsetX="-65", $offsetY="-30")
    UpdateRelStyle(pmbc-listener, pmbc-socket,␣
$textColor="var(--md-code-hl-function-color)",␣
$lineColor="var(--md-code-hl-function-color)", $offsetX="5", $offsetY="-30")
    UpdateLayoutConfig($c4ShapeInRow="1", $c4BoundaryInRow="3")
```

7.1.2 External Frontend Application

If the Pipeline Manager is used as an `iframe`, a website that wraps it can implement an *External Application*.

Similarly to *External Frontend Communication*, data transfer relies on POST requests: both requests and responses use MessageEvent (see *Frontend Features* for details).

This application type can be enabled dynamically via dedicated `register_external_frontend` *Frontend API* request. This is possible for both `static-html` and `server-app` modes. Currently, in the latter case, external backend application will be overridden with the frontend one.

Request structure

```
sequenceDiagram
    Note over External Frontend,Pipeline Manager Frontend: postMessage
    par Frontend API
        External Frontend-> > Pipeline Manager Frontend: request
        Pipeline Manager Frontend-> > External Frontend: response
    and External API
        Pipeline Manager Frontend-> > External Frontend: request
        External Frontend-> > Pipeline Manager Frontend: response
    end
```

7.2 Response messages types - sent by the external application

7.2.1 OK

Message of `type` `OK` (0) is used to indicate a success and optionally includes an answer to a previous request. Its `content` may vary depending on the request type.

7.2.2 ERROR

Message of `type` `ERROR` (1) is used to indicate a failure and optionally includes an answer to a previous request. Its `content` may vary depending on the answered request.

7.2.3 PROGRESS

Message of optional `type` `PROGRESS` (2) is used to inform Pipeline Manager about the status of a running dataflow. The `PROGRESS` message type can only be used once a message of type `RUN` is received and can be sent multiple times before sending a final response message of type either `ERROR` or `OK` that indicates the end of the run. The progress information is conveyed in `content` using a number ranging `0 - 100` encoded in UTF-8 that signals the percentage of completion of the run. See *RUN* for more information.

7.2.4 WARNING

Message of `type` `WARNING` (3) is used to indicate a success but also alerts of a condition that might cause a problem in the future. It optionally includes an answer to a previous request. Its `content` may vary depending on the answered request.

7.3 API Specification

7.3.1 Frontend API

frontend_status_get

Returns status of the frontend

- **`params`**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **`result`** *(object)*: Description of frontend status. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **`status`** *(string, required)*: Status.

frontend_specification_get

Returns specification used by frontend

- **params** *(object)*: Parameters for specification request. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **graph** *(boolean)*: Specifies whether graph should be returned along with the specification. Default: `false`.
  - **minify** *(boolean)*: Specifies whether the returned specification should be minified. Default: `false`.
- **result**: Refer to specification_object.

open_dialog_request

Request opening dialog box by frontend.

- **params** *(object)*: Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **title** *(string, required)*: Name of the dialog box.
  - **wait** *(boolean)*: Wait for data from dialog box. Default: `false`.
- **result**: Refer to dialog_box_output.

graph_get

Returns dataflow used by frontend

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **result**: Refer to dataflow_object.

node_get

Procedure to read node state

- **params**
  - **All of**
    - : Refer to node_object.
- **result** *(object)*: Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **node** *(object, required)*: State of the node.

properties_get

Procedure to alter values of a node

- **params** *(object)*: Cannot contain unevaluated properties.
  - **All of**
    - : Refer to node_object.
  - **properties** *([array, null])*: Properties which values are going to be read specified by either a name of id. If undefined then all properties are returned.
    - **Items** *(object)*

        - **One of**
            - *object*: Cannot contain additional properties.
                - **`id`** *(string, required)*: Id of the property to read.
            - *object*: Cannot contain additional properties.
                - **`name`** *(string, required)*: Name of the property to read.

- **`result`** *(array)*
    - **Items** *(object)*: Values of the searched properties. Cannot contain additional properties.
        - **`id`** *(string, required)*: Id of the property.
        - **`name`** *(string, required)*: Name of the property.
        - **`value`**: Value of the property. Its type depends on the property.

properties_change

Procedure to alter properties of a node

- **`params`**: Refer to properties_diff.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

interfaces_change

Procedure to alter interfaces of a node

- **`params`**: Refer to interfaces_diff.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

name_change

Procedure to alter the name of the node.

- **`params`**: Refer to name_diff.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

position_change

Procedure to alter position of a node

- **`params`**: Refer to position_diff.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

nodes_change

Procedure to add and delete nodes

- **`params`**: Refer to nodes_diff.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

connections_change

Procedure to add and delete connections

- **params**: Refer to connections_diff.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

graph_change

Procedure to add and delete nodes

- **params** *(object)*: Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **dataflow**: Refer to dataflow_or_url.
  - **loadingScreen**: Refer to loadingScreen.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

progress_change

Notification with progress of job ran by external application

- **params** *(object)*: Parameters for notification. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **method** *(string, required)*: Name of the method used to run the job.
  - **progress** *(number, required)*: Progress of job ran be external application. If between 0 and 100 progress will be set and if -1, animation will ran.

metadata_change

Updates the editor's metadata

- **params**: Refer to metadata.

viewport_center

Center the editor

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.

terminal_add

Create new terminal instance

- **params** *(object)*: Parameters for request.
  - **name** *(string, required)*: Unique name for the new terminal instance. This name is used for any communication.
  - **readonly** *(boolean)*: Specifies whether the terminal should be read-only, or editable by user. Default: `true`.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

terminal_remove

Create new terminal instance

- **params** *(object)*: Parameters for request.
  - **name** *(string, required)*: Name of the terminal to remove.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

terminal_write

Writes a message line to a terminal instance. Allows to send both text and hterm's control sequences. For more details on available control sequences check hterm Control Sequences.

> **Warning**
>
> Since data is sent in JSON format, the hexadecimal values need to be escaped with `\u`, not `\x`, e.g. `\u001b[38:2:238:178:17mexample`.

- **params** *(object)*: Parameters for request.
  - **name** *(string, required)*: Name of the terminal to which the message is written.
  - **message** *(string, required)*: Message to be written to the terminal.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

terminal_clear

Clears a terminal with a given name

- **params** *(object)*
  - **name** *(string)*: Name of the terminal to clear. If the name is not provided, the main terminal is cleared.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

terminal_hide

Hides a terminal panel

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

terminal_show

- **params** *(object)*: Parameters for request.
  - **name** *(string)*: Name of the terminal to show. If the name is not provided, the main terminal is chosen.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

terminal_view

Configures the layout of the terminal panel

- **`params`** *(object)*: Parameters for request.
  - **`names`** *(array)*: Names of the terminal to show. If the parameter is empty, then the terminal view is unmodified.
    - **Items** *(string)*: Name of the terminal.
  - **`clearButton`** *(boolean)*: Specifies whether to 'Clear terminal' button should be displayed. If not specified, the state of the clear button is not modified.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

terminal_get_instances

Configures the layout of the terminal panel

- **`params`**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **`result`** *(array)*: Existing terminals.
  - **Items** *(string)*: Name of the terminal.

notification_send

Sends a notification to the frontend. It will display the message both in the notifications and in the default terminal

- **`params`** *(object)*: Parameters for notification.
  - **`type`**: Type of the notification. Must be one of: `["error", "warning", "info"]`.
  - **`title`** *(string, required)*: Title of the notification, appearing both in the terminal and notification.
  - **`details`** *(string, required)*: Details of the notification, displayed only in the terminal.
  - **`timestamp`** *(string)*: Notification timestamp, if not provided, timestamp will be automatically generated (pass non-null falsy value to disable).
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

specification_change

Procedure to update specification

- **`params`** *(object)*
  - **`specification`**: Refer to specification_or_url.
  - **`urloverrides`**: Refer to urloverrides.
  - **`loadingScreen`**: Refer to loadingScreen.
  - **`tryMinify`**: Refer to tryMinify.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

specification_graph_change

Procedure to update specification and dataflow

- **params** *(object)*: Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **specification**: Refer to specification_or_url.
  - **dataflow**: Refer to dataflow_or_url.
  - **urloverrides**: Refer to urloverrides.
  - **loadingScreen**: Refer to loadingScreen.
  - **tryMinify**: Refer to tryMinify.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

specification_preprocess

Handles preprocessor specification directives

- **params** *(object)*
  - **specification**: Refer to specification.
  - **unmarkNewNodes** *(boolean)*: Decides whether to remove built-in style of new nodes from specification.
  - **urloverrides**: Refer to urloverrides.
  - **tryMinify**: Refer to tryMinify.
- **result**
  - **Any of**
    - : Refer to specification_object.
    - : Refer to null_or_empty.

specification_expand

- **params** *(object)*
  - **specification**: Refer to specification.
- **result**: Refer to specification_object.

nodes_highlight

Procedure to highlight specified nodes in the editor

- **params**: Refer to highlight_diff.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

register_external_frontend

Register external frontend in the Pipeline Manager frontend, available only through 'postMessage' interface

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.

- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

return_from_subgraph

Returns from subgraph if currently in one

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **result** *(object)*: Specifies whether the editor was in subgraph and returned. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **has_returned** *(boolean, required)*: Has returned from subgraph.

7.3.2 Backend API

status_get

Returns status of connection with external application

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **result** *(object)*: Description of backend status. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **status** *(object, required)*: Status. Cannot contain additional properties.
    - **connected** *(boolean, required)*: Connection with external application.

external_app_connect

Request to wait till connection with external application is established

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **result**: Refer to empty.

connected_frontends_get

Request the number of connected fronteds

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **result** *(object)*: Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **connections** *(number, required)*: Number of connections.

7.3.3 External App API

specification_get

Request specification used by external application

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **result**: Refer to external_endpoint_return_type.

app_capabilities_get

Request external application capabilities

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **result**: Refer to navbar_items.

dialog_boxes_get

Request external application dialog boxes

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **result**: Refer to dialog_boxes.

dataflow_import

Request to convert dataflow in external app to Pipeline Manager format and import it

- **params** *(object)*: Parameters for request. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **external_application_dataflow** *(string, required)*: Dataflow in external application format. If loaded file cannot be represented as text, it will be sent as base64 string. To make sure received data are in readable format `convert_message_to_string` from `pipeline_manager_backend_communication.utils` can be used. Optionally, for conversion to bytes `convert_message_to_bytes` function is available.
  - **mime** *(string, required)*: MIME type.
  - **base64** *(boolean, required)*: Specifies whether `external_application_dataflow` is in byte64 format.
- **result**: Refer to external_endpoint_return_type.

dataflow_validate

Request external application to validate dataflow

- **params**: Refer to dataflow_object.
- **result**: Refer to external_endpoint_return_type.

dataflow_run

Request external application to run dataflow

- **params**: Refer to dataflow_object.
- **result**: Refer to external_endpoint_return_type.

dataflow_stop

Request external application to run dataflow

- **params** *(object)*: Parameters for stopping dataflow. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **method** *(string, required)*: Name of the method used to start run.
- **result**: Refer to external_endpoint_return_type.

dataflow_export

Request external application to export dataflow

- **params**: Refer to dataflow_object.
- **result** *(object)*: Common type returned by external app. Cannot contain additional properties.

  - **type** *(number, required)*: *MessageType* specifying success or error.
  - **content** *([object, string])*: Exported dataflow, which is then saved by the frontend user. Should be either a json object, or a base64 encoded string. If any error occurred then it should contain a proper message.
  - **filename** *(string)*: Suggested filename used to save the file.

frontend_on_connect

Request sent when Pipeline Manager frontend connects to backend and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **params**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

properties_on_change

Request sent when properties of any node change and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **params**: Refer to properties_diff.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

interfaces_on_change

Request sent when interface of any node changes and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **params**: Refer to interfaces_diff.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

name_on_change

Request sent when node name was changed and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **params**: Refer to name_diff.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

position_on_change

Request sent when position of any node changes and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **params**: Refer to position_diff.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

nodes_on_change

Request sent when node was added or deleted and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **params**: Refer to nodes_diff.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

connections_on_change

Request sent when connection was added or deleted and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **`params`**: Refer to connections_diff.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

graph_on_change

Request sent when whole dataflow changed, e.g. when dataflow is loaded, and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **`params`**: Refer to dataflow_object.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

specification_on_change

Request sent when whole specification changed, e.g. when node type is modified, and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **`params`**: Refer to specification_object.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

metadata_on_change

Request sent when metadata was changed, and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **`params`**: Refer to metadata.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

viewport_on_center

Request sent when editor was centered and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **`params`**: Refer to null_or_empty.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

user_dialog_read

Request sent by the frontend when custom user dialog is closed

- **`params`**: Refer to dialog_box_output.
- **`result`**: Refer to null_or_empty.

terminal_read

Request sent by the frontend when terminal received an input

- **`params`** *(object)*: Parameters for request.
  - **`name`** *(string, required)*: Name of the terminal to which the message was written. Terminal has to be not read-only.

  - **message** *(string, required)*: Terminal input.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

nodes_on_highlight

Request sent when node was either selected or unselected and `notifyWhenChanged` option is enabled in the metadata section of specification.

- **params**: Refer to highlight_diff.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

button_click

Request send when button node property was pressed

- **params** *(object)*: Parameters for request.
  - **id** *(string, required)*: ID of the property.
  - **value** *([object, null], required)*: Value of the property.
- **result**: Refer to null_or_empty.

7.3.4 Common Types

empty

- *object*: Empty object definition. Cannot contain additional properties.

null_or_empty

- *[object, null]*: Empty or missing object definition. Cannot contain additional properties.

dialog_box_template

- *object*: A template that defines dialog box inputs.
  - **name** *(string, required)*: A title of the input visible to a user.
  - **type**: A type of the input. Must be one of: `["text", "number", "int", "bool"]`.
  - **default** *([string, number, boolean])*: A default value of the input.
  - **min** *(number)*: A minimal value for numerical types.
  - **max** *(number)*: A maximum value for numerical types.

dialog_box

- *object*: Schema that defines dialog box template.
  - **title** *(string)*: Title of the dialog box.
  - **confirmText** *(string)*: Name of confirmation button.
  - **template** *(object)*: A template of the dialog box.
    - **All of**
      - : Refer to dialog_box_template.

dialog_boxes

- *object*: Schema that defines dialog boxes template.
  - **All of**
    - `*` : Refer to dialog_box.

dialog_box_output

- *object*: Parameters for request.
  - **`data`** *(object, required)*: Data read by user dialog.
  - **`msg`** *(string)*: Optional message with request status.

node_object

- *object*: Schema that identifies a node in a graph.
  - **`graph_id`** *(string, required)*: Id of the graph.
  - **`node_id`** *(string, required)*: Id of the node.

urloverrides

- *object*: Override metadata URLs in provided specification.
  - **`^.*$`** *(string)*

loadingScreen

- *boolean*: Show loading screen. Default: `false`.

tryMinify

- *boolean*: Try to minify specification if a dataflow or entry graph is provided. Default: `false`.

dataflow_or_url

- *[object, string]*: JSON or link to the remote JSON with graph definition.

dataflow_object

- *object*: Definition containing `dataflow` object. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **`dataflow`** *(object)*: JSON with graph definition in PM format.

specification

- *object*: JSON with specification definition in PM format.

specification_or_url

- *[object, string]*: JSON or link to the remote JSON with specification.

specification_object

- *object*: Definition containing `specification` object. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **`specification`**: Refer to specification.

properties_diff

- *object*: Schema that represents differences in properties of the node. Cannot contain unevaluated properties.
  - **All of**
    - : Refer to node_object.
  - **`properties`** *(array, required)*: Properties to change specified by either a name or id.
    - **Items** *(object)*
      - **One of**
        - *object*: Cannot contain additional properties.
          - **`id`** *(string, required)*: Id of the property to alter.
          - **`new_value`**: New value of the property.
        - *object*: Cannot contain additional properties.
          - **`name`** *(string, required)*: Name of the property to alter.
          - **`new_value`**: New value of the property.

interfaces_diff

- *object*: Schema that represents differences in interfaces of the node. Cannot contain unevaluated properties.
  - **All of**
    - : Refer to node_object.
  - **`interfaces`** *(array, required)*: Interfaces to change specified by either a name or id.
    - **Items** *(object)*
      - **One of**
        - *object*: Cannot contain additional properties.
          - **`id`** *(string, required)*: Id of the interface to alter.
          - **`externalName`** *(string)*: New external name of the interface.
        - *object*: Cannot contain additional properties.
          - **`name`** *(string, required)*: Name of the interface to alter.
          - **`externalName`** *(string)*: New external name of the interface.

name_diff

- *object*: Schema that represent differences in title change. Cannot contain unevaluated properties.
  - **All of**
    - : Refer to node_object.
  - **`name`** *(string, required)*: Name of the node to change.

position_diff

- *object*: Schema that represent differences in position of the node. Cannot contain unevaluated properties.
  - **All of**
    - : Refer to node_object.
  - **`position`** *(object, required)*: Position to change specified by either a name or id.
    - **`x`** *(number)*: X coordinate.
    - **`y`** *(number)*: Y coordinate.

nodes_diff

- *object*: Schema that represents nodes' differences in a graph.
  - **`graph_id`** *(string, required)*: Id of the graph.
  - **`nodes`** *(object, required)*: .
    - **`added`** *(array)*: List with created nodes.
      - **Items** *(object)*: JSON with node definition.
    - **`deleted`** *(array)*: List with removed nodes.
      - **Items** *(string)*: ID of node to delete.
  - **`remove_with_connections`** *(boolean)*: Should node be removed with connections.

connections_diff

- *object*: Schema that represents connections' differences in a graph.
  - **`graph_id`** *(string, required)*: Id of the graph.
  - **`connections`** *(object, required)*: .
    - **`added`** *(array)*: List with created connections.
      - **Items** *(object)*: JSON with connection definition.
    - **`deleted`** *(array)*: List with removed connections.
      - **Items** *(object)*: Connection defined with its beginning and end.
        - **`from`** *(string)*: ID of output interface.
        - **`to`** *(string)*: ID of input interface.

highlight_diff

- *object*: Schema that represents the difference in node selection in the editor.
  - **`graph_id`** *(string, required)*: Id of the graph.
  - **`nodes`** *(object, required)*: .
    - **`selected`** *(array)*: List with selected nodes.
      - **Items** *(string)*: ID of selected node.
    - **`unselected`** *(array)*: List with unselected nodes.
      - **Items** *(string)*: ID of unselected node.

metadata

- *object*: Type with PM metadata. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **`metadata`** *(object, required)*: JSON with metadata description in PM format.

external_endpoint_return_type

- *object*: Common type returned by external app. Cannot contain additional properties.
  - **`type`** *(number, required)*: *MessageType* specifying success, error or progress.
  - **`content`** *([object, string])*: Additional information, either message or dataflow.

navbar_items

- *array*: List of buttons displayed in the application navbar. Default: `[]`.
  - **Items** *(object)*: Description of a single button. Cannot contain additional properties.
    - **`name`** *(string, required)*: Name displayed in the tooltip.
    - **`stopName`** *(string)*: Name displayed in the tooltip when the corresponding procedure is running and is stoppable. If not specified simply Stop is added as a prefix to the name.
    - **`iconName`** *(string, required)*: Name of the icon displayed in the navbar. Name should correspond to a file in the asset directory or to an icon in `frontend/src/icons`.
    - **`procedureName`** *(string, required)*: Name of the procedure used when button is pressed. The currently displayed graph is used as an argument.
    - **`allowToRunInParallelWith`** *(array)*: List of procedures which can be run when this `navbarItem` is still running. Default: `[]`.
      - **Items** *(string)*: `procedureName` of `navbarItem`.
    - **`requireResponse`** *(boolean)*: Flag determining whether response from external application should be awaited when running the procedure. Default: `true`.

7.3.5 Custom procedures

Navbar

External application can define new remote procedures, which will be called by custom *Navbar button*. To use it, procedure's name has to start with `custom_` prefix, e.g. `custom_simulate_design`.

Such remote procedures can be called from the frontend using custom Navbar buttons defined in the *metadata's* `navbarItems` *field*, e.g.:

```
{
    "name": "Simulate design",
    "stopName": "Stop simulation",
    "iconName": "Run",
    "procedureName": "custom_simulate_design"
}
```

Custom procedure has the same parameters and return type as *dataflow_run* method.

Context menus

An external application can also define custom remote procedures to be called in the context menu of node. There are three scopes for such an action: all nodes, subgraph nodes and a given node type. They are specified by including a *Context menu item* in, respectively, `customMenuActions` or `subgraphCustomMenuActions` fields of *metadata* or in the `contextMenuActions` field of a given *node*.

Context menu procedures have only one parameter: `node_id`, which is the id of the clicked node. The expected return type is *dataflow_export* for procedures with the `custom_download` prefix in their name, and *dataflow_run* for all other procedures.

7.4 Custom dialog box

7.4.1 Custom dialog box definition

An external application can also define custom dialog boxes for various different use cases. When connection with Pipeline Manager server is established it sends *dialog_boxes_get* request to get user credentials with all custom dialog boxes used by application. Example dictionary defines simple form:

```
{
    "optimizationTask": {
        "title": "Optimization task",
        "confirmText": "Ok",
        "template": {
            "taskName": {
                "name": "task",
                "type": "text",
                "default": "Foo"
            },
            "numberOfIterations": {
                "name": "iterations",
```

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```
                "type": "int",
                "default": 10
            },
            "earlyStopping": {
                "name": "early stopping",
                "type": "bool",
                "default": false
            }
        },
    }
}
```

Every entry in dictionary defines an internal with the name later used to open the dialog box, in this case it is a dialog box with name `optimizationTask`. Each dialog definition consists of:

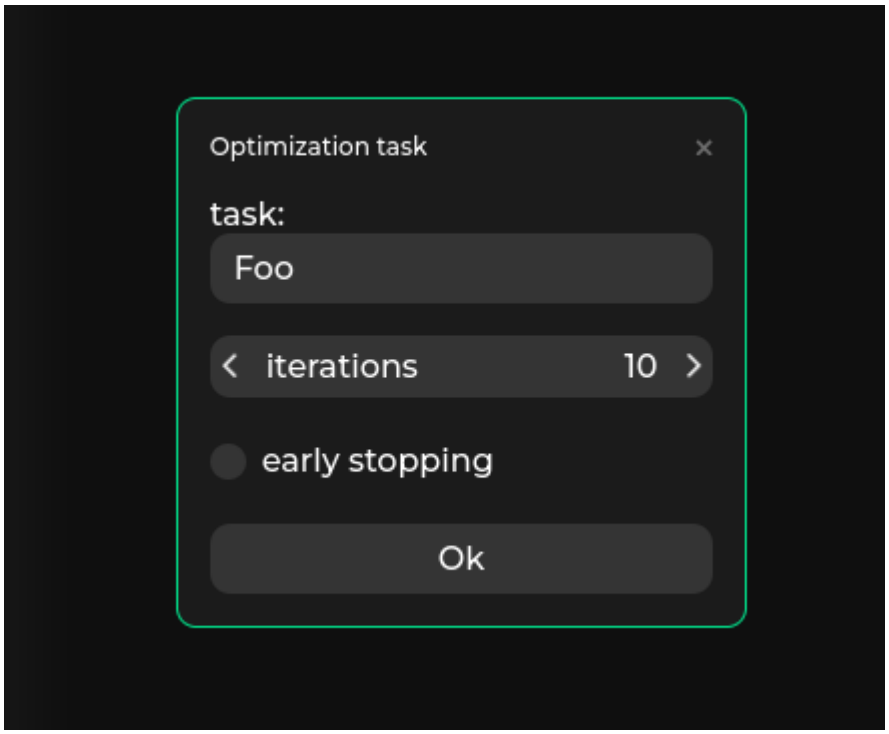
- `title` - which is a name of the dialog box's window
- `confirmText` - a title of the dialog box's confirm button
- `template` - it holds definition for every input in dialog box.

User dialog box `template` allows for defining input's name and it's type. Object name represents internal name of the input in which it will be returned, see *Read data from custom dialog box*. Nested `name` property represents a name of the input it will be shown in a dialog box's form and `type` represents type of the input, current supported types:

- `text` - a standard text input
- `number` - a numerical input
- `int` - an integer input
- `bool` - a checkbox with two states true or false

`default` properties in the template allows for setting a initial value in user data form.

The resulting specification gives us dialog box that looks like that:



7.4.2 Custom dialog input types description

- **Text** - Represents a standard input that accepts text data.
- **Number** - Represents a numerical input that supports float based data. It allows for settings optional `max` and `min` value which define range of supported input numbers.
- **Int** - Represents a numerical input that supports integer based data. It allows for settings optional `max` and `min` value which define range of supported input numbers.
- **Bool** - Represents a input that accepts only two states `true` and `false`. It is defined as a checkbox in dialog box.

7.4.3 Open custom dialog box

To open this dialog box, external application sends *open_dialog_request* request with a payload:

```
{
    "title": "optimizationTask",
    "wait": true
}
```

in which `title` parameter is a name of the dialog box to open and `wait` is an optional parameter that allows for a synchronous call. When it is set to `true` the request will wait for user inputs and send them back in the same call, otherwise `user_dialog_read` callback needs to be used to get user's inputs.

7.4.4 Read data from custom dialog box

When confirm button, `OK` button in this case, is pressed, Pipeline Manager sends *user_dialog_read* request with data read from dialog box in form of simple json-like format:

```
{
    "taskName": "Foo"
}
```

in which `taskName` corresponds to text input defined in `template` section of the dialog box.

Example usage of custom dialog box is defined in script tester_client.

You can also test custom dialog box using Custom dialog box demo which uses Pipeline Manager embedded into html page.

7.5 Implementing a Python-based client for Pipeline Manager

The communication described above is necessary to integrate an application with Pipeline Manager. The client needs to be able to read requests coming from Pipeline Manager and send proper responses.

For applications written in Python, you can use the pipeline-manager-backend-communication library. It implements an easy-to-use interface that is able to communicate with Pipeline Manager along with helper structures and enumerations.

The main structures provided by the `pipeline-manager-backend-communication` library are:

- `CommunicationBackend` - class that implements the functionality for receiving and sending messages.
- `MessageType` - enum used to easily distinguish message types.
- `Status` - enum that describes the current state of the client.

The following code is an example of how to receive requests and send responses to Pipeline Manager: As Pipeline Manager communication is based on JSON-RPC, application should implement method that can be requested. They are described in *Backend API*.

```
# Class containing all implemented methods
class RPCMethods:
    def specification_get(self) -> Dict:
        # ...
        return {'type': MessageType.OK.value, 'content': specification}

    # ...
```

Defined methods have to have appropriate (matching with specification) name, input and output.

```
    # Function name matches with the dataflow_import endpoint from External App␣
↪API
    def dataflow_import(self, external_application_dataflow: str, mime: str,␣
↪base64: bool) -> Dict:
        # Function will receive one parameter, it's name has to be the same
        # as the one from API specification `params`.
        # Optional, but you can convert the received file to string format
        # with `convert_message_to_string`
        # from pipeline_manager_backend_communication.utils import (
```

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```
        #     convert_message_to_string
        # )
        data_as_string = convert_message_to_string(
            external_application_dataflow,
            base64,
            mime
        )
        # ...
        # pipeline_manager_dataflow here is the converted input file to the
        # Pipeline Manager's graph representation
        return {
            'type': MessageType.OK.value,
            'content': pipeline_manager_dataflow
        }

    def dataflow_validate(self, dataflow: Dict) -> Dict:
        # ...
        # Returned object has to match API specification `returns`
        return {'type': MessageType.OK.value}

    def dataflow_run(self, **kwargs: Dict) -> Dict:
        # All params can also be retrieved as one dictionary
        print(kwargs['dataflow'])
        # ...
        return {'type': MessageType.OK.value}

    # Custom procedure example
    def custom_build(self, dataflow: Dict) -> Dict:
        # ...
        return {'type': MessageType.OK.value}
```

Moreover, every uncaught exception will be classified as error.

```
    def dataflow_export(self, dataflow: Dict) -> Dict:
        # ...
        raise Exception('Something went very, very bad...')
```

RPC methods can also be asynchronous. It is automatically detected by server and awaited.

```
    async def dataflow_stop(self) -> Dict:
        # ...
        return {'type': MessageType.OK.value}
```

Therefore, the following JSON-RPC error message will be returned to frontend application.

```
{
    "id": 1,
    "jsonrpc": "2.0",
    "error": {
        "code": -3,
```

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```
        "message": "Something went very, very bad...",
        "data": {}
    }
}
```

TCP client, that connects to Pipeline Manager using `host` and `port` parameters provided has to be created. It has to be initialized with object containing JSON-RPC methods.

```
host = '127.0.0.1'
port = 5000

# Creating a client instance with host and port specified
client = CommunicationBackend(host, port)
# Registering implemented methods and
# connecting to Pipeline Manager
await client.initialize_client(RPCMethods())
```

Once the connection is established, the application can start listening for the incoming requests.

```
await client.start_json_rpc_client()
```

These methods can be wrapped into the `async` function and run with `asyncio.run` function.

7.5.1 Sending JSON-RPC requests to Pipeline Manager

Sending requests is defined as coroutine which has to be awaited.

```
response = await client.request('graph_get')
```

This method sends *graph-get* request to frontend application and receive following response:

```
{
    "id": 1,
    "jsonrpc": "2.0",
    "result": {
        "dataflow": {
            // ...
        }
    }
}
```

CHAPTER

EIGHT

SAMPLE THIRD-PARTY SERVER

Some front-end features can be tested with the `frontend_tester` application that acts as a third-party application in the `server-app` scenario. It allows the user to create graph representations of basic front end use cases.

To be able to test the front end, start with building the front end in the `server-app` mode. In the root of the project, run:

```
python -m pipeline_manager build server-app
```

Note

If the specification requires additional assets (e.g. icons), provide them with `--assets-directory <path-to-assets>` flag, for example:

```
python -m pipeline_manager build server-app --assets-directory examples/sample-
↪assets
```

Now, start the Pipeline Manager server application:

```
python -m pipeline_manager run --verbosity INFO
```

Once the server has started, it waits for the third-party application to connect to. Let's run the front end tester with:

```
python -m pipeline_manager.frontend_tester.tester_client
```

After this, the entire testing setup should be up and running at http://127.0.0.1:5000. From there, it is possible to add mini scenarios mocking the work of the server to check various front-end features.

The implementation of the tester_client is documented and quite straightforward. You can also easily extend it to test other front-end (or back-end) features.

CHAPTER

NINE

SPECIFICATION BUILDER

Creating a specification, especially in external applications written in Python, can be significantly simplified with the `SpecificationBuilder` class. This tool:

- Provides methods to update the contents of the specification
- Provides an API that allows modifying the specification without worrying about the changes in the format
- Provides sanity checks of URLs, prevents duplicates and validates the specification with the frontend.

Note that this chapter only presents the initial steps of constructing a specification in Pipeline Manager. Check the *specification format* for some more comprehensive details.

9.1 Example usage of the `SpecificationBuilder`

9.1.1 Creating the builder

Import the package, specify the specification version to use and create an instance:

```
from pathlib import Path
from pipeline_manager.specification_builder import SpecificationBuilder

SPECIFICATION_VERSION = '20250623.14'
ASSETS_DIRECTORY = Path("./assets")

specification_builder = SpecificationBuilder(
    spec_version=SPECIFICATION_VERSION,
    assets_dir=ASSETS_DIRECTORY,
    check_urls=True
)
```

`assets_dir` is a path to additional assets (icons, visualizations) - it is used during validation to inform the user that e.g. paths provided in the specification do not have corresponding files. `check_urls` determines whether the `SpecificationBuilder` should check URLs provided in the specification for availability and raise errors when pages are not found.

9.1.2 Creating node types

Node types can be created with:

```
specification_builder.add_node_type(
    name='Digital camera',
    category='Video provider'
)
```

This method requires a unique name of the node type. We can also specify category, parent classes, layer and abstract fields. Follow the documentation of the class for more details.

9.1.3 Add node type "as category"

To create a node type that can act as a category grouping the child node types, we can use `add_node_type_as_category`:

```
specification_builder.add_node_type_as_category(
    categoryname='Filter',
)
```

To add a node that extends this node type as category, just provide its name in the `extends` field in the child node:

```
specification_builder.add_node_type(
    name='GaussianFilter',
    extends='Filter'
)
```

9.1.4 Adding interfaces to node types

The following snippets show how to add interfaces to node types. Note that one or more values can be passed to the `interfacetype` argument, signifying which types of other interfaces can be connected to it.

```
specification_builder.add_node_type_interface(
    name='Digital camera',
    interfacename='Video output',
    interfacetype='video',
    direction='output'
)

specification_builder.add_node_type_interface(
    name='Filter',
    interfacename='Video',
    interfacetype=['video', 'filtered_output'],
    direction='input'
)

specification_builder.add_node_type_interface(
    name='Filter',
    interfacename='Output',
```

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```
    interfacetype='filtered_output',
    direction='output',
)
```

9.1.5 Adding properties to node types

To create a property in Pipeline Manager, we need to pass three required arguments:

- `name` - the name of the property
- `type` - the type of the property, see *specification format* for possible values
- `default` - specifies a default value, its type depends on the `type` of the property

```
specification_builder.add_node_type_property(
    name='Digital camera',
    propname='Focal length',
    proptype='slider',
    min=14,
    max=135,
    default=50,
    description='Value signifying a camera\'s angle of view'
)

specification_builder.add_node_type_property(
    name='Filter',
    propname='Kernel size',
    proptype='select',
    values=['3x3', '5x5', '7x7'],
    default='3x3',
    description='Small matrix used for convolution'
)
```

There are some additional arguments, available in the *specification format*.

9.1.6 Adding node type descriptions

Adding descriptions is just a matter of providing a node name and a description string.

```
specification_builder.add_node_description(
    name='Digital camera',
    description='Camera providing digital video output'
)
```

9.1.7 Adding positioned interfaces.

To add custom position to node you need to specify node style with node shape.

```
spec.metadata_add_node_style(
    stylename='SaveNodeStyle',
    styleshape="floppy.svg"
)
```

Then you can specify interface name and positions:

```
spec.add_position_to_interface(
    stylename='SaveNodeStyle',
    interfacename='save',
    x=50.0,
    y=50.0
)
```

This will move interface named `save` to a center of the node.

9.1.8 Creating interface groups

All interfaces belonging to a group must exist. Members of an interface group may be:

- interface range(s)
- single interface(s)

For example, to create an interface range `pins` with indices `0-99`:

```
specification_builder.add_node_type_interface(
    name="Digital camera",
    interface_name="pins",
    array=[0, 100],
    direction=Direction.INOUT.value,
)
```

Note

`Direction` enum may be imported with `pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.data_structures import Direction`.

Adding an interface group is a two-step process:

1. Create an empty interface group.

   ```
   specification_builder.add_node_interface_group(
       node_type_name="Digital camera",
       interface_group_name=f"lower_half",
       direction=Direction.INOUT,
   )
   ```

2. Add interfaces and/or interface ranges to the newly created interface group.

   ```
   specification_builder.add_interface_to_group_interface(
       node_type_name="Digital camera",
       interface_group_name=f"lower_half",
       actual_interface_name="pins",
       direction=Direction.INOUT,
       index_or_indices=(0, 50),
   )
   ```

9.1.9 Adding metadata

Metadata specifies additional editor options, like `connectionStyle` or `movementStep`. All parameters are defined in the *specification format*.

```
specification_builder.metadata_add_param(
    paramname='connectionStyle',
    paramvalue='orthogonal'
)
```

9.1.10 Adding URLs to node types

To add a URL, first specify the URL group, which is part of the metadata. The icon argument can be a path to an asset file or a link.

```
specification_builder.metadata_add_url(
    groupname='wikipedia',
    displayname='Wikipedia',
    icon='https://en.wikipedia.org/static/favicon/wikipedia.ico',
    url='https://en.wikipedia.org/'
)
```

Then, add the node URL by defining the suffix that will be appended to the group URL.

```
specification_builder.add_node_type_url(
    name='Digital camera',
    urlgroup='wikipedia',
    suffix='wiki/Digital_camera'
)
```

9.1.11 Constructing and validating the specification

This function will generate and check the validity of the specification:

```
specification = specification_builder.create_and_validate_spec()
```

The possible arguments are:

- `workspacedir` - The path to the workspace directory for Pipeline Manager, the same that has been provided for the build script
- `fail_on_warnings` - Determines whether the validation should fail on warnings
- `dump_spec` - A path to where the specification should be dumped as a file before validation. Useful for debugging purposes.
- `sort_spec` - Return specification that has introduced ordering to dictionaries and lists. In lists containing dictionaries the unique field of each dictionary is used to sort entries.

The created `specification` upon successful run should contain a full specification based on `SpecificationBuilder`. It is a regular Python dictionary that can be saved to a JSON file using the `json.dump` method.

> **Note**
>
> To make sure the entries in the specification are sorted (mostly dictionaries) after using `sort_spec`, in case of Python's `json.dump` and `json.dumps` methods use `sort_keys=True`, e.g.:

```
json.dumps(spec, sort_keys=True, indent=4)
```

9.1.12 Adding custom actions to node context menus

This function will add a custom action named `My Action` to the context menu of every node. The action will be executed by sending a `custom_my_action` request to the RPC client, with the id of the clicked node as the only argument.

```
specification_builder.metadata_add_context_menu_action(
    name="My Action",
    procedure_name="custom_my_action",
    icon=None,
    require_response=True
)
```

To register an action only for nodes of type `Test Node`, use

```
specification_builder.add_node_type_context_menu_action(
    name="Test Node",
    action_name="Download Action",
    procedure_name="custom_download_action",
    icon=None,
    require_response=True
)
```

To register an action for subgraph nodes, use `specification_builder.metadata_add_subgraph_context_menu_action` with the same format as above.

The `procedure_name` has to start with `custom_`. If it starts with `custom_download`, the expected response schema will expect a file (see: *dataflow_export*). Otherwise the expected schema will be *dataflow_run*, which allows for sending notifications.

9.2 `SpecificationBuilder` documentation

class pipeline_manager.specification_builder.**SpecificationBuilder**(spec_version: *str*, assets_dir: *Path* | *None* = **None**, check_urls: *bool* = **False**)

Creates a specification file and checks validity of files.

This class allows to:

- Create and modify specification entries using simple API
- Merge existing specifications with some consistency checks

- Check URLs to remote resources in terms of availability
- Checks correctness of paths to assets from the given directory

This class also performs very strict checking, e.g. it does not allow creating duplicates. In case of any errors spotted it raises a SpecificationBuilderException.

add_include(include: *str*, style: *str | list[str] | None* = **None**)

Adds include defined by url to the specification.

Parameters

include : str
URL to the specification to include

style : Optional[Style]
Style of included nodes

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when include already exists.

add_include_subgraph(dataflow: *dict[tuple[str, str], str]*)

Adds dataflow to the include subgraph defined by url.

Parameters

dataflow : Dict[Tuple[str, str], str]
Dataflow to include. Keys are tuples of node names and node urls

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when included subgraph already exists

add_interface_to_group_interface(node_type_name: *str*, interface_group_name: *str*, actual_interface_name: *str*, index_or_indices: *int | tuple[int]*, direction: *Direction* = Direction.INOUT, max_connection_count: *int | None* = **None**, side: *Side | None* = **None**)

Add an interface or a range of interfaces to an existing interface group.

Parameters

node_type_name : str
Name of the node type.

interface_group_name : str
Name of the interface group.

actual_interface_name : str
Name of the actual interface to be split within groups.

index_or_indices : Union[int, Tuple[int]]
Either a single index of a new interface or [lower, upper) range of interface to be added to the group interface.

direction : Direction, optional
Direction of the interface. By default, Direction.INOUT.

max_connection_count : Optional[int], optional
Maximal number of connection of the interface or the range of interface. By default, None.

side : Optional[Side], optional
Side, where the interface or the group of interface should be located. By default, None.

Raises

- **TypeError** – Raised if: - an unsupported type of *index_or_indices* was provided, - a provided range of indices has size different than two.
- **ValueError** – Raised if: - there is no interface group present in the specification builder, - a group with *interface_group_name* does not exist.

add_node_description(name: *str*, description: *str*)

Sets description for the node if it is not defined.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

description : str
Description

Raises

SpecificationBuilderException – Raised if description is already defined

add_node_interface_group(node_type_name: *str*, interface_group_name: *str*, direction: *Direction* = `Direction.INOUT`, interface_type: *str* | *None* = **None**, interfaces: *list[dict]* | *None* = **None**)

Add an empty interface group to a node type.

Parameters

node_type_name : str
Name of a node type.

interface_group_name : str
Name of a newly created interface group.

direction : Direction
Direction of the interface group, by default Direction.INOUT.

interface_type : Optional[str]
Type of an interface group, by default None.

interfaces : Optional[List[Dict]]
A list of interfaces to be added to the interface group. It is safer to use *add_interface_to_group_interface* method to add interface to an interface group - it performs more detailed data validation. Each interface is a dictionary with at least two keys: *name* and *direction*.

Raises

- **MissingInterfaceAttribute** – Raised if either *name* or *direction* is missing in *interfaces*.
- **ValueError** – Raised if direction has an illegal value.

add_node_type(name: *str*, category: *str* | *None* = **None**, layer: *str* | *None* = **None**, extends: *str* | *list[str]* | *None* = **None**, abstract: *bool* | *None* = **False**)

Adds a node type to the specification.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type.

category : Optional[str]
Category of the node.

layer : Optional[str]
Name of the layer metatype.

extends : Optional[Union[str, List[str]]]
Base classes for the node type.

abstract : Optional[bool]
Tells if the type is abstract or not. Abstract types do not need to be complete, they are also not added to the final specification. They are templates for other classes.

Raises

SpecificationBuilderException – Raised if the node type is redefined.

add_node_type_additional_data(name: *str*, additionaldata: *Any*)

Adds additional data to the node, in JSON-like format.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

additionaldata : Any
Any JSON-like construct

Raises

SpecificationBuilderException – Raised if additionalData already exists.

add_node_type_as_category(categoryname: *str*, categoryparent: *str* = '', layer: *str* | *None* = **None**, extends: *str* | *list[str]* | *None* = **None**)

Adds a node type “as category” to the specification.

Parameters

categoryname : str
Name of the newly added category

categoryparent : str
Path to the new category

layer : Optional[str]
Name of the layer metatype

extends : Optional[Union[str, List[str]]]
Base classes for the node type

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when node type is redefined.

add_node_type_category(name: *str*, category: *str*)

Adds a category to the given node. Raises an error if different category is already added.

Parameters

name : str
name of the node type

category : str
category for the node type

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised if there is already a node type category.

add_node_type_color(name: *str*, color: *str*)

Sets color for the node.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node

color : str
Color of the node

add_node_type_context_menu_action(name: *str*, action_name: *str*, procedure_name: *str*, icon: *str* | *None* = **None**, require_response: *bool* = **True**) → None

Adds a custom context menu action for the given node type.

The action is displayed only in the context menu of nodes of this type, in addition to any global actions added with *metadata_add_context_menu_action*.

The client response to the action has to follow either the *dataflow_run* or *dataflow_export* schemas (see procedure_name). The request is not currently verified.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

action_name : str
Label of the action, displayed in the context menu

procedure_name : str

Name of the JSON-RPC procedure requested from the external application when the action is clicked. The id of the clicked node is sent as an argument. Unless this name is one of the built-in endpoints known

to *pipeline_manager_backend_communication*, it must start with *custom_*, otherwise the external application will silently refuse to register it.

If this name starts with *custom_download*, the response will be verified against the *dataflow_export* schema. Otherwise the response will be verified against the *dataflow_run* schema.

icon : Optional[str]
Path in assets directory or URL to the icon

require_response : bool
Tells whether the response from the external application should be awaited when running the procedure

Raises

SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when an action with the given procedure_name is already registered for this node type and differs in format with the existing entry.

add_node_type_from_spec(node)

Adds single node type defined in JSON-like format.

add_node_type_icon(name: *str*, iconpath: *dict* | *str*) → None

Adds icon for the node type.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

iconpath : Union[dict, str]
Icon path

add_node_type_interface(name: *str*, interfacename: *str*, interfacetype: *str* | *list[str]* | *None* = **None**, direction: *str* = 'inout', dynamic: *bool* | *list[int]* = **False**, side: *str* | *None* = **None**, maxcount: *int* | *None* = **None**, override: *bool* | *None* = **None**, array: *list[int]* | *None* = **None**, busType: *str* | *None* = **None**, busSize: *int* | *None* = **None**)

Adds interface to the node type.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

interfacename : str
Name of the interface

interfacetype : Optional[Union[str, List[str]]]
List of matching types for interfaces

direction : str
Direction of the connection, by default “inout”.

dynamic : Union[bool, List[int]]
Determine whether a number of interfaces may be dynamically adjusted. By default, False.

side : Optional[str]
On which side the interface should be placed by default

maxcount : Optional[int]
The maximum connections to the given interface

override : Optional[bool]
Determines whether interface should be overridden

array : Optional[List[int]]
Creates an array of interfaces with given name. Accepts two integers - minimal and maximal value

busType : Optional[str]
If interface is a bus, specify the bus type (twoSided or oneSided)

busSize : Optional[int]
If interface is a bus type, bus size specified in pixels.

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when interface already exists.

add_node_type_parent(name: *str*, parent_names: *str | list[str]*)

Adds a parent class to the node type. Raises an exception if the base name does not exist.

Parameters

name : str
name of the node type

parent_names : Union[str, List[str]]
name of the base class, or list of base classes' names.

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when base/parent class is not found.

add_node_type_pill(name: *str*, text: *str*, color: *str | None* = **None**)

Sets node's pill.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node

text : str
Content of the pill

color : Optional[str]
Background color. The default is white

add_node_type_property(name: *str*, propname: *str*, proptype: *str*, default: *Any*, description: *str | None* = **None**, min: *Any* = **None**, max: *Any* = **None**, values: *list[Any] | None* = **None**, dtype: *str | None* = **None**, override: *bool | None* = **None**, hidden: *bool | None* = **None**)

Adds property to the node.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

propname : str
Name of the property

proptype : str
Type of the property

default : Any
Default value of the property

description : Optional[str]
Optional description for the property

min : Any
Minimal value

max : Any
Maximal value

values : Optional[List[Any]]
List of allowed values

dtype : Optional[str]
Type of elements in property type is list

override : Optional[bool]
Determines whether property should be overridden

hidden : Optional[bool]
Determines whether property should be rendered in node

Raises

SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when the property exists already.

add_node_type_property_group(name: *str*, propgroupname: *str*, propname: *str*, proptype: *str*, default: *Any*, description: *str* | *None* = None, min: *Any* = None, max: *Any* = None, values: *list[Any]* | *None* = None, dtype: *str* | *None* = None, override: *bool* | *None* = None)

Adds a property to a property group.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

propgroupname : str
Name of the group of property

propname : str
Name of the property

proptype : str
Type of the property

default : Any
Default value of the property

description : Optional[str]
Optional description for the property

min : Any
Minimal value

max : Any
Maximal value

values : Optional[List[Any]]
List of allowed values

dtype : Optional[str]
Type of elements in property type is list

override : Optional[bool]
Determines whether property should be overridden

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when no properties are found that could be bound to the group.

add_node_type_size(name: *str*, width: *int*, height: *int* | *None* = None)
Sets node's width and height.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node

width : int
Width of the node

height : Optional[int]
Height of the node

add_node_type_style(name: *str*, style: *str* | *list[str]*)
Sets style for the node.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node

style : Style
Style of the node

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when the given style is not present egistered in metadata

add_node_type_subgraph_id(name: *str*, subgraph_id: *str*)
Sets subgraph ID for the node.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node

subgraph_id : str
Subgraph ID of the node

add_node_type_tag(name: *str*, tag: *str*)

Sets node's tag.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node

tag : str
Tag assigned to the node.

add_node_type_two_column(name: *str*, twoColumn: *bool*)

Sets node's twoColumn property.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node

twoColumn : bool
Enables or disables two column mode.

add_node_type_url(name: *str*, urlgroup: *str*, suffix: *str*)

Adds URL for the node type.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

urlgroup : str
Name of the URL group the entry is defined for. URL group defines prefix, and icon for the URL.

suffix : str
Appended suffix to the URL group

Raises

SpecificationBuilderException – Raised if provided urlgroup does not exist.

add_position_to_interface(stylename: *str*, interfacename: *str*, x: *float*, y: *float*)

Adds position to interface in node style.

Parameters

stylename : str
Name of the node style

interfacename : str
Name of the interface

x : float
x coordinate of the interface

y : float
y coordinate of the interface

Raises

SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when style doesn't exist.

add_subgraph_from_spec(subgraph)

Adds subgraph defined in JSON-like format.

create_and_validate_spec(workspacedir: *Path | None* = **None**, resolved_specification: *Path | None* = **None**, fail_on_warnings: *bool* = **True**, sort_spec: *bool* = **False**, dump_spec: *Path | None* = **None**, skip_validation: *bool* = **False**, host_uri_subs: *dict[str, URISubEntry] | None* = **None**) → dict

Creates a specification and validates it using schema.

Parameters

workspacedir : Optional[Path]
Path to the workspace directory for Pipeline Manager

resolved_specification : Optional[Path]
Path to specification that has have resolved inheritance, i.e. resolved 'extends' attributes. If none then the specification is not resolved.

fail_on_warnings : bool
Tells if the specification creation should fail on warnings

sort_spec : bool
True if the entries in the specification should be sorted.

dump_spec : Optional[Path]
Tells where the specification should be dumped to file before validation and resolving for debugging purposes.

skip_validation : bool
Whether validation of the specification should be omitted.

host_uri_subs : Optional[Dict[str, URISubEntry]]
Mapping between scheme and substitution entry.

Returns

Built specification, if successful

Return type

Dict

Raises

SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when specification is not valid or when warnings appeared.

create_property(propname: *str*, proptype: *str*, default: *Any*, description: *str | None* = **None**, min: *Any* = **None**, max: *Any* = **None**, values: *list[Any] | None* = **None**, dtype: *str | None* = **None**, override: *bool | None* = **None**, stringify: *bool* = **False**, hidden: *bool | None* = **None**) → dict | str

Creates and returns a property.

Parameters

propname : str
Name of the property

proptype : str
Type of the property

default : Any
Default value of the property

description : Optional[str]
Optional description for the property

min : Any
Minimal value

max : Any
Maximal value

values : Optional[List[Any]]
List of allowed values

dtype : Optional[str]
Type of elements in property type is list

override : Optional[bool]
Determines whether property should be overridden

stringify : bool
Determines whether property should be returned as a string

hidden : Optional[bool]
Determines whether property should be rendered in node

Returns
Creates a single property for the node type

Return type
Union[Dict, str]

enable_interface_group_by_default(node_name: *str*, interface_group: *str*, direction: *Direction*)

Add an interface group to default interface groups of a node type.

The default interface group contains a list of interface groups enabled by default. Adding an interface group there effectively enables the interface group from the specification.

Parameters

node_name : str
Name of the node type.

interface_group : str
Name of the interface group.

direction : Direction
Direction of the interface group.

Raises
ValueError – Raised if: - the node with the provided *node_name* does not have any interface groups, - more than one interface group matches provided *interface_group* and *direction*, - none of interface groups matches provided *interface_group* and *direction*.

get_node_description(name: *str*) → str

Gets description for the node type.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

Returns
Description of the node type

Return type
str

metadata_add_context_menu_action(name: *str*, procedure_name: *str*, icon: *str* | *None* = None, require_response: *bool* = True) → None

Adds a custom context menu action to metadata.

The action is displayed in the context menu of every node in the specification, in addition to any node-type-specific actions added with *add_node_type_context_menu_action*.

The client response to the action has to follow either the *dataflow_run* or *dataflow_export* schemas (see procedure_name). The request is not currently verified.

Parameters

name : str
Label of the action, displayed in the context menu

procedure_name : str
Name of the JSON-RPC procedure requested from the external application when the action is clicked. The id of the clicked node is sent as an argument. Unless this name is one of the built-in endpoints known to *pipeline_manager_backend_communication*, it must start with *custom_*.

icon : Optional[str]
Path in assets directory or URL to the icon

require_response : bool
Tells whether the response from the external application should be awaited when running the procedure

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when an action with the given procedure_name already exists and differs in format with the existing entry.

metadata_add_interface_styling(interfacename: *str*, interfacecolor: *str* | *None* = None, interfaceconnpattern: *str* | *None* = None, interfaceconncolor: *str* | *None* = None)

Adds interface styling to metadata.

interfacename: str
Name of the interface type

interfacecolor: Optional[str]
Color of the interface

interfaceconnpattern: Optional[str]
Interface connection line pattern

interfaceconncolor: Optional[str]
Color of the interface connection line

metadata_add_layer(name: *str*, nodelayers: *str | list[str] | None* = **None**, nodeinterfaces: *str | list[str] | None* = **None**)

Adds nodes' layer to metadata.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the layer

nodelayers : Optional[Union[str, List[str]]]
List of node layers in the layer

nodeinterfaces : Optional[Union[str, List[str]]]
List of interface types in the layer

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when provided layer already exists.

metadata_add_node_style(stylename: *str*, styleicon: *str | dict | None* = **None**, stylecolor: *str | None* = **None**, styleshape: *str | None* = **None**, styleminimal: *bool | None* = **None**)

Adds node styling to metadata.

Parameters

stylename : str
Name of the style

styleicon : Optional[Union[str, Dict]]
Icon of the style

stylecolor : Optional[str]
Color of the style

styleshape : Optional[str]
Path to svg file used as node shape

styleminimal : Optional[bool]
Enables minimal node type.

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when the style already exists

metadata_add_param(paramname: *str*, paramvalue: *Any*, metadata: *dict | None* = **None**)

Sets parameter in metadata. Modifies the metadata dictionary in place.

The following rules apply: * If the parameter is a list and the value is a list, the parameter is extended by the value. * If the parameter is a dictionary and the value is a dictionary, the parameter is recursively updated by the value. * Otherwise, the parameter is set to the value.

Parameters

paramname : str
Name of the metadata parameter

paramvalue : Any
Value of the parameter

metadata : Optional[Dict]
Metadata dictionary to modify. if None, the class metadata is used

metadata_add_subgraph_context_menu_action(name: *str*, procedure_name: *str*, icon: *str* | *None* = **None**, require_response: *bool* = **True**) → None

Adds a custom context menu action to subgraph nodes.

The action is displayed only in the context menu of subgraph nodes, in addition to any global actions added with *metadata_add_context_menu_action*.

The client response to the action has to follow either the *dataflow_run* or *dataflow_export* schemas (see procedure_name). The request is not currently verified.

Parameters

name : str
Label of the action, displayed in the context menu

procedure_name : str
Name of the JSON-RPC procedure requested from the external application when the action is clicked. The id of the clicked node is sent as an argument. Unless this name is one of the built-in endpoints known to *pipeline_manager_backend_communication*, it must start with *custom_*.

icon : Optional[str]
Path in assets directory or URL to the icon

require_response : bool
Tells whether the response from the external application should be awaited when running the procedure

Raises

SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when an action with the given procedure_name already exists and differs in format with the existing entry.

metadata_add_url(groupname: *str*, displayname: *str*, icon: *str*, url: *str*)

Adds URL group to metadata.

Parameters

groupname : str
Name of the URL group

displayname : str
Displayable name of the URL group

icon : str
Path in assets directory or URL to the icon

url : str
URL prefix for the URL group

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when URL group already exists and differs in format with the existing entry.

register_category(categorypath: *str*)
Adds a category to the set of available categories.

Parameters

categorypath : str
Category. Subcategories are added via path-like string.

remove_node_type_interface(name: *str*, interfacename: *str*) → None
Removes interface from a selected node type.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

interfacename : str
Name of the interface

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when node type or interface does not exist.

remove_node_type_interface_bus_stub(name: *str*, interfacename: *str*, stubID: *int*)
Removes stub from interface. Interface has to be of type “Bus”.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

interfacename : str
Name of the interface

stubID : int
ID of the stub being removed

Raises
SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when an error occurs durign the search for/deletion of stub.

reset()
Resets all fields for the specification.

set_node_description(name: *str*, description: *str*)
Sets description for the node type.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node type

description : str
Description for the node

update_spec_from_other(otherspec: *Any*)

Updates the specification from other specification. It can be also used to merge partial specifications.

Parameters

otherspec : Any
JSON-like structure with other specification

Raises

SpecificationBuilderException – Raised when “extends” in any node has non-existent classes

CHAPTER

TEN

DATAFLOW GRAPH BUILDER

Class `GraphBuilder` (available in `pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.dataflow_builder`) provides a convenient Python API for creating and editing a dataflow graph.

10.1 Examples of GraphBuilder usage

10.1.1 Creating GraphBuilder

In order to create an instance of `GraphBuilder`:

```
from pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.dataflow_builder import GraphBuilder

builder = GraphBuilder(
    specification="examples/sample-specification.json",
    specification_version="20250623.14",
)
```

The code creates an instance of `GraphBuilder` with the `sample-specification.json` loaded.

10.1.2 Obtaining a dataflow graph

A dataflow graph may be either loaded from a dataflow file or created.

To create a new empty dataflow graph:

```
from pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.dataflow_graph import DataflowGraph

graph = builder.create_graph()
```

To load an existing specification from a file:

```
builder.load_graphs(dataflow_source='examples/sample-dataflow.json')
graph = builder.graphs[0]
```

In both cases, the dataflow graph:

- has to be compliant with the provided specification.
- is retrieved and may be edited with its public methods.

10.1.3 Creating a node

Having obtained the `DataflowGraph` object (in the previous examples, stored in the `graph` variable), a new node may be added to the graph in the following way:

```
from pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.entities import Node

node = graph.create_node(
    name="LoadVideo", # Required.
    position=Vector2(0, 0), # Optional.
)
```

Only keyword parameters are allowed. The available parameters of the `create_node` method are attributes of the `Node` dataclass (which is located under `pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.entities.Node`).

10.1.4 Getting a node

A dataflow graphs stores nodes. Thus, nodes are retrieved from the dataflow graph in the following way:

```
from pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.dataflow_graph import AttributeType

nodes = graph.get(AttributeType.NODE, name="LoadVideo")
if len(nodes) > 0:
    node = nodes[0]
```

Only nodes with `name` equal to `LoadVideo` will be retrieved.

The `DataflowGraph.get` method retrieves not only nodes but other objects present in the `AttributeType` enum: connections, interfaces, and nodes. In this case, nodes are retrieved. Parameters other than `type` are filters, which specify what values should the obtained objects (here: nodes) have. Take a look at the next example to see such usage.

10.1.5 Getting a node matching multiple criteria

To get a node, which satisfies all the matching criteria, use the `get` method once again:

```
from pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.entities import Vector2

[node] = graph.get(AttributeType.NODE, position=Vector2(0, 0), name="LoadVideo")
```

The code above puts in the `node` variable a node with name `LoadVideo` and position with coordinates `[0, 0]`.

10.1.6 Manipulating a node

After having a node retrieved from a graph, it is time to modify its attributes. For example, to change an instance name of the node, run:

```
node.instance_name = 'Instance name of a node'
```

To change the property of the node, `set_property` can be used:

```
try:
    # Use of `set_property` is recommended to set values of properties of a node.
    node.set_property('compression_rate', 1)
except KeyError:
    print('Cannot set compression_rate to 1 as the property does not exists.')
```

To move the node from its current position, use `move`:

```
# Move a node to [1000, 1000].
node.move(Vector2(1000, 1000))

# Move the node by 500 pixels to the right, relative to its previous position.
node.move(new_position=Vector2(500, 0), relative=True)
```

10.2 Exception Hierarchy

The dataflow builder module has custom exceptions ordered in a hierarchy of inheritance. The highest in the hierarchy is `DataflowBuilderError`.

The complete hierarchy of custom exceptions:

```
DataflowBuilderError
├── InterfaceError
│   ├── InterfaceCountError
│   ├── MissingInterfaceAttributeError
│   ├── MultipleInterfacesSelectedError
│   ├── NotDynamicInterfaceError
│   ├── NoInterfaceMatchedError
│   ├── InvalidInterfaceTypeError
│   ├── MissingInterfaceError
│   └── OutOfSpecificationInterfaceError
├── PropertyError
│   ├── InvalidPropertyValueError
│   ├── MissingPropertyError
│   └── InvalidPropertyTypeError
├── NodeError
│   ├── MissingNodeAttributeError
│   ├── ExtraNodeAttributeError
│   ├── OutOfSpecificationNodeError
│   ├── NodeLacksInterfacesError
│   └── MissingNodeError
├── GraphError
│   ├── DuplicateExternalNamesError
│   ├── InvalidPanningError
│   ├── ScalingOutOfBoundsError
│   ├── InvalidDataflowError
│   ├── NoGraphsError
│   └── GraphRenamingError
├── ConnectionError
│   ├── InvalidDirectionError
```

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```
│   ├── ConnectionExistsError
│   └── MismatchingInterfaceTypesError
└── GraphBuilderError
    ├── NotSpecificationError
    ├── NoGraphSelectedError
    ├── ExternalValidatorError
    ├── SpecificationWithoutNodesError
    └──
```

10.3 Specification of GraphBuilder

class pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.dataflow_builder.**GraphBuilder**(specification: *Path* | *str* | *dict* | SpecificationBuilder, specification_version: *str*, workspace_directory: *Path* | *None* = **None**)

Class for building dataflow graphs.

Each instance of the GraphBuilder must be associated with a single specification to ensure proper validation.

create_graph(based_on: *Path* | *str* | DataflowGraph | *dict* | *None* = **None**, identifier: *str* | *None* = **None**) → *DataflowGraph*

Create a dataflow graph and return its instance.

Create an instance of a dataflow graph, add it to the internal list and return it. The dataflow graph is based on the graph provided in *based_on* parameter.

Parameters

based_on : Union[Path, str, *DataflowGraph*, Dict, None], optional
Dataflow graph, on which the new graph should be based on. When *Path* or *str*, it should be a path to dataflow file in a JSON format. When *Dict*, it should be a dictionary representation of the dataflow. When *DataflowGraph*, it should be a valid representation (as its deep copy will be added). When *None*, the new dataflow graph will not be based on anything, by default None.

identifier : Optional[str]
Either *id* or *name* of a dataflow graph. That identifier should uniquely identify a graph from the dataflow file provided in *based_on* argument. If *based_on* is either *None* or of type *DataflowGraph*, the value of *identifier* is not used. Defaults to the graph defined as *entryGraph* in the dataflow file.

Returns
Instance a of a dataflow graph, preserved in the GraphBuilder.

Return type
DataflowGraph

disable_layers(layer_name: *str* | *list[str]*)

Disabled layers for every graph in dataflow.

Parameters

layer_name : Union[str, List[str]]
Name of the layer/layers to be disabled.

enable_layers(layer_name: *str* | *list[str]*)

Enable layers for every graph in dataflow.

Parameters

layer_name : Union[str, List[str]]
Name of the layer/layers to be re-enabled.

get_graph_by_id(id: *str*) → *DataflowGraph*

Get a graph by its ID.

Parameters

id : str
ID of the graph to retrieve.

Returns
Dataflow graph with the provided ID.

Return type
DataflowGraph

Raises
NoGraphSelectedError – Raised if the provided ID does not match any graph or matches more than one graph.

get_graph_by_property(property_name: *str*, property_value: *Any*) → *DataflowGraph*

Get the first graph with *property_name* equal to *property_value*.

Parameters

property_name : str
Name of the property, e.g.: *id* or *name*.

property_value : Any
Exact value to be matched.

Returns
Dataflow graph satisfying the provided criteria.

Return type
DataflowGraph

Raises

- **MissingPropertyError** – Raised if any graph lacks the property.
- **NoGraphSelectedError** – Raised if the provided property name and values does not match any graph.

get_subgraph_by_name(name: *str*) → *DataflowGraph* | list[*DataflowGraph*]

Get a subgraph by the name.

Get subgraph by either the name of a subgraph or name of the node containing the subgraph.

Parameters

name : str
Either name of the subgraph or name of the node containing the subgraph.

Returns
An single instance if one graph is matched, a list of instances if multiple graphs are matched.

Return type
Union[*DataflowGraph*, list[*DataflowGraph*]]

Raises
NoGraphSelectedError – Raised if name matches to more than one or none of graphs.

get_subgraphs() → list[*DataflowGraph*]

Get a list of subgraphs.

Get a list of graphs, which are contained in some node, what makes them subgraphs.

Returns
A list of subgraphs.

Return type
List[*DataflowGraph*]

load_graphs(dataflow_source: *Path* | *str* | *dict*, skip_validation: *bool* = **False**)

Load all dataflow graphs from a file.

Parameters

dataflow_source : Union[Path, str, Dict]
Path to a dataflow graph or dataflow graph dictionary

skip_validation : bool
Whether validation of a dataflow graph should be omitted.

Raises

- **InvalidDataflowError** – Raised if a dataflow graph could not be loaded.
- **NoGraphsError** – Raised if there are no graph in the dataflow file.

load_specification(specification: *Path* | *str* | *dict* | SpecificationBuilder, purge_old_graphs: *bool* = **True**)

Load a specification from given file or dictionary to use in GraphBuilder.

The default behaviour is to remove loaded dataflow graphs when loading a new specification. That is due to the fact that a dataflow graph is closely linked with its specification. Notice that loading a specification overrides the old one.

Parameters

specification : Union[Path, str, Dict, *SpecificationBuilder*]
Path to specification file, dictionary or the builder directly

purge_old_graphs : bool, optional
Determine if dataflow graphs loaded to memory should be purged. It makes sense as after changing a specification dataflow graphs may no longer be valid. By default True.

Raises

NotSpecificationError – Raised if specification cannot be loaded or its file is invalid.

save(json_file: *Path*, skip_validation: *bool* = **False**, save_specification: *bool* | *None* = **None**, minify: *bool* = **False**)

Save graphs to a JSON file.

Saving also validates all the stored graphs.

Parameters

json_file : Path
Path, where an output JSON file will be created.

skip_validation : bool
Whether the validation of the script should be skipped or not.

save_specification : Optional[bool]
Whether to save specification with graph data.

minify : bool
Specifies whether the returned specification should be minified.

set_save_with_specification(save_with_specification: *bool*)

Set whether dataflow should be saved with specification or not.

Parameters

save_with_specification : bool
Indicate whether dataflow should be saved with specification.

validate()

Validate the entire dataflow file including all the included graphs.

Raises

ExternalValidatorError – Raised if an external validator failed to validate either a dataflow or specification file. An error message is provided by the external validator.

10.4 Specification of DataflowGraph

class pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.dataflow_graph.**DataflowGraph**(builder_with_spec: SpecificationBuilder, builder_with_dataflow: *Any*, dataflow: *dict[str, Any]* | *None* = **None**)

Representation of a dataflow graph.

add_additional_data(additionalData: *dict*) → None

Add additional data to graph. Function appends graph's additional data with items from additionalData parameter.

Parameters

additionalData : Dict
Dictionary with additional data.

create_connection(from_interface: Interface | *str*, to_interface: Interface | *str*, connection_id: *str* | *None* = **None**, stubOffset: *int* | *None* = **None**) → *InterfaceConnection*

Create a connection between two existing interfaces.

The function performs numerous checks to verify validity of the desired connection, including if the connection already exists, interfaces' types are matching and so on. The connection is added, given it has passed these checks.

Parameters

from_interface : Union[*Interface*, str]
Source interface, where data will flow from.

to_interface : Union[*Interface*, str]
Destination interface, where data will flow to.

connection_id : Optional[str]
Identifier of a connection. If not supplied, one will be generated.

stubOffset : Optional[int]
Offset used to create a stub if one of the interfaces is a bus type interface, ignored otherwise.

Returns
Created connection added to the graph.

Return type
InterfaceConnection

Raises

- **MissingInterfaceError** – Raised if either a source or destination interface does not belong to the graph.
- **InvalidDirectionError** – Raised if either a source interface direction has *input* direction or a destination interface direction is *output*.
- **MismatchingInterfaceTypesError** – Raised if a mismatch between source and destination interfaces' types occurs.

create_group(name: *str*, nodes: *list[*Node | *str]*, id: *str* = **None**, color: *str* = **None**) → NodeGroup

Create a group of existing nodes.

The function checks if nodes exist to verify validity of added group.

Parameters

name : str
Source interface, where data will flow from.

nodes : Union[*Node*, str]
List of nodes that should be contained in the group created.

id : Optional[str]
Identifier of a group. If not supplied, one will be generated.

color : Optional[str]
Color of the group in the hex format. If not supplied will be randomly assigned when rendering the graph.

Returns
Created node group.

Return type
NodeGroup

Raises

- **MissingNodeError** – if error included in group is not present in the graph.
- **GroupExistsError** – if ids of two groups collide.
- **GroupTooSmallError** – if ids of two groups collide.

create_node(name: *str*, subgraph_id: *str* = **None**, **kwargs) → *Node*

Create the node initialized with the supplied arguments.

Use this method instead of manually adding a node. Default values are taken from the specification, based on the provided *name* parameter. The default values may be overridden by the values supplied in *kwargs*. *id* is already initialized.

Parameters

name : str
Name of a node, based on which default values will be derived.

subgraph_id : str
ID of the subgraph that contained by the node, if node is subgraph.

****kwargs**
Keyword arguments to initialise a newly created node. Check attributes of *Node* dataclass, to find all available keys.

Returns
The initialized node that belongs to the dataflow graph.

Return type
Node

Raises

- **InvalidMethodUsedError** – Raised if *subgraph* attribute was present in *kwargs*.
- **ExtraNodeAttributeError** – Raised if out-of-specification key is present in the *kwargs* directory.
- **OutOfSpecificationNodeError** – Raised if the provided name of the node does not exists in the specification.

create_subgraph_node(name: *str*, subgraph_id: *str*, **kwargs) → *Node*

Create a node with a subgraph.

Deprecated since version Use: `create_node(..., subgraph_id=...)` instead.

A graph has to exist inside *GraphBuilder* instance before creating a node containing it as a subgraph.

Parameters

name : str
Name of the node.

subgraph_id : str
ID of the subgraph that contained by the node.

Returns
Newly created node with a subgraph.

Return type
Node

disable_layers(layer_name: *str* | *list[str]*)

Disable layers for this graph.

Parameters

layer_name : Union[str, List[str]]
Name of the layer/layers to be disabled.

enable_layers(layer_name: *str* | *list[str]*)

Enable previously disabled layers.

Parameters

layer_name : Union[str, List[str]]
Name of the layer/layers to be re-enabled.

get(type: *AttributeType*, **kwargs) → list[*Node*] | list[*InterfaceConnection*] | list[*Interface*]

Get items of a given type, which satisfy all the desired criteria.

Items are understood as either nodes or connections or interfaces. The function finds objects by eliminating these, which do not match the criteria. Thus, between all the criteria is *AND* logical operator.

Parameters

type : AttributeType
Type of the output objects.

**kwargs
Contains search criteria. Available: - Keys: the attributes of the object of he chosen type. - Values: values to be matched.

Returns
List of items satisfying the criteria.

Return type
Union[List[*Node*], List[*InterfaceConnection*], List[*Interface*]]

get_by_id(type: *AttributeType*, id: *str*) → *InterfaceConnection* | *Node* | *Interface* | None

Fast getter, which finds an item of a supplied type and with the provided id.

It has complexity of O(1) (except for interfaces) in juxtaposition to the *get* method, which iterates over all items.

Parameters

type : AttributeType
Type of the output objects.

id : str
ID of the sought object.

Returns
Either an single instance of InterfaceConnection or Node or Interface depending on the provided *type*. If does not exist, None is returned.

Return type
Optional[Union[*InterfaceConnection*, *Node*, *Interface*]]

property id : str

Getter to obtain the ID of the graph.

property panning : Vector2

Getter to obtain the panning of the graph.

property scaling : float

Getter to obtain the scaling of the graph.

to_json(as_str: *bool* = **True**, minify: *bool* = **False**) → str | dict

Convert a dataflow graph to the JSON format.

Parameters

as_str : bool, optional
Determine return type. By default, True.

Returns
Representation of the dataflow graph in JSON. If *as_str* is *True*, JSON in str is returned. Otherwise, a Python dictionary is returned.

Return type
Union[Dict, str]

10.5 Specification of Node

class pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.entities.**Node**(specification_builder: SpecificationBuilder, for_subgraph_node: *bool* = **False**, **kwargs)

Representation of a node in a dataflow graph.

get(type: *NodeAttributeType*, **kwargs) → list[*Property*] | list[*Interface*]

Get either properties or interfaces matching criteria.

Parameters

type : NodeAttributeType
Type of an item to retrieve.

kwargs : Any
Criteria, which items have to satisfy.

Returns
List of either Property or Interface instances.

Return type
Union[List[*Property*], List[*Interface*]]

get_interfaces_by_regex(pattern: *str*) → list[*Interface*]

Find interfaces with names matching *pattern*.

Parameters

pattern : str
Regular expression used to match the names of the interfaces.

Returns
List of interfaces matching *pattern* with their names.

Return type
List[*Interface*]

get_number_of_dynamic_interfaces(interface_name: *str*) → int

Get a number of dynamic interfaces with a given name.

Parameters

interface_name : str
Name of the dynamic interface without any indices.

Returns
Number of dynamic interfaces.

Return type
int

Raises

- **NoInterfaceMatchedError** – Raised if multiple properties representing the same number of dynamic interfaces exist.
- **NotDynamicInterfaceError** – Raised if the provided interface is non-dynamic.

get_property(property_name: *str*) → Any

Convenient getter to get value of a property of a node.

Parameters

property_name : str
Name of the property.

Returns
Value of the property.

Return type
Any

Raises
MissingPropertyError – Raised if the supplied name is not associated with any property.

static init_subgraph_node(specification_builder: SpecificationBuilder, name: *str*, subgraph: *Any*, **kwargs) → *Node*

An alternative constructor of Node object.

Not for external use. Use *GraphBuilder.create_subgraph_node(...)* instead.

Parameters

specification_builder : *SpecificationBuilder*
Specification builder with loaded specification.

name : str
Name of the node.

subgraph : *DataflowGraph*
Dataflow graph that this node should contain.

Returns
Constructed Node object containing a subgraph.

Return type
Node

Raises
RuntimeError – Raised if *graph_id* of a non-existent graph is provided.

move(new_position: *Vector2*, relative: *bool* = **False**)

Change a position of the node.

Change a position of the node either in a relative manner or an absolute manner. Values are clamped to stay in the range of values.

Parameters

new_position : Vector2
If *relative* is False, then this a new position. Otherwise, it is a displacement (movement) vector.

relative : bool, optional
Whether position should be calculated based on the previous one (True) or not (False), by default False.

property name : str

Getter to retrieve name of the node.

set_number_of_dynamic_interfaces(interface_name: *str*, new_count: *int*)

Set a number of dynamic interfaces to *new_count*.

Parameters

interface_name : str
Name of the dynamic interface.

new_count : int
Number of the dynamic interfaces that should exist in the end.

Raises

- **ValueError** – Raised if: - new interface count is equal to or lower than 0, - interface name is associated with none of the interfaces,
- **MultipleInterfacesSelectedError** – Raised if the interface name is associated with more than one interface.
- **MissingInterfaceAttributeError** – Raised if the interface is not dynamic due to missing *dynamic* attribute.
- **NotDynamicInterfaceError** – Raised if the interface is not dynamic due to explicit definition in the specification.
- **InterfaceCountError** – Raised if either maximum interface count from the specification was exceeded or it has gone below a minimum interface count from the specification.

set_property(property_name: *str*, property_value: *Any*) → None

Convenient setter to change value of a property of the node.

Parameters

property_name : str
Name of the property.

property_value : Any
New value of a property.

Return type
None

Raises
MissingPropertyError – Raised if property with the supplied *property_named* was not found.

to_json(as_str=**True**, minify=**False**) → str | dict

Convert a dataflow graph to the JSON format.

Parameters

as_str : bool, optional
Determine return type. By default, True.

Returns
Representation of the dataflow graph in JSON. If *as_str* is *True*, JSON in str is returned. Otherwise, a Python dictionary is returned.

Return type
Union[Dict, str]

10.6 Specification of Interface

class pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.entities.**Interface**(name: str, direction: ~pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.data_ side: ~pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.data_ | None = None, side_position: int | None = None, external_name: str | None = None, id: str = <factory>, type: ~typing.List[str] = <factory>, bus: ~pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.entit | None = None, hidden: bool | None = None)

Representation of a node's interface.

to_json(as_str: *bool* = **True**, minify: *bool* = **False**) → str | dict

Convert a dataflow graph to the JSON format.

Parameters

as_str : bool, optional
Determine return type. By default, True.

Returns
Representation of the dataflow graph in JSON. If *as_str* is *True*, JSON in str is returned. Otherwise, a Python dictionary is returned.

Return type
Union[Dict, str]

10.7 Specification of Connection

Notice that name of the class representing connection is `InterfaceConnection`, not `Connection`.

class pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.entities.**InterfaceConnection**(from_interface: ~pipeline_manager.dataflow_b | ~pipeline_manager.dataflow_b to_interface: ~pipeline_manager.dataflow_b | ~pipeline_manager.dataflow_b anchors: ~typ- ing.List[~pipeline_manager.da | None = None, id: str = <factory>)

Representation of a connection between two interfaces in a dataflow graph.

to_json(as_str: *bool* = **True**, minify: *bool* = **False**) → str | dict

Convert a dataflow graph to the JSON format.

Parameters

as_str : bool, optional
Determine return type. By default, True.

Returns
Representation of the dataflow graph in JSON. If *as_str* is *True*, JSON in str is returned. Otherwise, a Python dictionary is returned.

Return type
Union[Dict, str]

10.8 Specification of Property

class pipeline_manager.dataflow_builder.entities.**Property**(name: *str*, type: *str* | *None* = **None**, default: *Any* | *None* = **None**, value: *Any* | *None* = **None**, values: *list[Any]* | *None* = **None**, min: *str* | *None* = **None**, max: *str* | *None* = **None**, dtype: *str* | *None* = **None**, group: *dict[str, Any]* | *None* = **None**, dynamic_counter: *bool* | *None* = **None**, id: *str* = '20e32fd4-bb6c-4f88-8c62-ebaa52418822' hidden: *bool* | *None* = **None**)

A property of a node.

to_json(as_str: *bool* = **True**, minify: *bool* = **False**) → dict | str

Convert a dataflow graph to the JSON format.

Parameters

as_str : bool, optional
Determine return type. By default, True.

Returns
Representation of the dataflow graph in JSON. If *as_str* is *True*, JSON in str is returned. Otherwise, a Python dictionary is returned.

Return type
Union[Dict, str]

CHAPTER

ELEVEN

CUSTOM SHAPED NODE

Pipeline Manager gives option for defining nodes with custom shapes defined in SVG files. It allows to have nodes of any shape representing any objects.

11.1 Quickstart

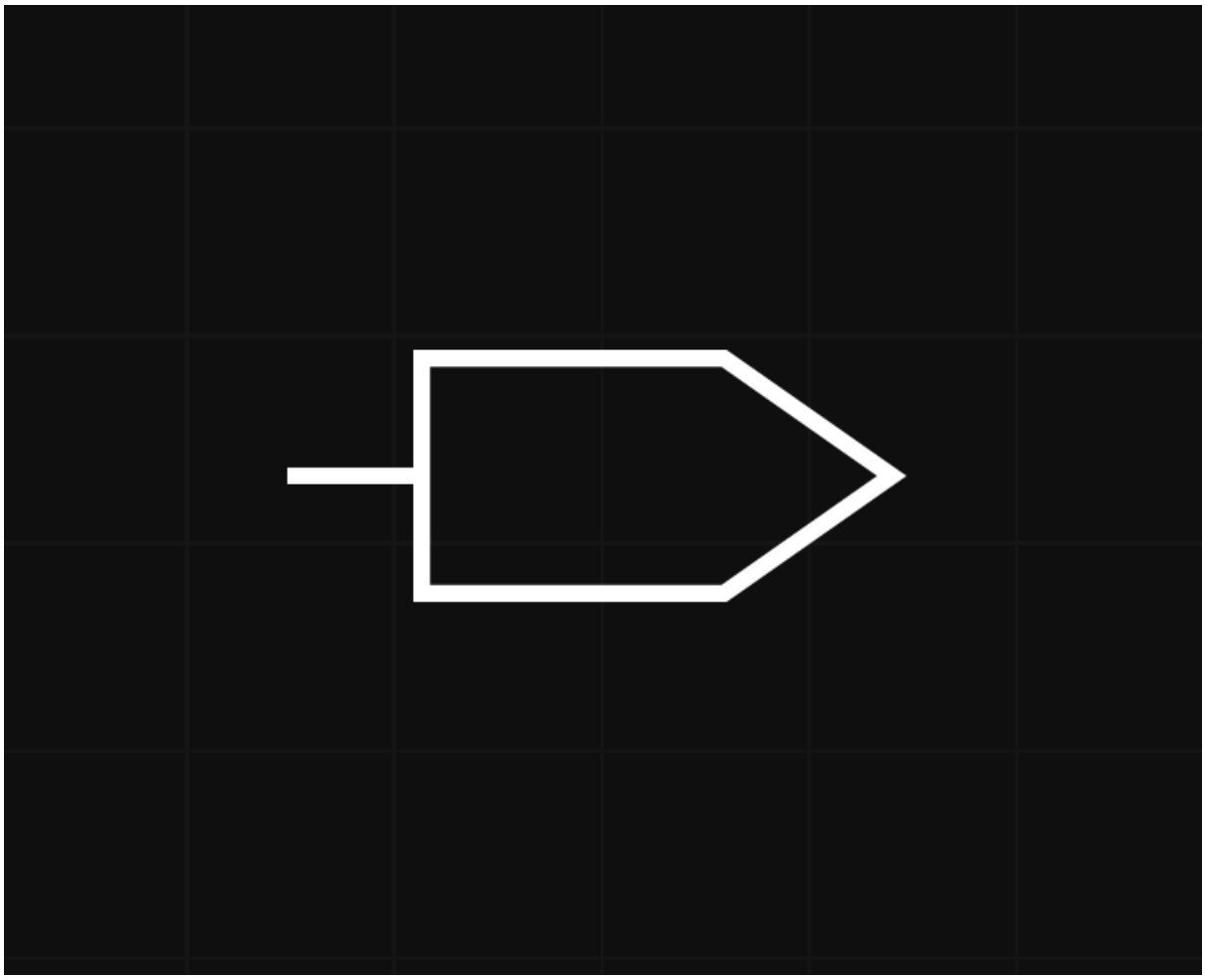
To create a custom shaped node, a style for that node needs to be defined in the metadata. In node style, provide a URL path to SVG file with desired shape, using `shape` attribute:

```
"metadata": {
    "styles":{
        "MyCustomShape": {
            "shape": "https://raw.githubusercontent.com/antmicro/kenning-pipeline-
↪manager/refs/heads/main/docs/source/_static/svgs/bidirectional.svg"
        },
    }
}
```

Then in specification nodes list, user adds created style:

```
"nodes": [
    {
        "name": "bidirectional",
        "style": "MyCustomShape"
    },
]
```

Once the specification is loaded, user should be able to add a node with the custom shape in the editor:



11.2 Custom shaped node styling

Custom shaped node supports setting `width` and `height` through node specification, allowing for different node size. This allows for having two nodes with the same shape but different sizes.

11.3 Interfaces with custom position

For greater flexibility, custom shaped nodes use interfaces with positions defined by user.

Positions for interfaces are defined in node's style like the custom shape. Positioned interfaces support two additional sides - `top` and `bottom` Side of interfaces should be provided explicitly by user in the specification - it is used for rendering connections. `positions` attribute is used for setting positions of interfaces, where each `position` subattribute is named after the interface to which position should be applied. Positions are defined in `x` and `y` coordinates relative to node top-left corner and are specified in percentage of node width in case of `x` coordinate and in percentage of node height in case of `y` coordinates.

Example positioned interfaces configuration, for node with two interfaces:

```
"metadata": {
    "styles":{
        "VoltageStyle":{
```

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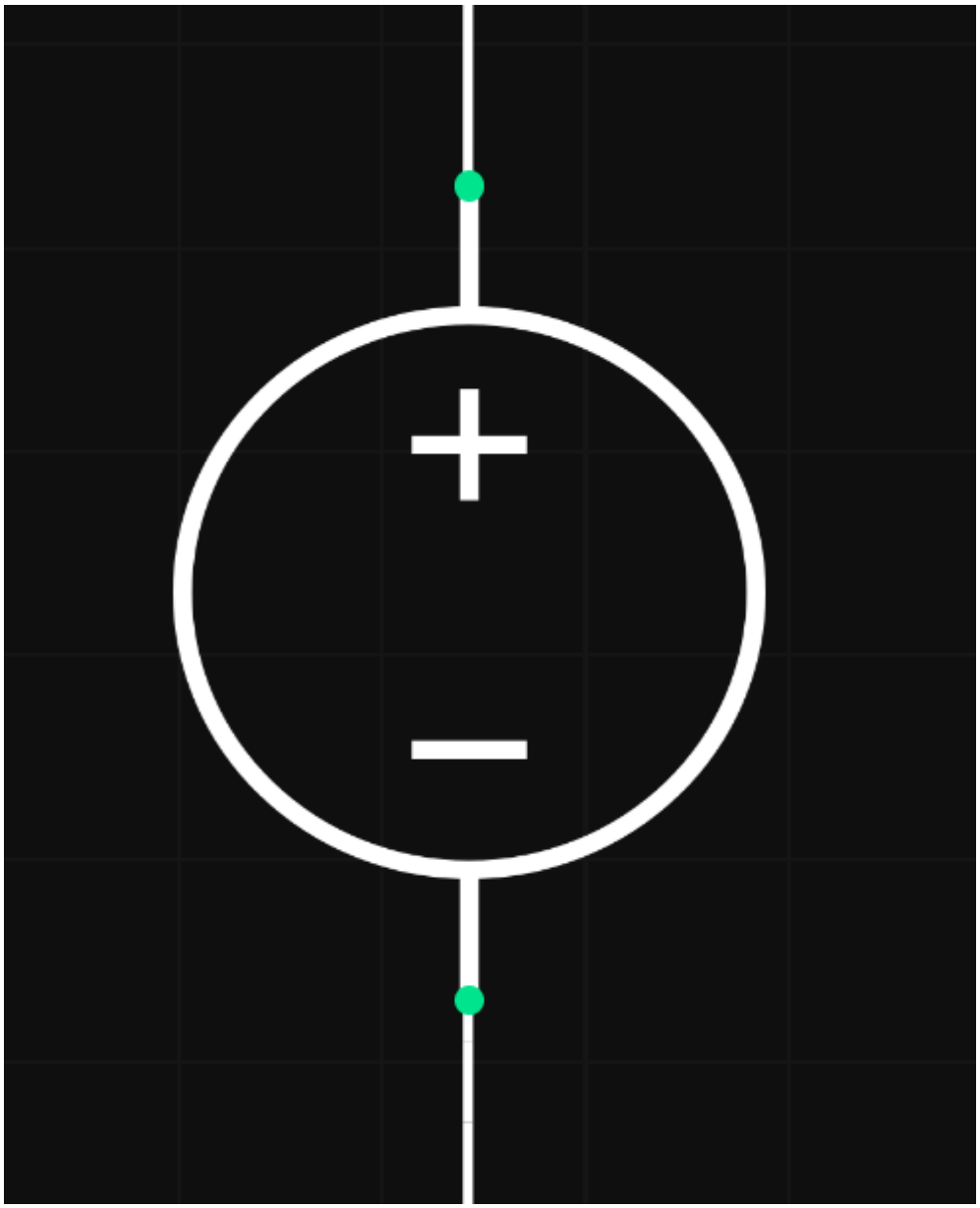
```
            "shape": "localhost:3000/svgs/voltage.svg",
            "positions": {
                "a": {
                    "x": 50,
                    "y": 0
                },
                "b": {
                    "x": 50,
                    "y": 95
                }
            }
        },
    }
}
```

In this configuration `VoltageStyle` is the style used for node representing voltage symbol in electronic circuits and have two interfaces with defined positions, node specification:

```
"nodes": [
    {
        "name": "Voltage",
        "interfaces": [
            {"name": "a", "direction": "inout", "side": "top"},
            {"name": "b", "direction": "inout", "side": "bottom"}
        ],
        "style": "VoltageStyle"
    },
]
```

`x` coordinate for `a` and `b` interfaces are set to 50% which means they are centred, `a` interface `y` coordinate is set to 0% which means it is placed at top of the node, for `b` interface `y` is set to 95% which places it slightly above the bottom of the node.

`Voltage` node should look like this in the Pipeline Manager editor:



It is possible to hide interface names permanently by using `hiddenNames` property in node's style. User can provide a list with names of interfaces that should have hidden name or set property to `all`, which makes all interfaces names to hide permanently. Example usage of `hiddenNames`:

```
"NPNStyle":
    {
        "shape": "svgs/npn.svg",
        "hiddenNames": [
            "c",
            "b",
            "e"
        ],
        "positions": {
            "c": {
                "x": 81,
                "y": 0
```

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```
            },
            "b": {
                "x": 0,
                "y": 50
            },
            "e": {
                "x": 81,
                "y": 100
            }
        }
    },
```

11.4 Adding positioned interfaces

When node shape is set, `Add interface` option in a context menu allows for setting interface side and interface position. After `Add interface` button in the context menu is pressed, user simply clicks on the part of the node where the interface should be placed. It automatically updates node's specification and node's style, so changes are permanent and can be exported through specification saving.

CHAPTER

TWELVE

SPHINX EXTENSION FOR PIPELINE MANAGER

Pipeline Manager provides Sphinx extension that allows drawing graphs inside documentation.

To use it, first include `pipeline_manager` in your installed packages, with following extra dependencies:

- `docs` - optional, brings Sphinx and dependencies that allows converting Pipeline Manager graphs to images automatically for documentation types other than HTML (e.g. PDF).

Secondly, add `pipeline_manager.sphinxext` to `extensions` in Sphinx's `conf.py` file:

```
extensions = [
    ...,
    "pipeline_manager.sphinxext.draw_graph"
]
```

After these steps you should be able to define Pipeline Manager graph like so:

````
```{pipeline_manager}
:spec: ../examples/sample-specification.json
:graph: ../examples/sample-dataflow.json
```
````

When building the docs, a static single-html `pipeline-manager.html` is created in the static directory of the docs. Any specification or dataflow referenced by the extension will be copied to downloads subdirectory and automatically linked in the final docs. If the docs are not built in html, images will be included in the documentation.

12.1 Directive parameters

The `pipeline_manager` directive allows for following parameters:

- `spec` - required, points to specification that should be used for the graph.
- `graph` - optional, points to dataflow that should be used for the graph.
- `preview` - optional, if set, the graph is displayed in preview mode (read only, no HUD).
- `height` - optional, specifies height of the graph in chosen units, `px/%/em` etc. Unit has to be specified. If height was not set, aspect ratio of 3/2 will be assumed.
- `width` - optional, specifies width of the graph in chosen units, `px/%/em` etc. Unit has to be specified. If width was not set, 100% will be assumed.
- `alt` - optional, changes alternative text of the graph.

- `center_at_top` - optional, determines whether to center the editor at the topmost node after loading.

So for example this is a valid directive usage:

```
```{pipeline_manager}
:spec: ../examples/specification.json
:height: 500px
:alt: This is an example of using pipeline manager in documentation
:preview:
```
```

12.2 draw_graph extension documentation

12.2.1 KPMNode

class pipeline_manager.sphinxext.draw_graph.**KPMNode**(** (Keyword-only parameters separator (PEP 3102))*, depth*: int*, preview*: bool | None* = **None**, spec*: str | None* = **None**, graph*: str | None* = **None**, height*: str | None* = **None**, alt*: str | None* = **None**, width*: str | None* = **None**, center_at_top*: bool | None* = **None**)

Docutils node introducing Pipeline Manager graph to docs.

static visit_html(trans*: HTML5Translator*, node*:* KPMNode)

Node renderer method for HTML target.

12.2.2 KPMDirective

class pipeline_manager.sphinxext.draw_graph.**KPMDirective**(name, arguments, options, content, lineno, content_offset, block_text, state, state_machine)

Sphinx directive for pipeline_manager.

build_image_node(workspace_dir*: Path*) → Node

Build a PNG image of the graph and return a node for the current builder.

option_spec : dict[str, type] = {'alt': <function unchanged>, 'center_at_top': <function unchanged>, 'graph': <function path>, 'height': <function unchanged>, 'preview': <function flag>, 'spec': <function path>, 'width': <function unchanged>}

Mapping of option names to validator functions.

run() → list[Node]

Creates nodes for the directive. This method is called for each graph encountered.

pipeline_manager.sphinxext.draw_graph.**build_pipeline_manager_once**(app, workspace_dir*: Path*) → None

Builds Pipeline Manager frontend on builder's initialization only once.

CHAPTER

THIRTEEN

DATAFLOW AND SPECIFICATION FORMAT CHANGELOG

Formats of dataflows and specification is often updated with new features, that makes former formats incompatible with the new ones. This section lists all versions, related features and breaking changes.

13.1 20250623.14

Commit SHA - `8938cb326abc59ee8a7d506f9285954a8c6a027c`

- Nodes:
  - `direction` is now optional, the default value is `inout`
  - Added `color` for both node specification and node dataflow instance allowing to customize the background color of the node title
  - Nodes no longer have to have `category` field - node types are created at the root level by default
  - Added `dynamic` field allowing to modify number of interfaces with dedicated node properties during runtime
- Properties:
  - Added `multiline` node property, which renders Markdown inside of node
  - Added `readonly` property field allowing to forbid value modification from UI
- Subgraphs:
  - Introduced new simplified implementation
  - Subgraphs do not have to be defined for graph nodes
  - Graph nodes can have properties
- Metadata:
  - Added `urloverrides` allowing to modify metadata URLs of included specifications
  - Added `editableTypes` field to metadata allowing to:
    - Add new node types from UI
    - Modify node types from UI with:
      - forms and buttons
      - YAML-based editor

- Added node styling:
  - `styles` in metadata defines `icon` and `color` for each named style:
    - `icon` is secondary, displayed on the right side of the node title
    - `color` is the same as in node specification, however, it has lower priority
  - `style` in the node type specification allows to use and combine styles defined in metadata
  - `include` supports new value - a pair `{"url": "...", "style": "..."}`

13.2 20240723.13

Warning

This update changes the existing format of specification and dataflow.

Commit SHA - TODO

- Added `includeGraphs` field allowing to include graphs in the specification as subgraphs
- Added `include` field allowing to include partial specification to the specification
- Replaced `graph` field with `graphs` list
- The default graph now can be:
  - the first entry in the `graphs` list
  - the graph from `graphs`, where `id` of the graph is equal to `entryGraph`
- Replaced `subgraphs` in specification with `graphs` that have the exact same format as regular graphs
- Introduced `externalName` for graph nodes
- Fixed `list` type for properties - now they can be defined as lists in the graph, and display/modified as space-separated entries
- Improved Markdown-based rendering of description

13.3 20230523.12

Warning

This update changes the existing format of specification and dataflow.

Commit SHA - `006998910f871da00c49ef00625e5d8bccf3a9c3`

- Introduced changes in dataflow and specification formats:
  - Removed `interfaces` property from graphs, which were used to define interface nodes for subgraphs.

  - Instead of “interface nodes”, a new property was added to regular interfaces of nodes, called `externalName`.
  - `externalName`, when not empty, indicates that the interface is an outer interface of the subgraph, which should be exposed with the name from this field.

13.4 20230830.11

> **Warning**
>
> This update changes the existing format of specification and dataflow.

Commit SHA - `0bee99e152a408650590bb6ea4210e96502b33ef`

- Introduced changes in dataflow and specification formats:
  - `type -> name` for dataflows for consistency with specification naming
  - `name -> instanceName` for dataflows to make it more explicit and avoid conflicts
  - `type -> layer` for nodes in specification. This property is now also optional.
  - `nodeTypes -> nodeLayers` in `layers` keywords in metadata
  - `checkbox -> bool` for property type
  - `graphTemplateInstances -> subgraphs` for dataflow and specification.
- Added converter from version `20230824.10` to `20230523.12`
- Added `abstract` parameter for node types to define abstract types.
- Added `isCategory` parameter that allows defining category nodes which serve both as a node and category.

13.5 20230824.10

Commit SHA - `6ce3bf106353bc58fb8e7217b9bc8aa7db9ebd20`

- Choosing an entry graph that is rendered to the user when loading a subgraph dataflow is now possible using the `entryGraph` property.

13.6 20230824.9

Commit SHA - `de31d01d9b6591993559e3b10851815f3320e545`

- Introduced `description` keyword for nodes that allows displaying Markdown-based description in a sidebar.

13.7 20230818.8

Commit SHA - `d4abcc80bce3e280120078a47d784eff92821a8a`

- Introduced `group` keyword for checkbox property which allows defining groups of properties that can be disabled.

13.8 20230817.7

Commit SHA - `5946db06d8f42a33934a07fba95634aa8a70c78e`

- Format of subgraph dataflows and specifications is redesigned. Details can be found in *Dataflow format* and *Specification format*.
- Dataflow
  - `SubgraphIO` was renamed to `interfaces` and its properties were changed.
  - Connections are now defined using `connections` property instead of `nodeInterfaceId` keyword.
- Specification
  - `id` property for nodes and connections in subgraphs is no longer required.
  - Connections are now defined using `connections` property instead of `nodeInterface` keyword.

13.9 20230809.6

Commit SHA - `59b04f8bc9cd0ce1cb757dcc4027750e1275d935`

- Introduced `anchors` for connections, which is a list of coordinates that allows rendering custom connections shapes.

13.10 20230619.5

Commit SHA - `84fe865ca44b3a80b87a2be418eedc1d1c025ee4`

- Introduced `defaultInterfaceGroups` groups of interfaces that are enabled by default.
- Implemented more verbose error logging both for interfaces and interface groups.

13.11 20230619.4

Commit SHA - `bdc4b2fb998ed9d6318a676d4ac77f92c1603d39`

- Introduced `interfaceGroups` and `enabledInterfaceGroups` keywords that allow defining groups of interfaces.
- Introduced arrays of interfaces that can be easily created using `array` keyword.
- Simplified dataflows as interfaces that have no connections are no longer saved into output `.json` files.

13.12 20230619.3

Commit SHA - `84559ae8327d7aa214c388200c5b48d112021679`

- Introduced two new keywords to the specification's `metadata`:
  - `backgroundSize` - defines size of the background grid. It has strictly visual effects.
  - `movementStep` - minimal node movement step.

- Added `additionalData` for storing some node-related data, not relevant to Pipeline Manager
- Changed `connectionSide` to `side` in dataflow and specification
- `type` of interface now can be either a single string or a list of strings.
- Introduced optional metadata keyword `layout` specifying algorithm used for automatic node position calculation.
- Introduced `randomizedOffset` keyword that adds a random offset to connections so that a layout from complex graphs can be created easier. This value propagates into dataflows.

13.13 20230615.2

Commit SHA - `711ea7224e30d342924319c3964f1cb076939a29`

- Introduced inheritance mechanism in specification - for each node type it is possible to specify `extends` list that provides information which are the base classes for a given type.

13.14 20230615.1

Commit SHA - `4e0cf99ccaa5bc3513804e8184b907ed0230985f`

- Introduced versioning for dataflow and specification format, starting with version `20230615.1`. Pipeline Manager saves the current version in a dataflow save so that when loading a dataflow an appropriate message is displayed.
- Implemented a dataflow format converter that can apply a range of patches so that an obsolete dataflow can be updated to the current format.

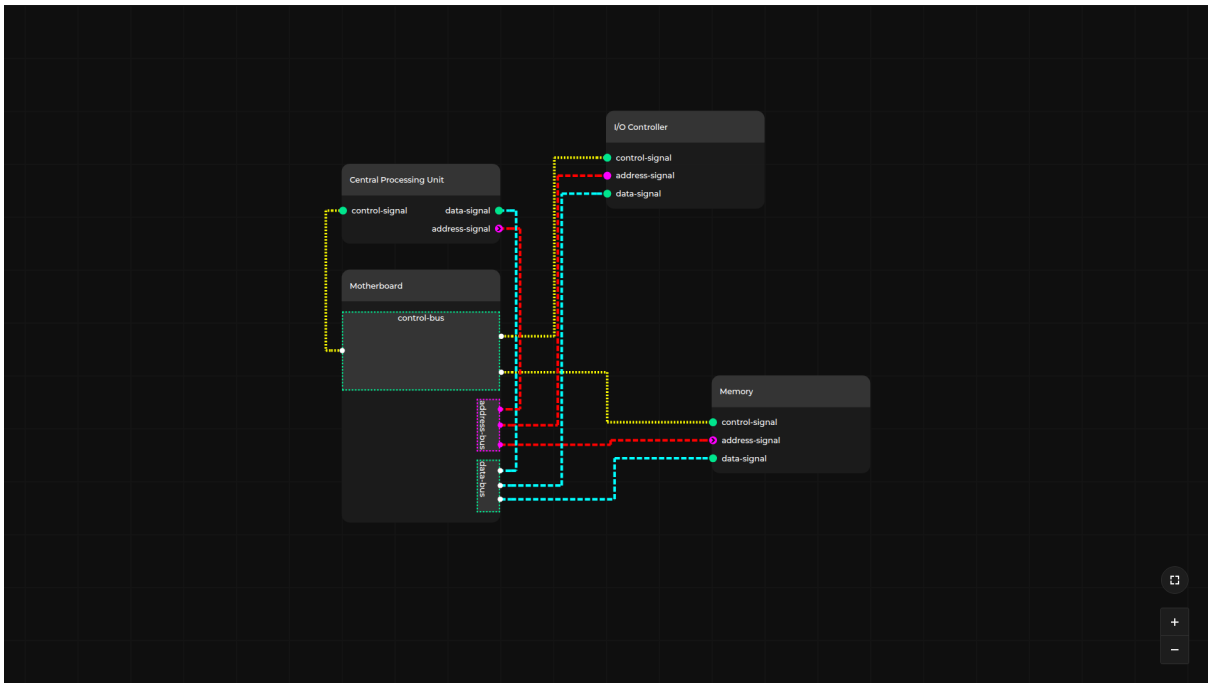
CHAPTER

FOURTEEN

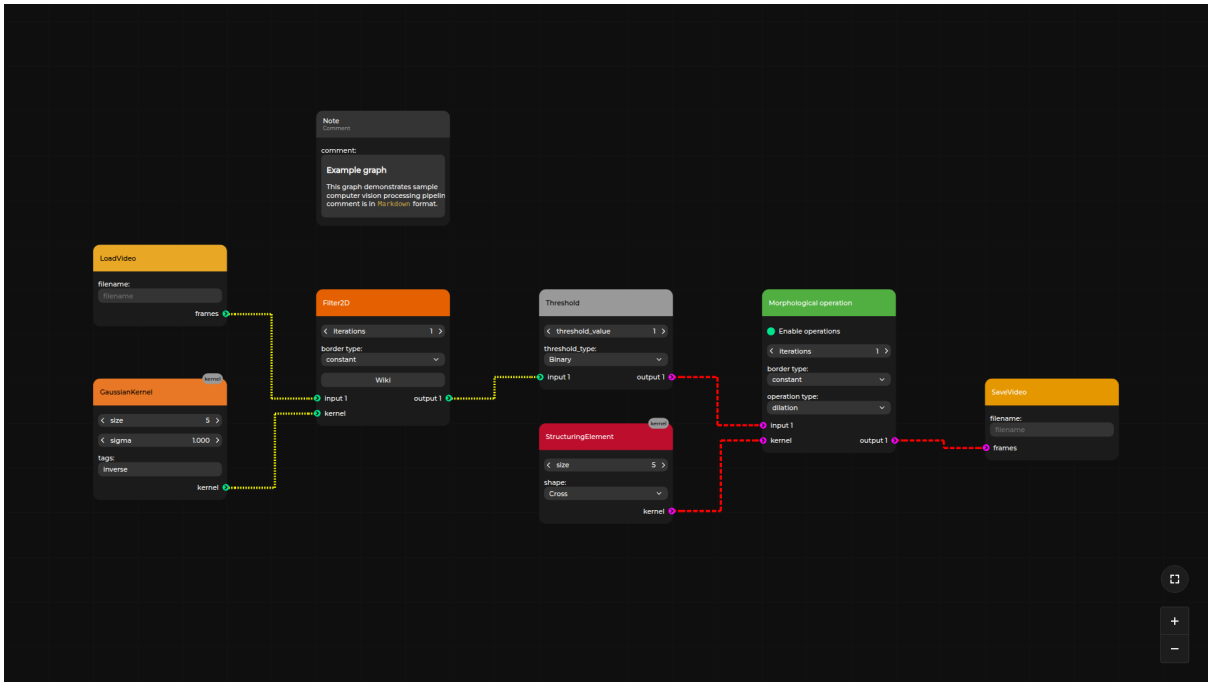
DEMONSTRATION OF THE FRONTEND

To see the work of the frontend check one of the below examples:

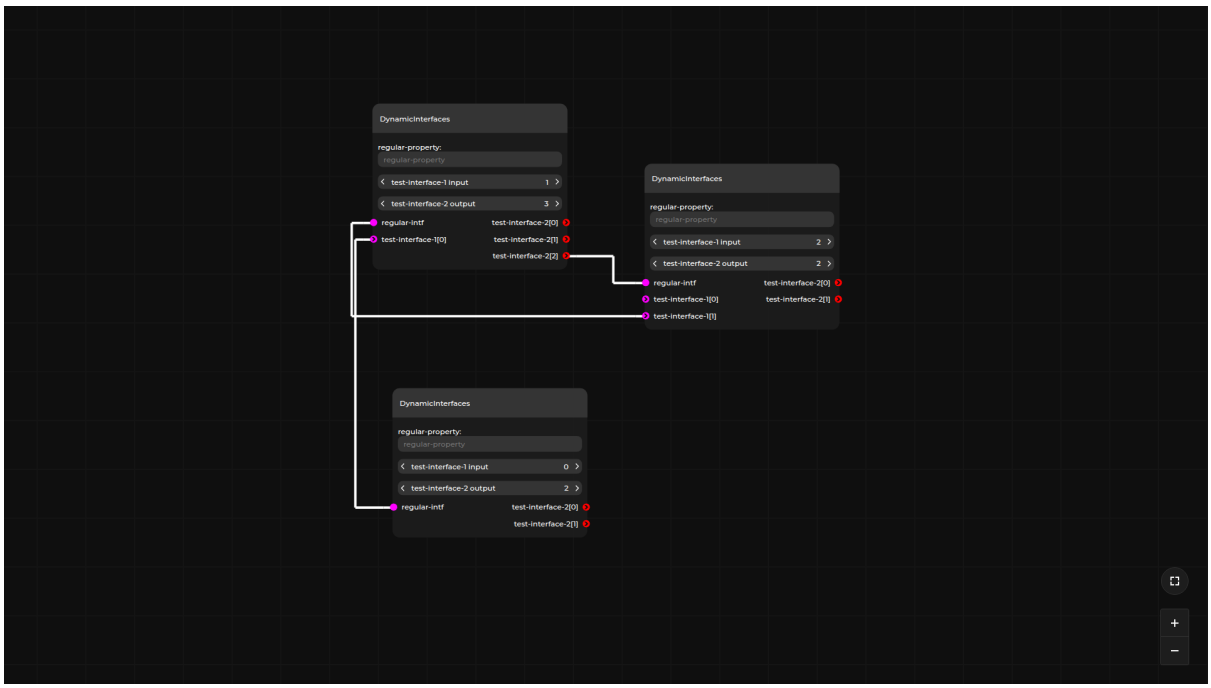
14.1 Example of a graph using BUS interface



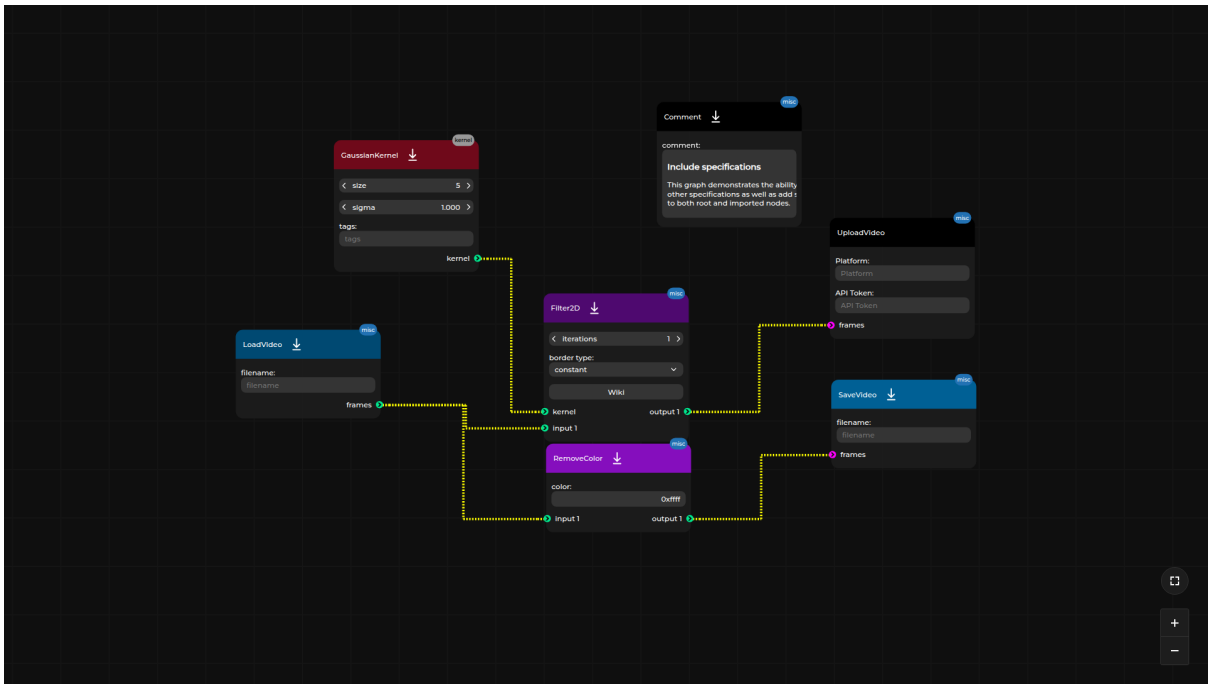
14.2 Example of a more complex graph with nodes as interfaces, inheritance and more



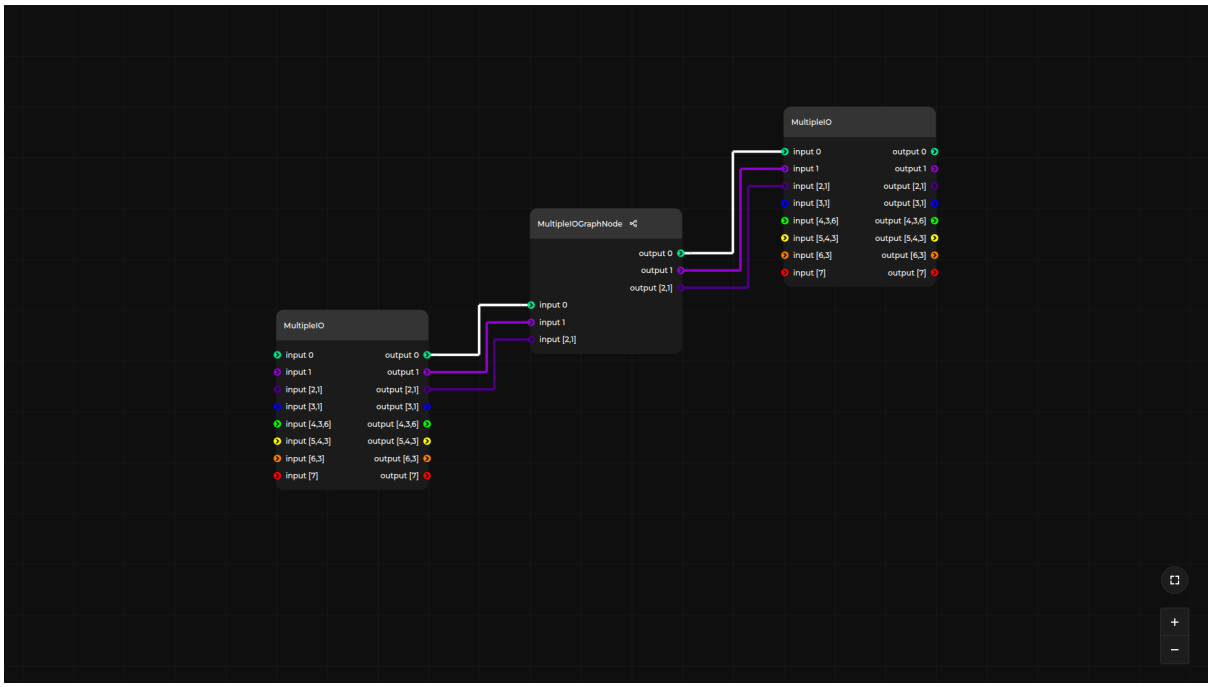
14.3 Example of a graph with dynamic number of interfaces



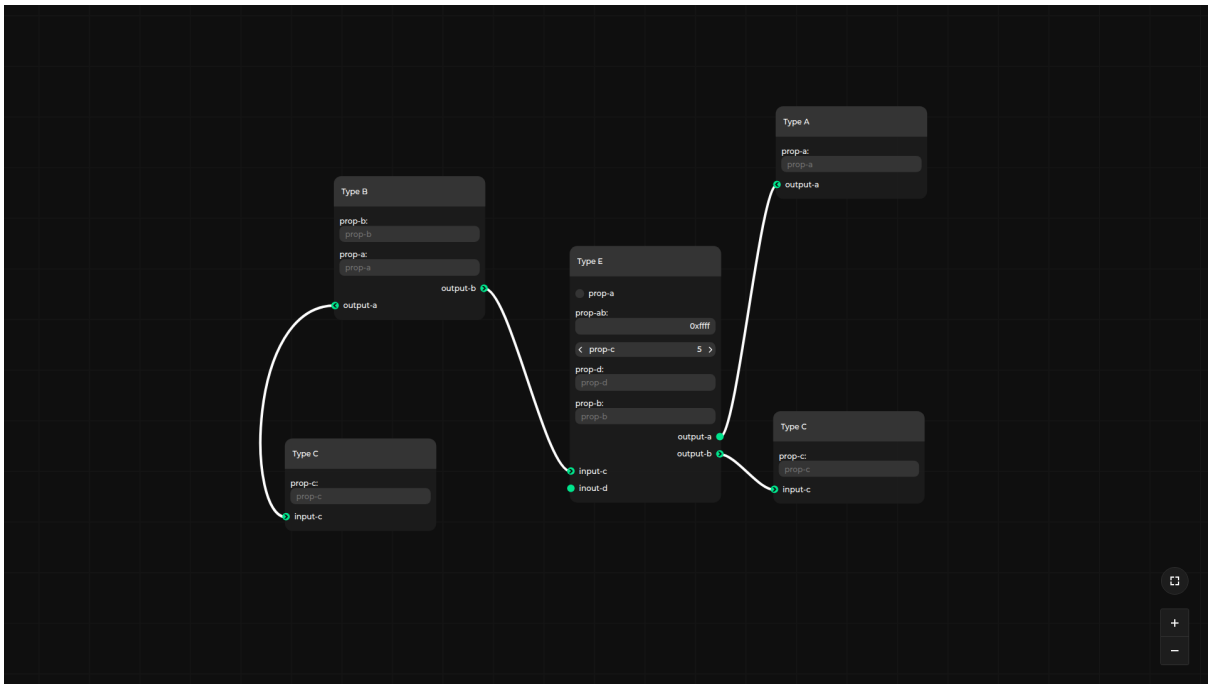
14.4 Example of the graph with include mechanisms



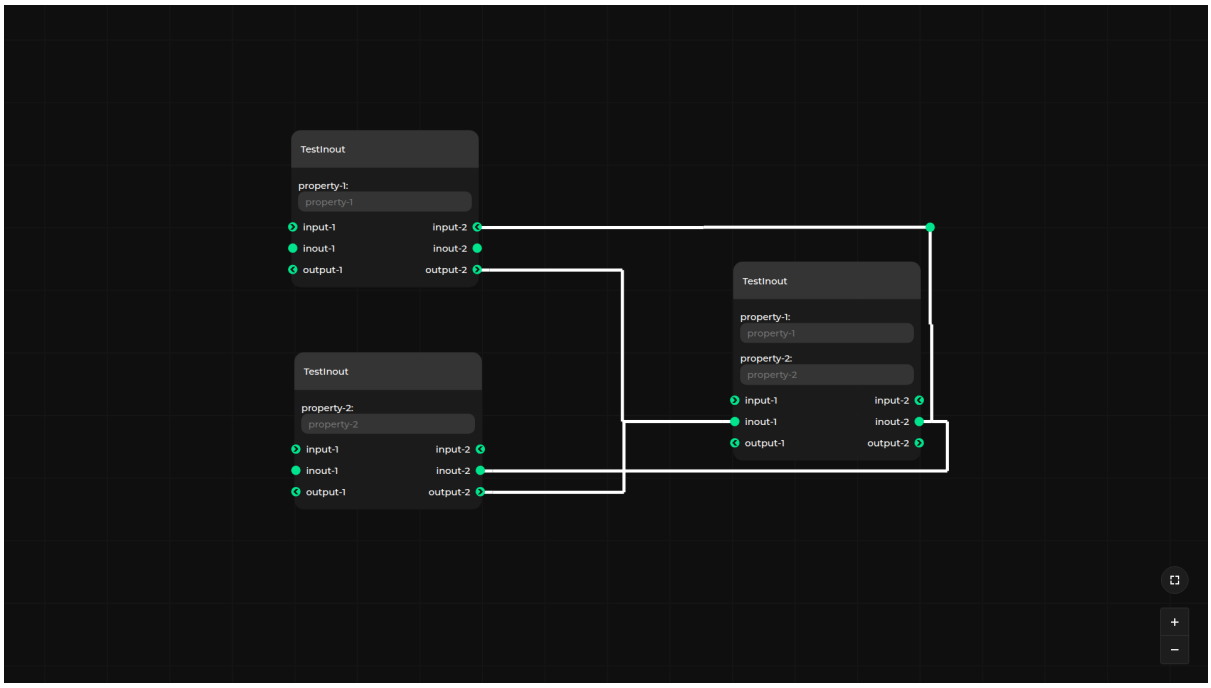
14.5 Example of the graph with top-level interfaces exposed



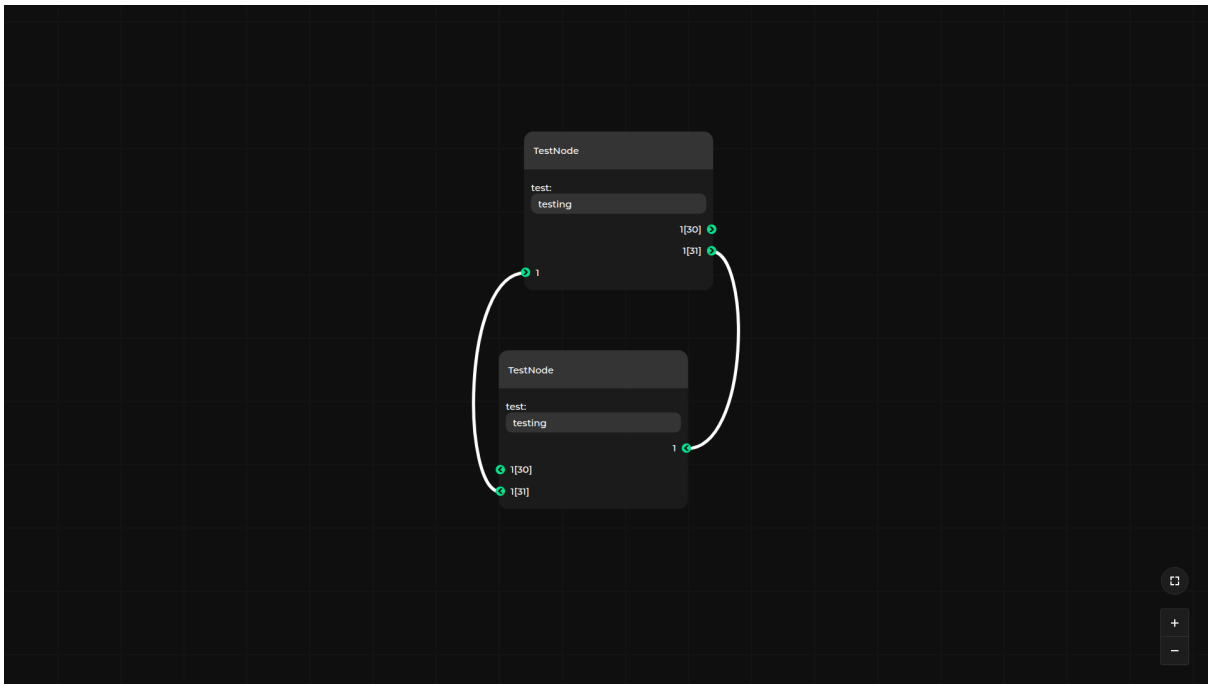
14.6 Example of graph with inheritance



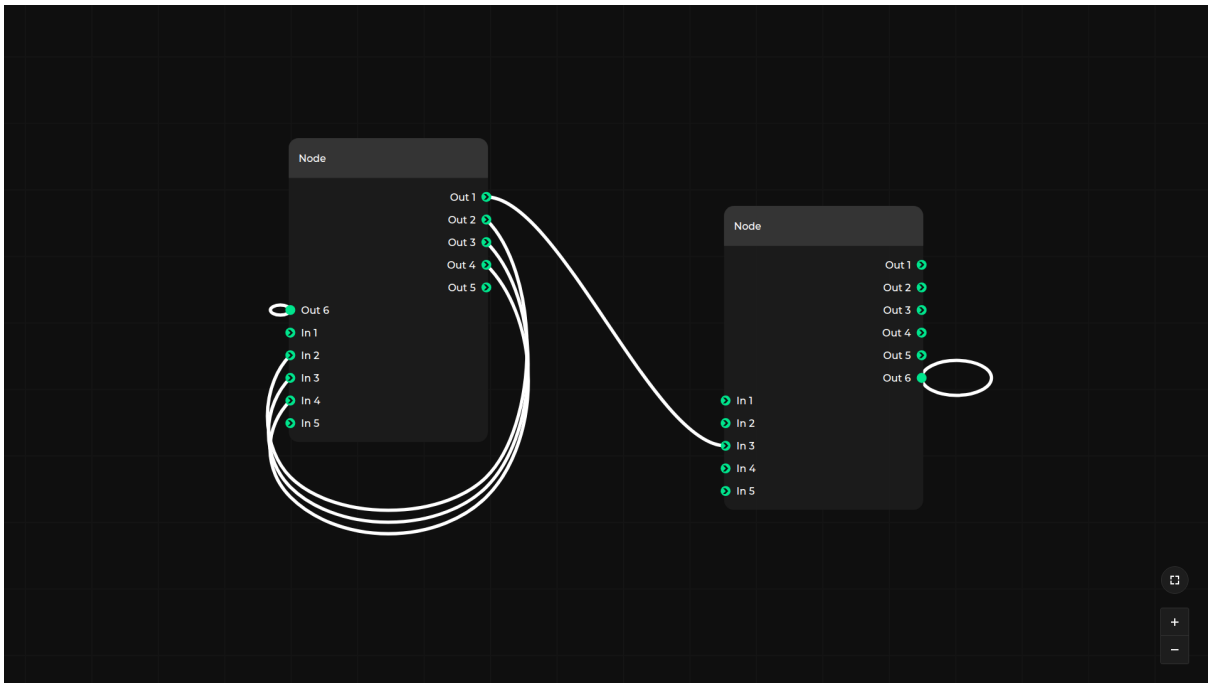
14.7 Example of Input-Output interfaces



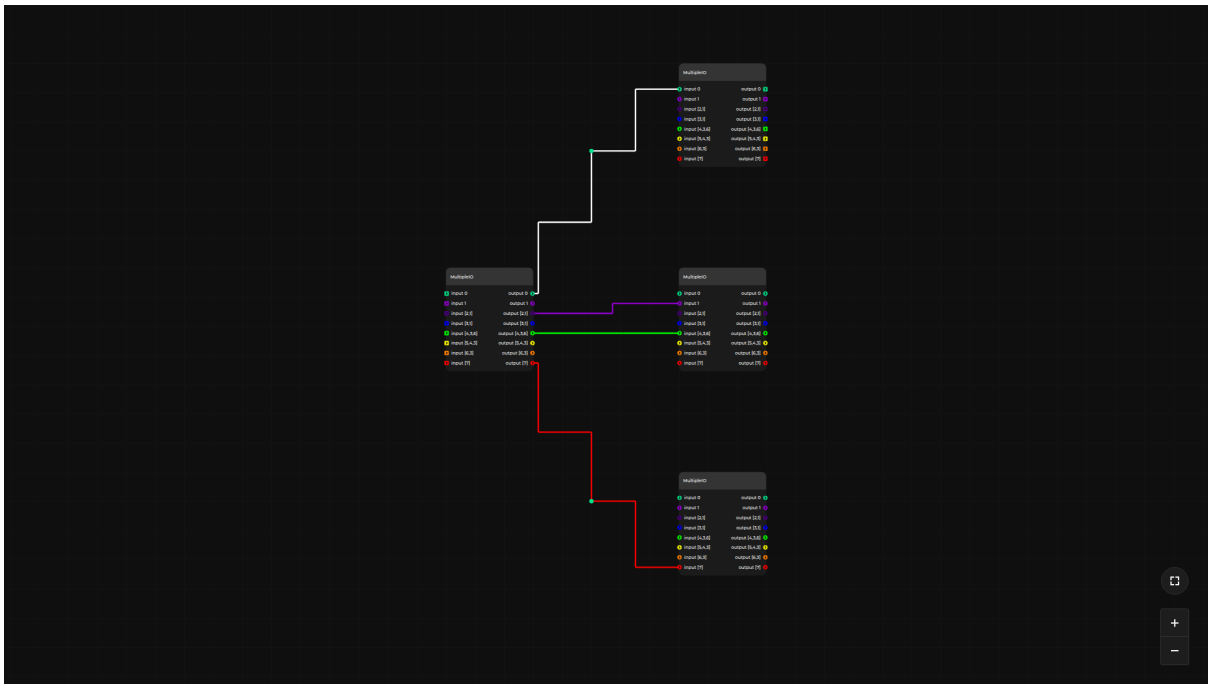
14.8 Example of interface grouping



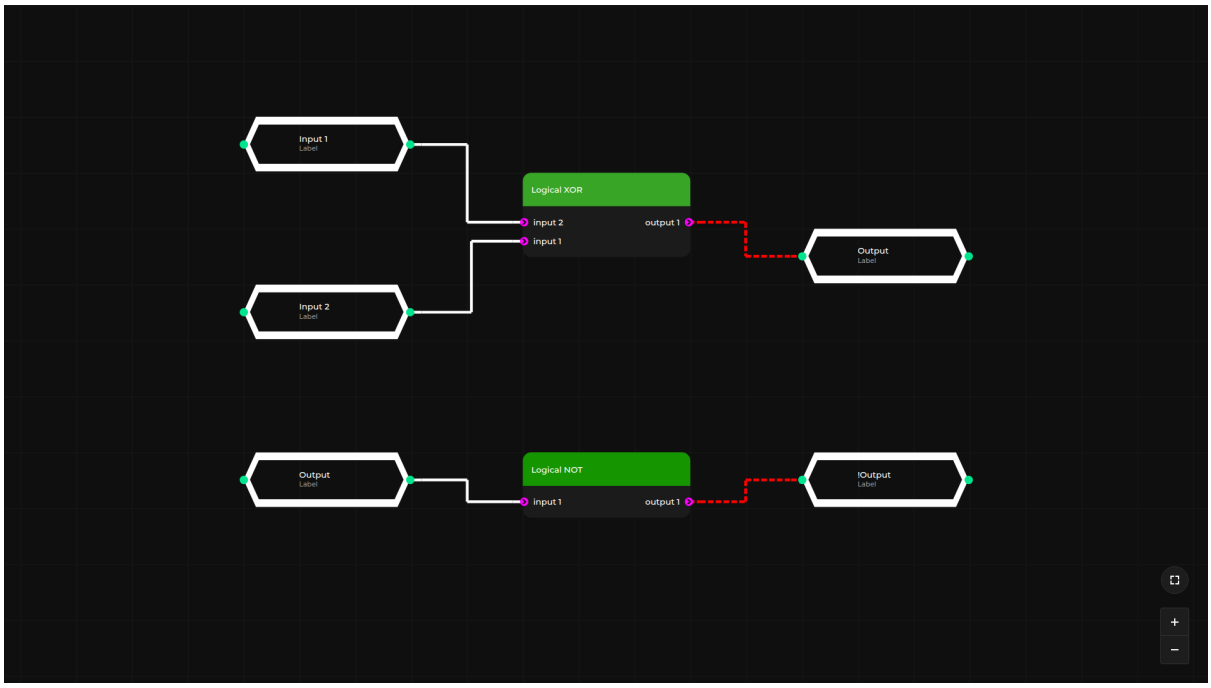
14.9 Example of graphs with connection loopbacks



14.10 Example of Multiple Input-Output node



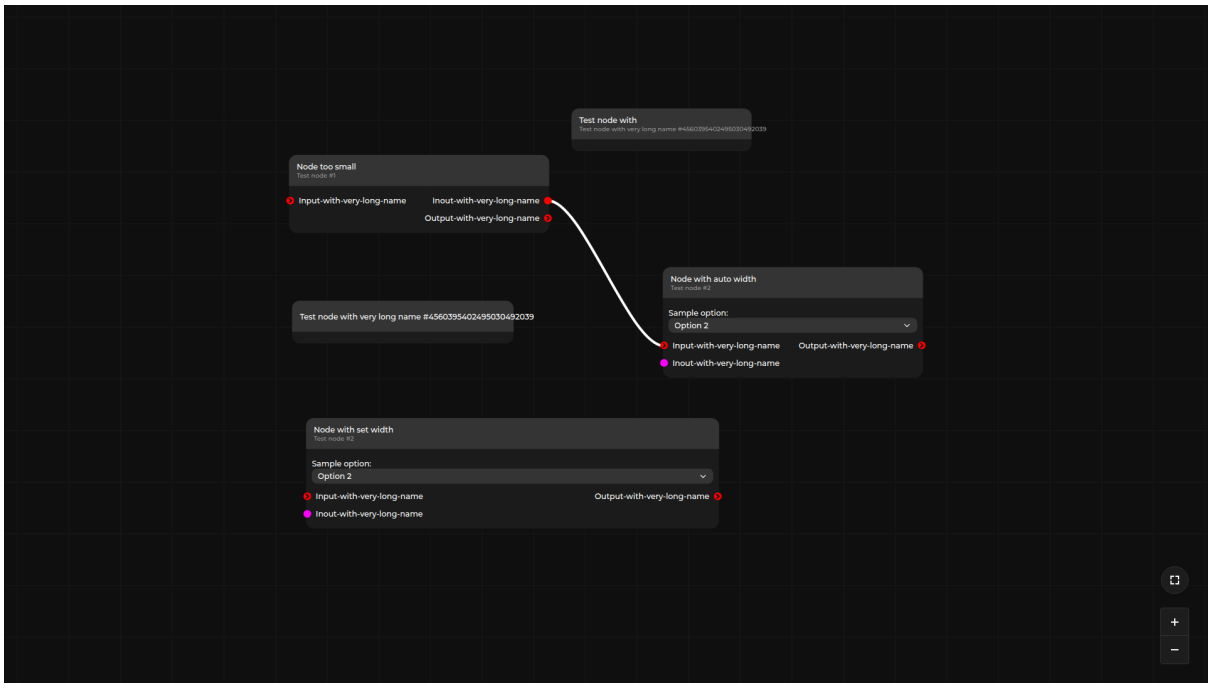
14.11 Example of a graph with port like nodes



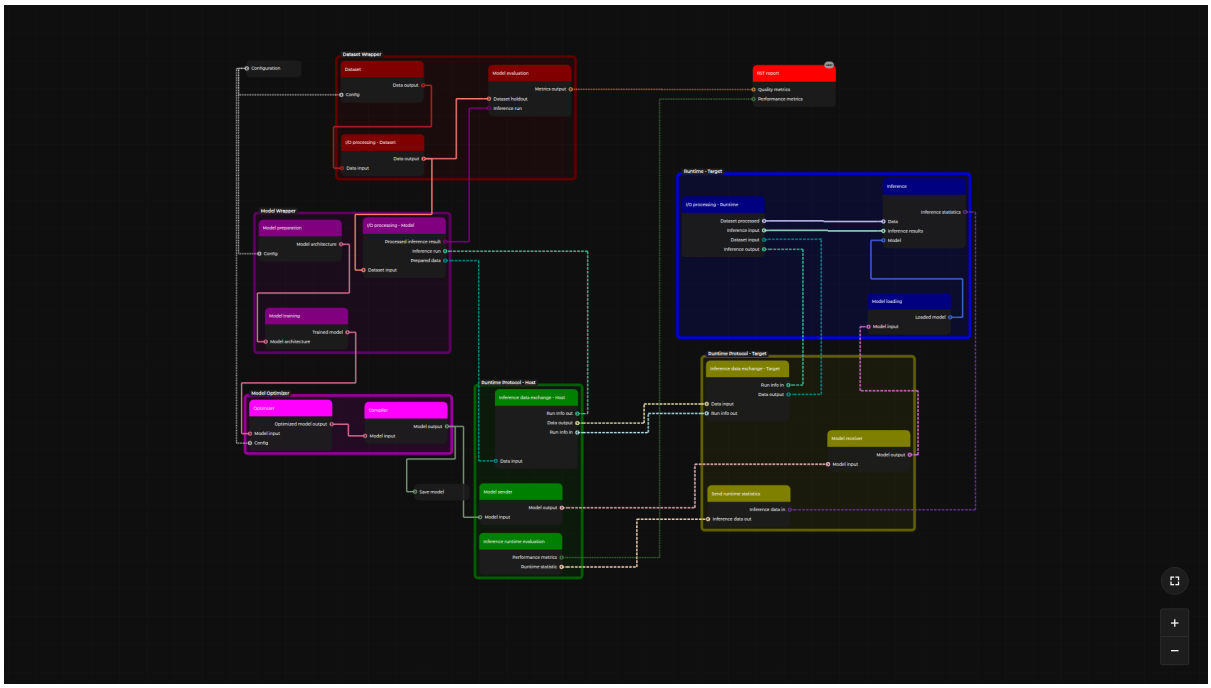
14.12 Example of a neural network graph



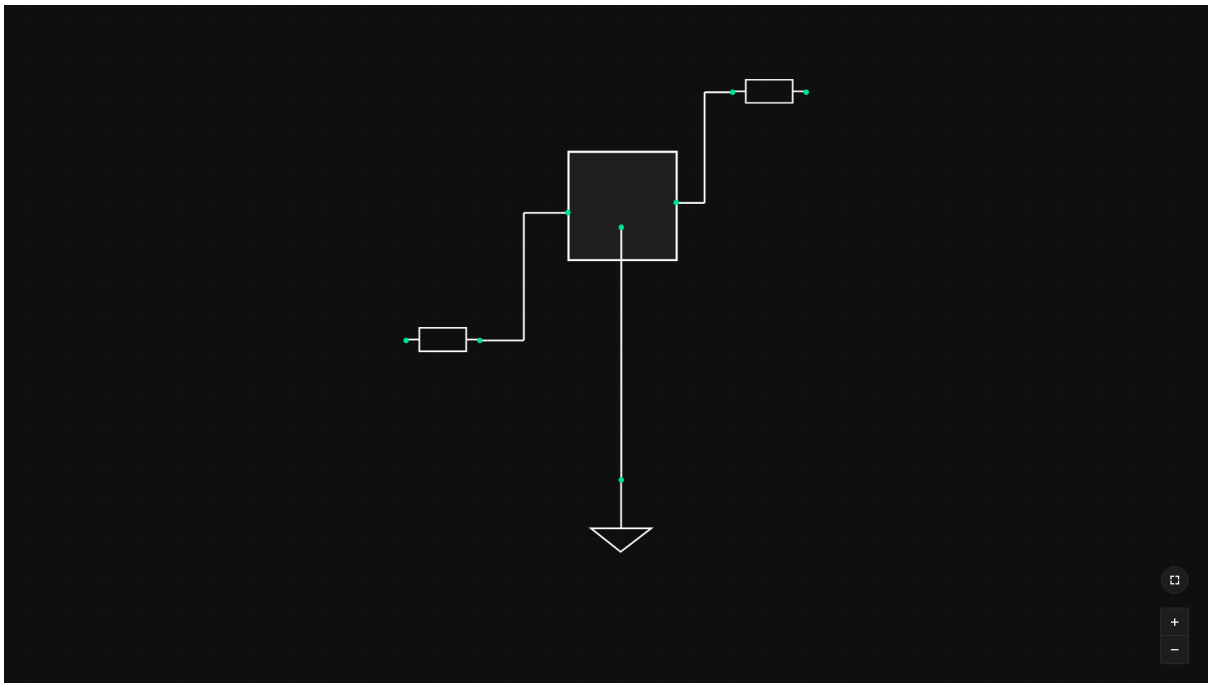
14.13 Example of a graph with different node width



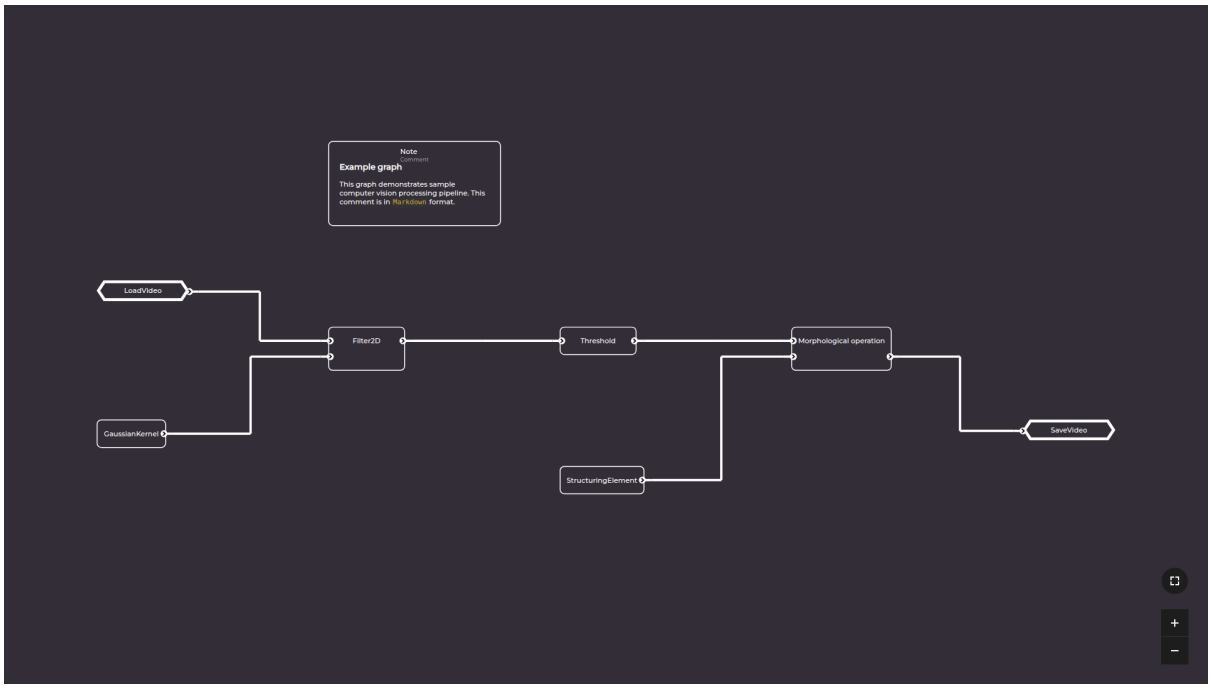
14.14 Example of the graph with rectangle groupings



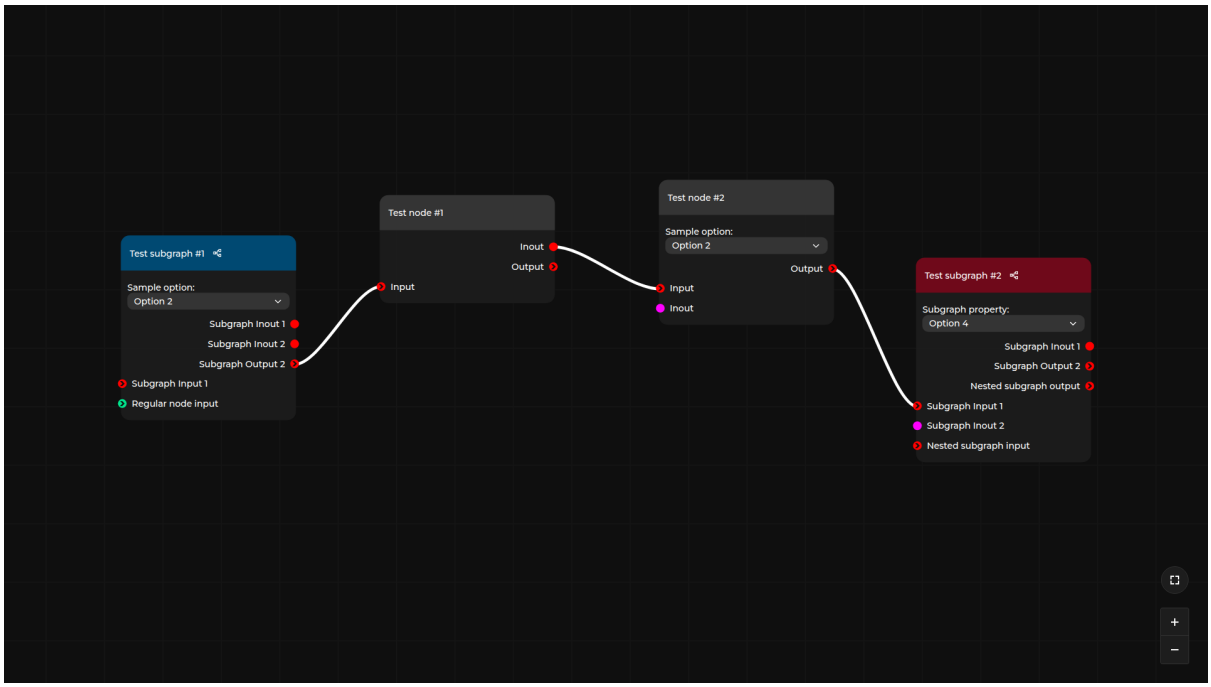
14.15 Example of a graph with positioned interfaces added manually



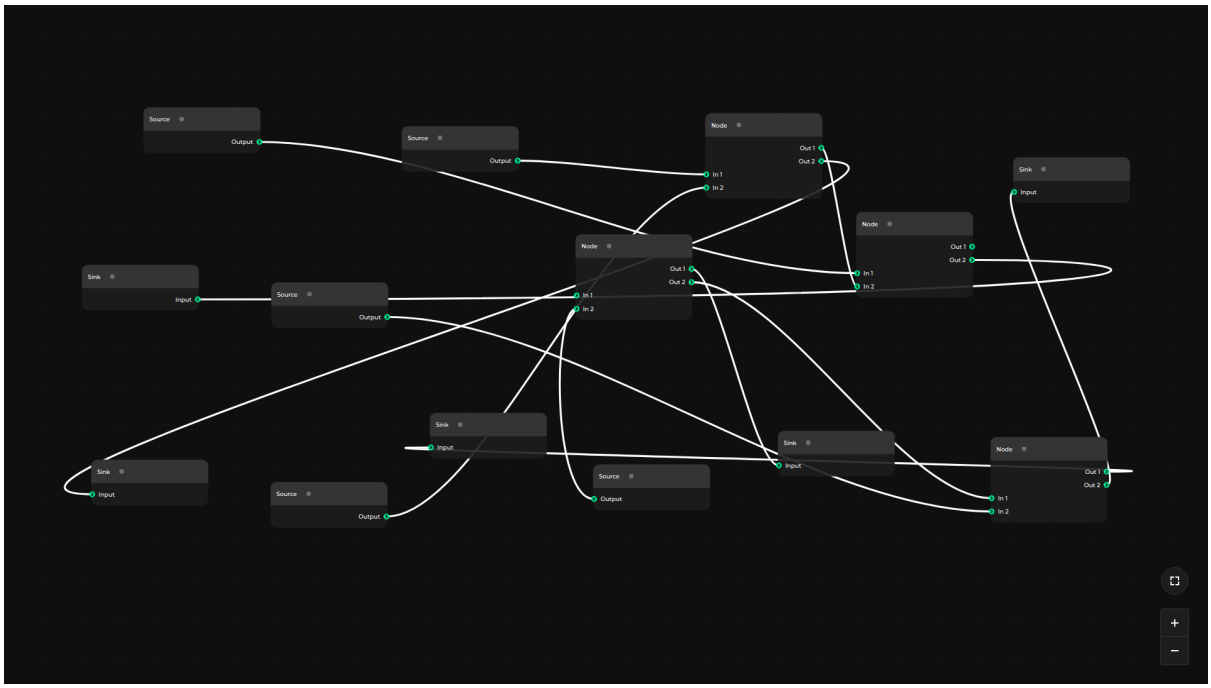
14.16 An example of custom graph styling



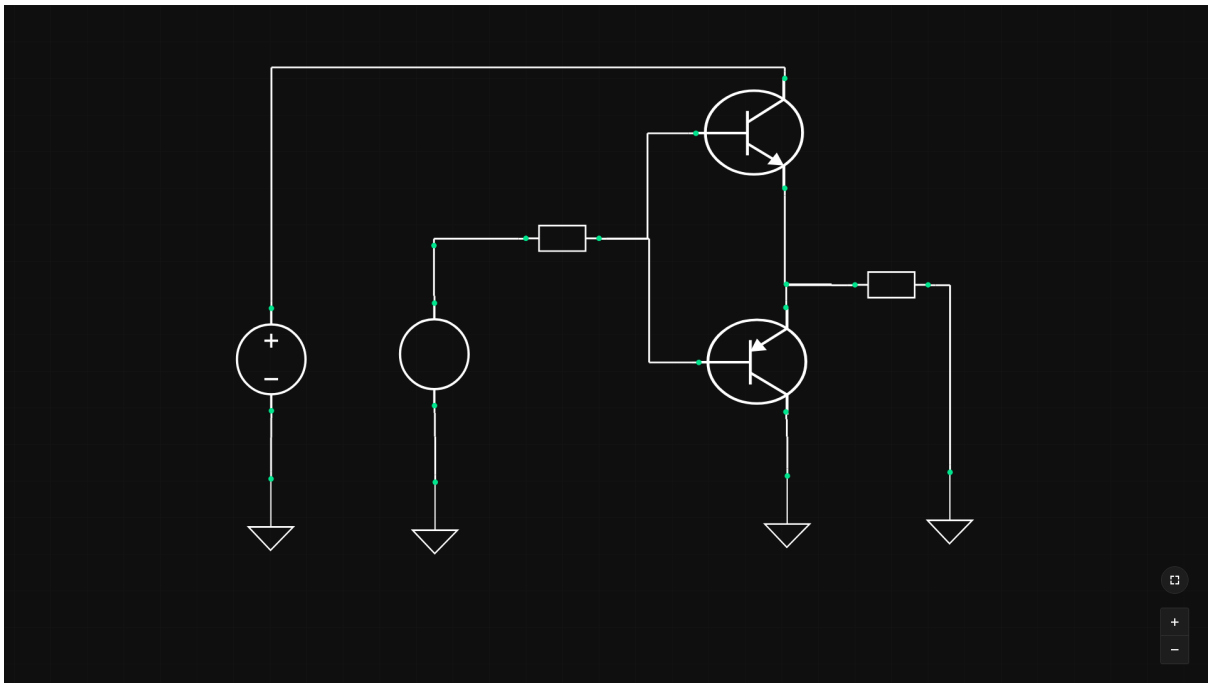
14.17 Example of a graph with graph nodes



14.18 Example of a graph with alternative views



14.19 Example of a graph with custom shape node



14.20 Communication with Pipeline Manager via `postMessage`

The demo allows to check communication between Pipeline Manager and its embedding webpage.

Go to Frontend-to-Frontend demo.

14.21 Huge pipeline manager graph

The demo shows very big and complicated graph with many subgraphs.

Go to Caliptra graph.

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